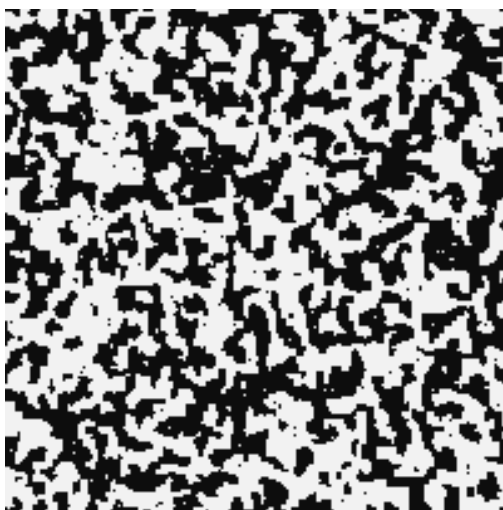


Advanced Statistical Physics

LECTURE NOTES

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Lecture 01: Introduction and Van der Waal's Equation of State

What we will discuss here is mainly the equilibrium physics of phase transitions which is both interesting and intriguing. Phase transitions are generally the result of the collective behaviour of interacting particles which produce some change in the thermodynamics of the system. For interaction between particles, we require a *pair potential*, which describes the behaviour of the interaction. One of such potentials is the celebrated *Lennard-Jones* potential (LJP) which goes as:

$$u(r) = \varepsilon_0 \left[\left(\frac{\sigma}{r} \right)^{12} - \left(\frac{\sigma}{r} \right)^6 \right]$$

where $r = |\mathbf{r}_i - \mathbf{r}_j|$ is the interparticle distance. This is used as a model for intermolecular interactions in many systems. Another “lesser” realistic (but simpler to handle) model can be described by the potential,

$$u(r) = \begin{cases} \infty & r < r_0 \\ -\varepsilon_0 \left(\frac{r_0}{r} \right)^6 & r > r_0 \end{cases}$$

The above potential tells that the minimum possible separation between molecules is r_0 , since $u(r)$ blows up below $r = r_0$. Hence the particles act as *hard spheres* (spheres which cannot penetrate each other) of radius $\frac{r_0}{2}$. For $r > r_0$, $u(r) \sim r^{-6}$ which implies *dipolar interactions*.

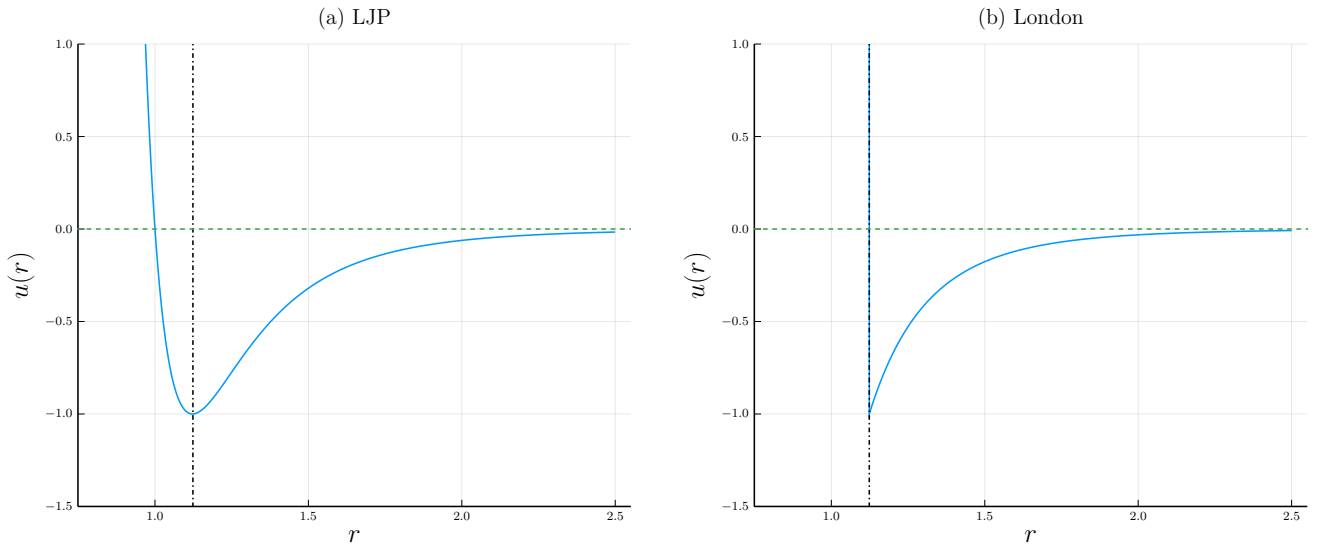


Figure 1: Interaction potentials. (a) Lennard-Jones potential. The vertical line denotes the r at which minima occurs (b) London dispersion potential.

Note that these interactions are mostly *power-law* interactions, $u(r) \sim r^{-s}$. Let d be the dimension of the space in which we are working. Then, it can be shown or motivated that if $s \leq d$, then the interaction is long-ranged which is not ideal for us. Extensivity can break down and some other issues (like negative specific heat) may occur in this case. One such example is that of gravitational systems where $u(r) \sim \frac{1}{r}$. If $s > d$ then the interaction is short-ranged. Since $u(r)$ blows up when $r = 0$, in general, it is advisable to impose a hard core repulsion (like in the London force) which ensures that everything stays okay, since interactions act only after $r > r_0$!

1.1. Van der Waal's gas

Let us see an example of this using the Van der Waal's equation which is a correction to the ideal gas equation $PV = Nk_B T$ and successfully explains the condensation process of gases.

We will work in canonical ensemble here. The *canonical partition function* is written as,

$$\mathcal{Z}(N, V, T) = \frac{1}{N!} \int \prod_i \left(\frac{d^3 p_i d^3 q_i}{h^3} \right) e^{-\beta \mathcal{H}}$$

where $\mathcal{H}$ is the Hamiltonian of the system. The $N!$ factor has been put to include the indistinguishability of the particles and h^3 factor has been put to make the phase space volume dimensionless. The Hamiltonian consists, as usual, of a kinetic and a pair potential part.

$$\mathcal{H} = \sum_i \frac{p_i^2}{2m} + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i \neq j} u(|\mathbf{q}_i - \mathbf{q}_j|)$$

The momentum integral can be carried out nicely since this is essentially a Gaussian integral. Using independence of the kinetic terms we get,

$$\mathcal{Z}_p = \left[\int \frac{d^3p}{h^3} e^{-\beta p^2/2m} \right]^N = \left[\frac{4\pi}{h^3} \int_0^\infty p^2 e^{-\beta p^2/2m} dp \right]^N = \left[\frac{2\pi m k_B T}{h^2} \right]^{3N/2}$$

Defining the thermal wavelength $\lambda_T = h/\sqrt{2\pi m k_B T}$, we have

$$\mathcal{Z} = \frac{1}{N! \lambda_T^{3N}} \int \prod_i d^3q_i e^{-\beta U(\{\mathbf{q}_i\})}$$

where $U(\{\mathbf{q}_i\})$ denotes the interaction term in the Hamiltonian. Tackling this part is extremely hard, since the interactions are between pair of particles, hence independence cannot be assumed.

1.2. Uniform Density Approximation

One of the most popular ways to deal with interactions is through *perturbation*, however, perturbations are generally taken to be *continuous* and hence, non-analyticity (an important aspect of phase transitions) cannot be effectively captured. We will use the method of *mean-field approximation*, which treats the interactions as an “effective potential” which can be found out self-consistently. To simplify our calculations, let us define the number density of the gas, in terms of the delta function,

$$n(\mathbf{q}) = \sum_{i=1}^N \delta^{(3)}(\mathbf{q} - \mathbf{q}_i) \quad (1)$$

Then the interaction term becomes,

$$\begin{aligned} 2U &= \sum_i \sum_{j \neq i} u(|\mathbf{q}_i - \mathbf{q}_j|) \\ &= \sum_i \sum_{j \neq i} \int d^3q_1 \delta^{(3)}(\mathbf{q}_1 - \mathbf{q}_i) \cdot u(|\mathbf{q}_1 - \mathbf{q}_j|) \\ &= \sum_i \sum_{j \neq i} \int d^3q_1 \delta^{(3)}(\mathbf{q}_1 - \mathbf{q}_i) \cdot \int d^3q_2 \delta^{(3)}(\mathbf{q}_2 - \mathbf{q}_j) \cdot u(|\mathbf{q}_1 - \mathbf{q}_2|) \\ &= \int d^3q_1 d^3q_2 \sum_i \sum_{j \neq i} \delta^{(3)}(\mathbf{q}_1 - \mathbf{q}_i) \cdot \delta^{(3)}(\mathbf{q}_2 - \mathbf{q}_j) \cdot u(|\mathbf{q}_1 - \mathbf{q}_2|) \\ &= \int d^3q_1 d^3q_2 n(\mathbf{q}_1) n(\mathbf{q}_2) u(|\mathbf{q}_1 - \mathbf{q}_2|) \end{aligned}$$

We will use a heavily *unmotivated* approximation where we will treat the density to be uniform, independent of the spatial coordinate, that is, $n(\mathbf{r}) \equiv n$. Then,

$$U = \frac{n^2}{2} \int d^3q_1 d^3q_2 u(|\mathbf{q}_1 - \mathbf{q}_2|)$$

Let us define the variables $\mathbf{R} = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{r}_1 + \mathbf{r}_2)$ and $\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{r}_1 - \mathbf{r}_2$ from which we have $\mathbf{r}_1 = \mathbf{R} + \frac{\mathbf{r}}{2}$ and $\mathbf{r}_2 = \mathbf{R} - \frac{\mathbf{r}}{2}$. The Jacobian of this transformation can be written as,

$$\mathbf{J} \equiv \frac{\partial(\mathbf{r}_1, \mathbf{r}_2)}{\partial(\mathbf{R}, \mathbf{r})} = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbb{1} & \frac{1}{2}\mathbb{1} \\ \mathbb{1} & -\frac{1}{2}\mathbb{1} \end{pmatrix} \implies J = \det(\mathbf{J}) = -1$$

Using the new variables, the integral becomes,

$$U = \frac{n^2}{2} \int d^3R d^3r u(r) = \frac{n^2 V}{2} \int_{r_0}^{\infty} d^3r u(r) = \frac{N^2}{2V} \int d^3r u(r)$$

where we have used $n = N/V$ and r_0 is the hard-core cutoff. Now, assume a power-law interaction for $r > r_0$, $u(r) = -\varepsilon_0 \left(\frac{r_0}{r}\right)^s$ using which we get,

$$U = -\frac{\varepsilon_0 N^2}{2V} \cdot r_0^s \int_{r_0}^{\infty} 4\pi r^2 dr \frac{1}{r^s} = -\frac{4\pi\varepsilon_0 N^2 r_0^s}{2V(3-s)} r^{3-s} \Big|_{r_0}^{\infty}$$

As we can see, U is finite only when $3-s < 0 \implies s > 3$ where 3 was our spatial dimension. Assuming $s > 3$, we have $r^{3-s} \rightarrow 0$ and we have

$$U = \frac{4\pi\varepsilon_0 N^2 r_0^s}{2V(3-s)} r_0^{3-s} = -\frac{4\pi\varepsilon_0 N^2 r_0^3}{2V(s-3)} = -\frac{aN^2}{V} \quad \text{where, } a \equiv \frac{2\pi\varepsilon_0 r_0^3}{s-3}$$

We get an ‘effective’ interaction potential using the *uniform density approximation*. From here, the partition function now becomes,

$$\mathcal{Z} = \frac{e^{\beta a N^2/V}}{N! \lambda_T^{3N}} \int \prod dq_i$$

Now, the integral is simply not equal to V^N , since we have assumed a hard-sphere gas and each particle has some finite volume. Assume that each particle occupies a small volume ω , which cannot be occupied by the other particles. If one particle occupies volume say V , then the second particle can occupy $V - \omega$, the third occupies $V - 2\omega$ and so on. Then the integral will be just,

$$\begin{aligned} \int \prod dq_i &\equiv \prod_{i=0}^{N-1} (V - i\omega) \approx \prod (V - j\omega)(V - (N-j)\omega) \\ &= \prod V^2 \left(1 - \frac{j\omega}{V}\right) \left(1 - \frac{(N-j)\omega}{V}\right) \\ &\approx V^N \prod \left[1 - \frac{(j + N-j)\omega}{V} + \mathcal{O}((\omega/V)^2)\right] \\ &\approx V^N \left[1 - \frac{N\omega}{V}\right]^{N/2} = \left[V \left(1 - \frac{N\omega}{V}\right)^{1/2}\right]^N \end{aligned}$$

where we have made the product over $\approx N/2$ pairs. Now, assume $N\omega \ll V$ from which we can use the approximation $(1+x)^n \approx 1+nx$ to get,

$$\left[V \left(1 - \frac{N\omega}{V}\right)^{1/2}\right]^N \approx \left[V \left(1 - \frac{N\omega}{2V}\right)\right]^N = \left[V - \frac{N\omega}{2}\right]^N$$

We see that the available volume is reduced by a factor of $N\omega/2$. This was the final step and we can now write the partition function,

$$\boxed{\mathcal{Z}(N, V, T) = \frac{e^{\beta a N^2/V}}{N! \lambda_T^{3N}} \left[V - \frac{N\omega}{2}\right]^N} \quad (2)$$

The free energy can be obtained from the partition function using $F = -k_B T \ln \mathcal{Z}$,

$$F = -k_B T \beta \frac{aN^2}{V} - N k_B T \ln \left[V - \frac{N\omega}{2}\right] + c(N, T)$$

and from here, we can find the pressure $P = -\left(\frac{\partial F}{\partial V}\right)_{N,T}$

$$P = -\frac{aN^2}{V^2} + \frac{Nk_B T}{\left(V - \frac{N\omega}{2}\right)} \Rightarrow \boxed{\left(P + \frac{aN^2}{V^2}\right)(V - Nb) = Nk_B T} \quad (3)$$

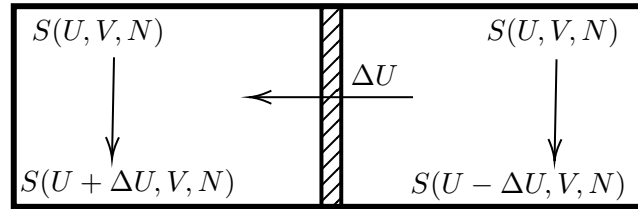
This is the Van der Waal's equation, where we have defined $b = \omega/2$. This can be written in an alternate form using the number of moles, $\mathbf{n} = N/N_A$ where N_A is the Avogadro's number:

$$\left(P + \frac{a'\mathbf{n}^2}{V^2}\right)(V - \mathbf{n}b') = \mathbf{n}RT \iff \left(P + \frac{a'}{v_m^2}\right)(v_m - b') = RT$$

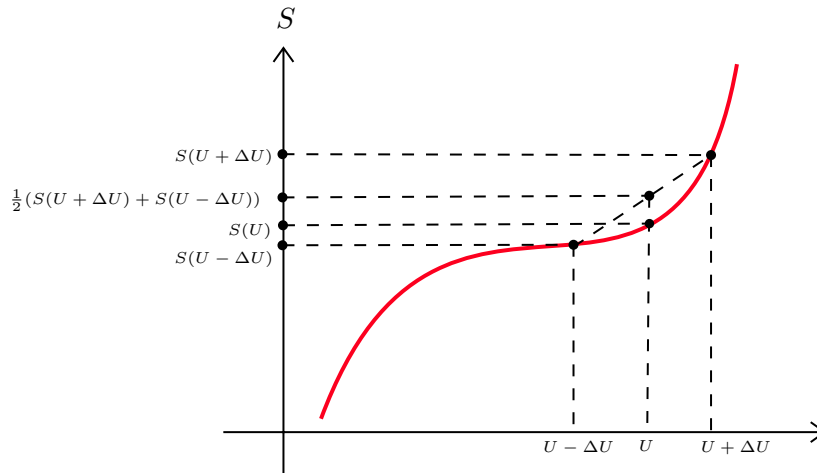
where $a' = N_A^2 a$ and $b' = bN_A$ and v_m is the molar volume.

Lecture 02: Stability of Thermodynamic Systems

We will discuss about the conditions under which the system in consideration is stable. This will in turn help us to understand *phase transitions* which are consequences of instability!



Consider two identical subsystems, with entropies $S(U, V, N)$, separated by an adiabatic wall. Suppose we remove an amount of energy ΔU from the first subsystem and transfer it to the second, the total energy changes from $2S(U, V, N)$ to $S(U + \Delta U) + S(U - \Delta U, V, N)$. Suppose that the entropy of the system looked something like in the diagram below.



Then, the resultant entropy after this transfer would be greater than the initial entropy. This would lead to inhomogenities in the system. Within one subsystem, there would be an uneven re-distribution of energy within different regions. This loss of homogeneity indicates a *phase separation*!

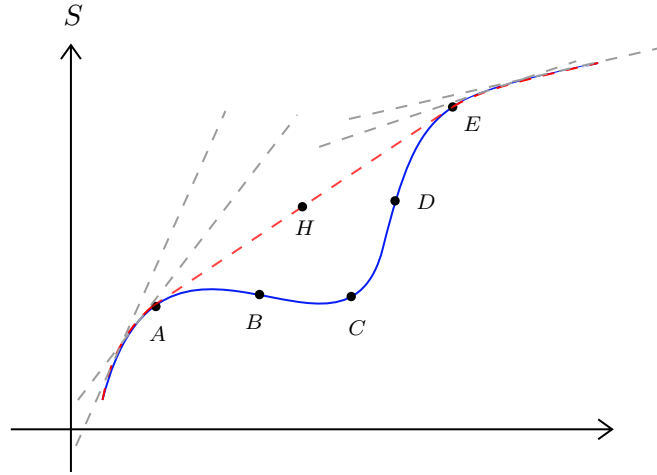
Thus the stability condition is the *concavity of entropy*, that is,

$$S(U - \Delta U, V, N) + S(U + \Delta U, V, N) \leq 2S(U) \quad (4)$$

Taylor expansion of the left hand side leads to the condition (under the limit $\Delta U \rightarrow 0$)

$$\boxed{\left(\frac{\partial^2 S}{\partial U^2}\right)_{V,N} \leq 0} \quad (5)$$

This implies that the curvature of the entropy should be downwards! It might happen that we obtain a ‘locally convex’ entropy curve from some calculation or from experimental data, which does not obey concavity.



This *convex intruder* cannot describe the equilibrium state and we have to obtain the *stable thermodynamic fundamental equation* from this curve. To do that, we construct all the *superior tangents*, that is, tangents which are above this curve. Now, within the family of tangents, there will be one line which will touch the curve at two places.

In the diagram, tangent at any point after A (but before E) will cross the curve. Now, the tangent at A will touch the curve at E. If it had not touched, it would have either intersected the curve or gone above E (If it has intersected the curve, then the tangent at A should not have been considered at all since we are considering only superior tangents. If it had gone over E, this means that there must be some points after A, where this touching will occur. In any case, what we want to say is that, there will be a ‘common tangent’ at points A and E).

Now, take the envelope of this family of tangents and this will be the fundamental thermodynamic equation that describes the equilibrium states.

Any point on the straight line denotes a phase-separated state, where part of the system is in state A and another part is in E. This happens because of the convex curve of entropy, which creates an inhomogeneity.

Note that in the region AB and DE, entropy is still concave, hence these are called *metastable* or locally stable states. These states satisfy Eq.(5) but does not satisfy Eq.(4) while the region BCD satisfy neither condition.

NOTE:

A generic condition for stability is given by $\delta P \delta V \leq 0$ where δP and δV represent a small deviation from the equilibrium value. We can write,

$$0 \geq \delta V \left[\left. \frac{\partial P}{\partial V} \right|_T \delta V + \frac{1}{2} \left. \frac{\partial^2 P}{\partial V^2} \right|_T (\delta V)^2 + \frac{1}{6} \left. \frac{\partial^3 P}{\partial V^3} \right|_T (\delta V)^3 + \dots \right] \quad (6)$$

The first term has $(\delta V)^2$ which is always positive. Hence to make this term negative, we need

$$\left. \frac{\partial P}{\partial V} \right|_T \leq 0$$

Suppose that $\left. \frac{\partial P}{\partial V} \right|_T = 0$. Then the second term has $(\delta V)^3$ and irrespective of what sign $\left. \frac{\partial^2 P}{\partial V^2} \right|_T$ has, δV can always be chosen to make the overall term positive. Hence the only option we have is that

$$\left. \frac{\partial^2 P}{\partial V^2} \right|_T = 0$$

Similar to the first term, we have the third term as,

$$\left. \frac{\partial^3 P}{\partial V^3} \right|_T \leq 0$$

These define the stability conditions for our thermodynamic system.

2.1. Stability Relations for Potentials

We will now discuss what are the consequence of stability on the thermodynamic potentials, F and G . We will use the fact that for a mechanically stable system, the *specific heat* and the *isothermal compressibility* must be positive for all temperatures. It can be motivated since compressibility and specific heat are related to number and energy fluctuations, σ_N and σ_E respectively, both of which are positive.

From appendix A, we see that $S = -\left(\frac{\partial F}{\partial T}\right)_{V,N}$ from which we get:

$$\left(\frac{\partial^2 F}{\partial T^2}\right)_{V,N} = -\left(\frac{\partial S}{\partial T}\right)_{V,N} = -\frac{1}{T}C_v \leq 0$$

Similarly, we can use $S = -\left(\frac{\partial G}{\partial T}\right)_{P,N}$ from which we get:

$$\left(\frac{\partial^2 G}{\partial T^2}\right)_{P,N} = -\left(\frac{\partial S}{\partial T}\right)_{P,N} = -\frac{1}{T}C_p \leq 0$$

From this, we infer that $G(T, P, N)$ and $F(T, V, N)$ are concave functions of temperature. Apart from temperature, since F depends on V and G depends on P , let us check for pressure and volume too. We note that $V = \left(\frac{\partial G}{\partial P}\right)_{T,N}$ and $P = -\left(\frac{\partial F}{\partial V}\right)_{T,N}$

$$\begin{aligned} \left(\frac{\partial^2 G}{\partial P^2}\right)_{T,N} &= \left(\frac{\partial V}{\partial P}\right)_{T,N} = -V\mathcal{K}_T \leq 0 \\ \left(\frac{\partial^2 F}{\partial V^2}\right)_{T,N} &= -\left(\frac{\partial P}{\partial V}\right)_{T,N} = \frac{1}{V\mathcal{K}_T} \geq 0 \end{aligned} \tag{7}$$

where we have appropriately used the definitions of isothermal compressibility and heat capacity. Using this, we find that G is a concave function of pressure and F is a convex function of volume. From the above expressions in Eq 7, we can also write

$$\left(\frac{\partial^2 G}{\partial P^2}\right)_{T,N} = -\left\{\left(\frac{\partial^2 F}{\partial V^2}\right)_{T,N}\right\}^{-1} \tag{8}$$

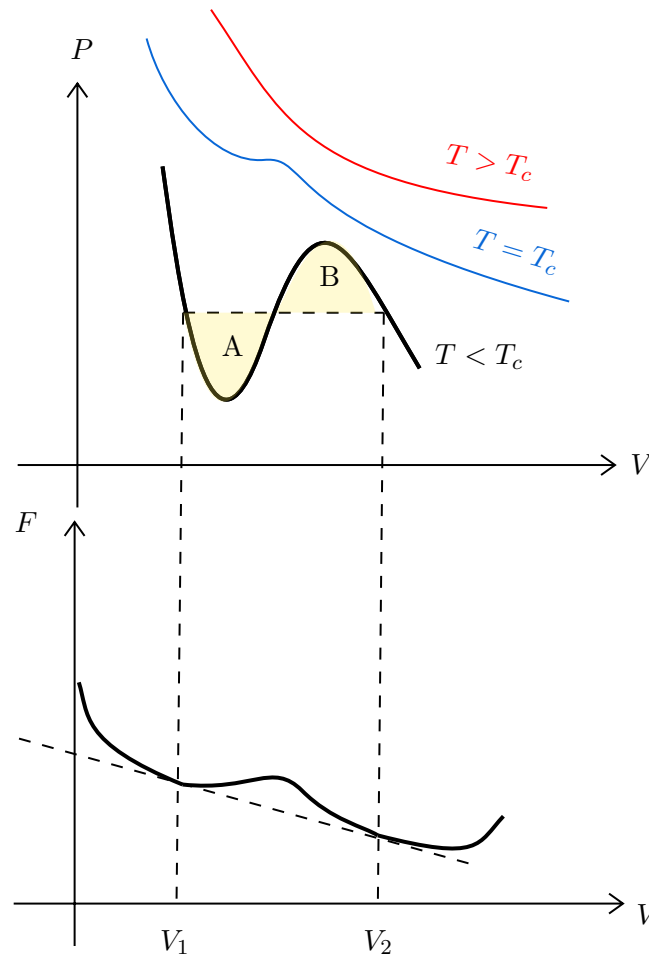
2.2. Stability Analysis of Van der waal's solutions

Recall the Van der Waal's equation from Eq (3),

$$\left(P + \frac{aN^2}{V^2}\right)(V - Nb) = Nk_B T$$

At high temperature, the P vs. V curves at constant temperature (*isotherm*) follows the usual ideal-gas curve. However, there exists a critical temperature T_c (which can be found out from the equation), such that, for $T < T_c$, there always exist a region, where the slope $\frac{\partial P}{\partial V}$ is positive. Since $\mathcal{K}_T = -\frac{1}{V}\left(\frac{\partial V}{\partial P}\right)_{N,T}$, this implies a negative compressibility, which, as motivated before, is *unphysical*.

This leads to a breakdown of the theory and Maxwell subsequently proposed an *ad hoc* remedy, similar in line to the construction of superior tangents that we noted earlier.



Consider the diagram above. Here, for a subcritical temperature, we see a region between V_1 and V_2 where the slope is positive. This region corresponds to the *concave intruder* (since free energy is a convex function of volume) in the free energy plot. Similarly as before, we replaced the concave part with a straight line denoting the common tangent. This corresponds to joining the region between V_1 and V_2 in the P-V plot with a straight horizontal line. It can also be shown that the horizontal line is at just such a value of the pressure that the areas labelled A and B are equal and hence this construction is also called *equal-area* construction.

Lecture 03: First Order Phase Transition

Let us now see some qualitative aspect of phase transition. Each phase transition can be viewed as a result of the failure of the stability criteria. We will see some characteristic aspects of first order phase transition¹. However, let us first note some geometric interpretation of the thermodynamic potentials.

3.1. Geometric Interpretation of Potentials

We will consider the relation $G = F + PV$ which can be obtained from the Legendre transform of the internal energy.

¹In modern language, these are called *abrupt phase transition*

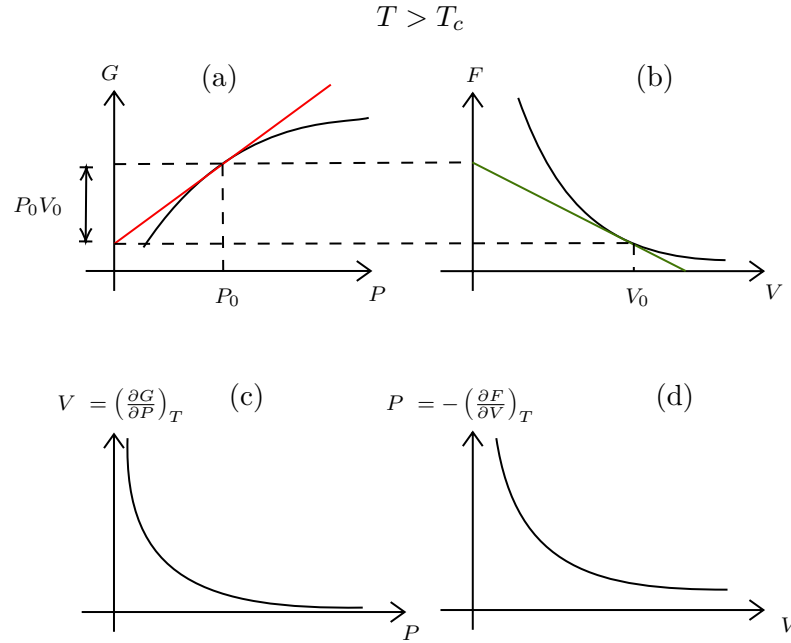


Figure 2: Relation between G and F . (a) Variation of Gibbs potential with pressure at a temperature $T > T_c$ (b) Corresponding plot of Helmholtz potential with V (c) and (d) denotes the P-V diagrams constructed from these potentials

In the above figure, observe the plot of G vs. P , which is smooth. We draw the tangent line at a $P = P_0$ and this intercepts the y-axis somewhere. The equation of the tangent is $G = PV + c$ as $V = \left(\frac{\partial G}{\partial P}\right)_{T,N}$ and it passes through the point (P_0, G_0) . Thus we have,

$$G_0 = P_0 V_0 + c \implies c = G_0 - P_0 V_0$$

The tangent has an intercept of $G_0 - P_0 V_0$ and so the remaining length as shown by the arrow in is Fig. 2 (a) is $G_0 - (G_0 - P_0 V_0) = P_0 V_0$. From the length of the intercept of the tangent, we can obtain the Helmholtz potential for this value of P_0 . We also obtain the volume from the slope of the tangent. The corresponding F vs. V graph has been plotted using these values. Also, plotted are the V vs. P graph (using the slope of the tangent of the Gibbs potential) and the P vs. V graph (using the slope of the tangent of the Helmholtz potential). This is the case for $T > T_c$. Now let us see the case when $T < T_c$ and the phase transition has occurred. We will see this with respect to the Van der Waal's equation.

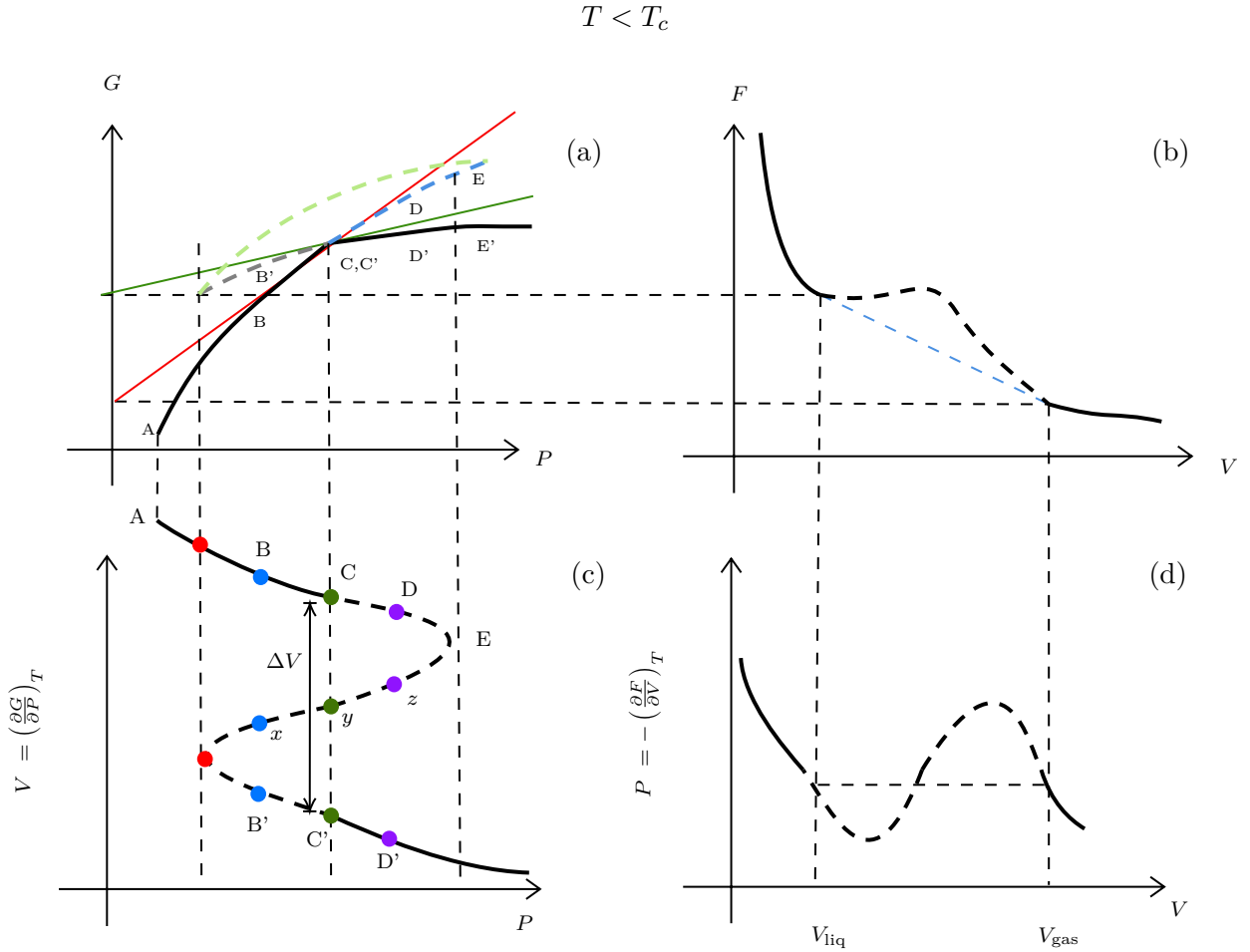


Figure 3: Plot of different quantities for $T < T_c$

In this scenario, G will have a 'kink' for some pressure $P = P_0$, since for first order phase transition, the derivative of the free energy is discontinuous. At this point, $(\frac{\partial^2 G}{\partial P^2}) \rightarrow \infty$ (even though this quantity cannot be defined exactly at $P = P_0$) and using Eq.(8), we get $(\frac{\partial F}{\partial V}) = 0$. Thus we expect that the corresponding plot of F has a *straight line* portion, as is shown in Fig.3 (b) with a blue dashed line.

Let us now see how the plot of G in (a) is actually constructed. For that, we need the isotherm in (c). Let us start at A and then, integrating we have

$$G(P) - G(P_A) = \int_{P_A}^P V dP$$

and we do this for all values of P . This creates a closed loop kind of plot, since for a single P , we have three values of V . Note that, this disappears for higher temperature since then, Van der Waal's equation consists of only one real and two complex roots.

What happens physically? Let us suppose our system is in a temperature bath and the temperature is fixed. So, consider the isotherm in (c) and start increasing pressure from P_A . The system will follow this isotherm. At P_A , there is a unique volume and thus a unique state of the system. Now, if we increase further, for each pressure, we will get multiple values of volume, so there are different states to choose from.

Consider the blue points (all having same P but different V). Of these, the state x is unstable and hence the system has two states B and B' to choose from. The state chosen is the one with the minimum value of G which is determined from panel (a). As clearly seen, the physical state chosen is B. Increasing pressure further, we get to C where the kink is there.

On increasing further, we see that the state chosen is D' since this has lesser value of G . The blue and

gray dashed lines in (a) denote the branch of G with higher value of G and thus, is not chosen. The green dashed line represent the unstable region where the states, say x, y or z lies. We see that in (c), no state from the dashed region is selected and hence after C , there is a volume jump, denoted by ΔV . The physical isotherm is thus the one created from the Maxwell equal area construction (as discussed before) and the straight line in the isotherm denotes the *coexistence* of two phases.

The points C and C' are determined by the condition that $G(P_c) = G(P_{c'})$ and hence, $\int_{P_c}^{P_{c'}} V dP = 0$, which proves that the areas divided by the line segment are indeed equal.

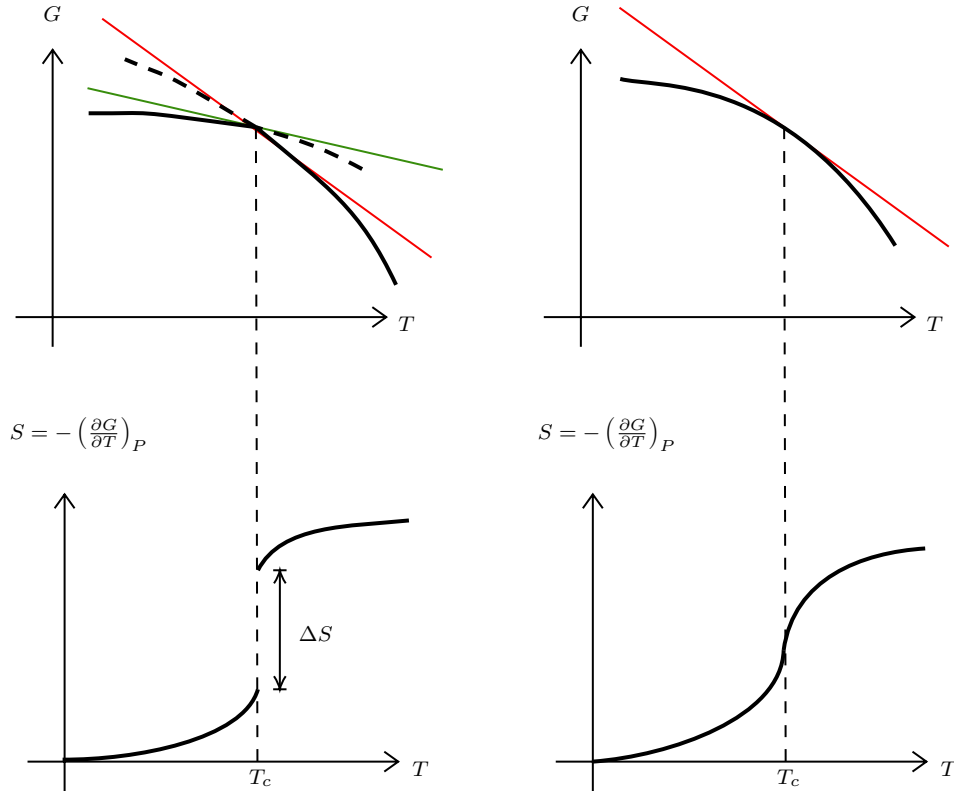


Figure 4: The left column shows the variation of G and S with temperature for first order phase transition, clearly showing an entropy discontinuity. The right column shows this for a higher order phase transition.

There is also an entropy change associated with phase transitions. For first order phase transitions, there is an abrupt entropy jump since entropy is defined as $S = -(\frac{\partial G}{\partial T})_P$ and G has a 'kink', making it non-differentiable at the critical point. This entropy jump is associated with the latent heat $L = T_c \Delta S$. For higher order phase transitions, where G is smooth (but some higher order derivative is discontinuous), there is no latent heat since S is continuous. However, the specific heat $C \sim \frac{dS}{dT}$ diverges at the critical point.

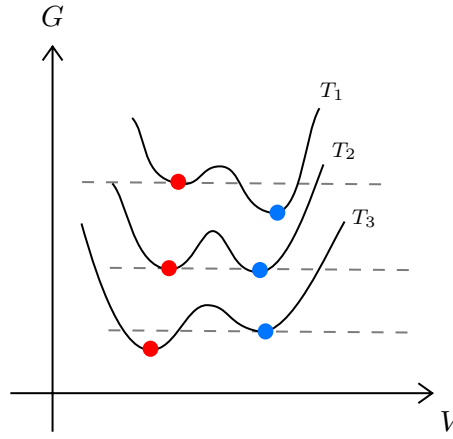


Figure 5: G vs. V plots for different temperatures.

From the previous analysis, we saw that in some interval, we had three values of volume for each pressure (out of which one was unphysical). A physical scenario to imagine is when suppose we have water above its boiling point (so it is in vapour phase). The Gibbs potential has its minima at two volumes as shown in Fig.5 for curve at T_1 . The system takes the minima which is lower (the right one).

As we decrease the temperature, at some temperature, both the minima become equal, as for T_2 . This is the *critical temperature*. As temperature is reduced further, the other minima becomes the more stable one. The system was in the right minima which was till now the *stable* one. It still remains in the right one, however, it now becomes *metastable*. In a very small timescale, due to some fluctuations, a *nucleus* of condensed liquid (the stable state) forms which grows rapidly and the entire system undergoes the transition.

3.2. Grand canonical basis of phase coexistence

Having seen the physical picture, we will discuss how the liquid-gas phase transition is brought about by considering the partition function that we had found out earlier from Eq(2). However, we used the uniform density approximation for this which is not entirely correct at phase coexistence since the gas (low density) and liquid phases (high density) have weirdly different densities (however, each phase can be assumed to have a uniform density separately).

This problem can be circumvented by considering the *grand canonical ensemble* where we fix the chemical potential μ and the number of particles (and in turn, the density) is appropriately adjusted for different phases. The grand partition function Ξ is defined as,

$$\Xi(\mu, T, V) = \sum_{N=0}^{\infty} e^{\beta\mu N} \mathcal{Z}(N, T, V) \quad (9)$$

where $\mathcal{Z}$ is the canonical partition function. We can appropriately modify the canonical partition function to write it as an exponential:

$$\begin{aligned} e^{\beta\mu N + \ln \mathcal{Z}} &= \exp[\beta\mu N] \cdot \exp\left[\frac{\beta a N^2}{V}\right] \cdot \exp\left[N \ln\left(V - \frac{N\omega}{2}\right)\right] \cdot \exp[-\ln N! - N \ln \lambda_T^3] \\ &= \exp[\beta\mu N] \cdot \exp\left[\frac{\beta a N^2}{V}\right] \cdot \exp\left[N \ln N + N \ln\left(\frac{V}{N} - \frac{\omega}{2}\right)\right] \cdot \exp[-\ln N! - N \ln \lambda_T^3] \\ &= \exp\left[\beta\mu N + \frac{\beta a N^2}{V} + N \ln N + N \ln\left(\frac{V}{N} - \frac{\omega}{2}\right) - \ln N! - N \ln \lambda_T^3\right] \\ &= \exp\left[\beta\mu N + \frac{\beta a N^2}{V} + \cancel{N \ln N} + N \ln\left(\frac{V}{N} - \frac{\omega}{2}\right) - \cancel{N \ln N} + N - N \ln \lambda_T^3\right] \\ &= \exp\left[\frac{\beta a N^2}{V} + N \ln\left(\frac{V}{N} - \frac{\omega}{2}\right) + N\Delta\right] \end{aligned}$$

where we have used Sterling's approximation, $\ln N! \approx N \ln N - N$ and $\Delta := (1 + \beta\mu - \ln \lambda_T^3)$. We can now use the saddle-point approximation to evaluate the sum, which gives only a significant contribution for some $N = N^*$.

$$\Xi \approx \exp \left[\frac{\beta a N^{*2}}{V} + N^* \ln \left(\frac{V}{N^*} - \frac{\omega}{2} \right) + N^* \Delta \right] \quad (10)$$

From appendix A, the grand potential is,

$$-PV = \Phi = -k_B T \ln \Xi \implies \beta P = \frac{\ln \Xi}{V} \approx \left[\frac{\beta a N^{*2}}{V^2} + \frac{N^*}{V} \ln \left(\frac{V}{N^*} - \frac{\omega}{2} \right) + \frac{N^*}{V} \Delta \right]$$

We define $n^* = \frac{N^*}{V}$, where n^* is the solution of the equation $\frac{\partial \Psi}{\partial n} = 0$ where $\Psi(n)$ is defined as,

$$\Psi(n) = \beta a n^2 + n \ln \left(\frac{1}{n} - \frac{\omega}{2} \right) + n \Delta$$

Carrying out the differentiation $\frac{\partial \Psi}{\partial n}$, we obtain

$$2\beta a n + \ln \left(\frac{1}{n} - \frac{\omega}{2} \right) + \frac{n}{\frac{1}{n} - \frac{\omega}{2}} \times \left(-\frac{1}{n^2} \right) + \Delta = 0 \implies \Delta = \frac{1}{1 - \frac{\omega n}{2}} - 2\beta a n - \ln \left(\frac{1}{n} - \frac{\omega}{2} \right) \quad (11)$$

Substituting this value of Δ in $\Psi(n)$ we get,

$$\Psi(n^*) = \beta a N^{*2} + n^* \ln \left(\frac{1}{N^*} - \frac{\omega}{2} \right) + \frac{n^*}{1 - \frac{n^* \omega}{2}} - 2\beta a n^{*2} - n^* \ln \left(\frac{1}{n^*} - \frac{\omega}{2} \right) = \frac{1}{\frac{1}{n^*} - \frac{\omega}{2}} - \beta a N^{*2}$$

Comparing this with Van der Waal's equation, this gives us $P = P_{\text{can.}}$ where $P_{\text{can.}}$ is the canonical ensemble pressure. This tells us that the grand canonical and the canonical pressure are identical at particular value of the density n^* . Here we have assumed only a unique n^* which maximises the sum. However, the sum in Eq (10) can be peaked at multiple different values of densities and the appropriate uniform density is chosen for that value which maximises $\Psi(n)$.

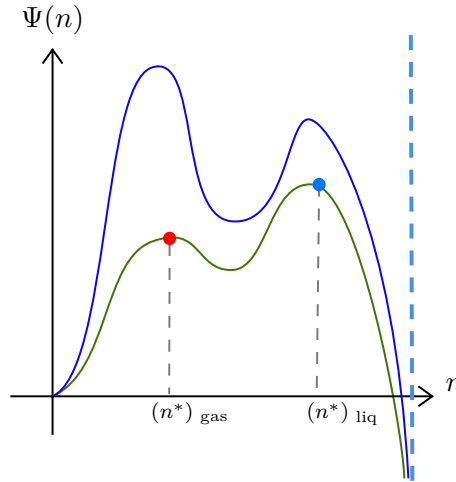


Figure 6: Plot of $\Psi(n)$ vs. n at different temperature. Green plot is for $T < T_c$ and blue is for $T > T_c$. The lower density corresponds to gas and higher density corresponds to liquid. At $n = \frac{2}{\omega}$, $\Psi(n) \rightarrow -\infty$ which has been shown by the blue vertical dashed line.

In the above figure, the blue curve denotes $T > T_c$ and the green curve denotes $T < T_c$. For both $T < T_c$ and $T > T_c$, we have two peaks in the $\Psi(n)$ vs. n plot, however, only the right peak is chosen for $T < T_c$ (corresponding to liquid density) and the left peak is chosen for $T > T_c$ (corresponding to gas density). Considering contribution from both peaks,

$$\ln \Xi \approx \ln \left(e^{V\Psi(n_{\text{liq}}^*)} + e^{V\Psi(n_{\text{gas}}^*)} \right) = V\Psi(n_{\text{liq}}^*) + \ln \left(1 + e^{V(\Psi(n_{\text{gas}}^*) - \Psi(n_{\text{liq}}^*))} \right)$$

In the thermodynamic limit, if $T > T_c$, $\Psi(n_{\text{gas}}^*) > \Psi(n_{\text{liq}}^*)$ then $\ln \Xi \approx V\Psi(n_{\text{gas}}^*)$ and hence the gas phase dominates. For $T < T_c$, $\Psi(n_{\text{gas}}^*) < \Psi(n_{\text{liq}}^*)$ and hence the liquid phase dominates. From this, we can say that only in the thermodynamic limit, there is a *singularity* in the density at $T = T_c$ (there are no phase transitions in finite systems)!

Lecture 04: Yang-Lee Theory for Phase Transition

We will now discuss about a mathematical basis of condensation based on Yang and Lee's theory of phase transition [1] which is based on the analysis of the zeroes of the grand partition function. The partition function seems to be an analytic function since it essentially consists of sums of well-behaved exponentials.

However, phase transitions are characterised by non-analyticity which leads us to think about how the analytic partition function will capture the essence of the non-analytic phase transition. As discussed before, *true* phase transitions occur only in the thermodynamic limit and in the thermodynamic limit, partition function can indeed become non-analytic (since the limit functions of a sequence of analytic function need not be analytic).

4.1. Singularities and Phase Transition

We will write Eq (9) in terms of the *fugacity* $z = e^{\beta\mu}$ and also consider a finite system with volume V (and then take ultimately take $V \rightarrow \infty$). Only a finite number of particles, say M , can be crammed into this finite volume, hence

$$\Xi(z, V) = \sum_{N=0}^M z^N \mathcal{Z}(N, V, T) = 1 + z\mathcal{Z}_1 + z^2\mathcal{Z}_2 + \dots + z^M\mathcal{Z}_M \quad (12)$$

Note that the above equation is a well-behaved polynomial of degree M in z and its coefficients $\mathcal{Z}_N$ are all positive which implies that $\Xi(z, V)$ has no real positive root. From the grand potential $\Phi = -PV = -k_B T \ln \Xi$, we can write the pressure P and density ρ in the thermodynamic limit,

$$\begin{aligned} P &= \lim_{V \rightarrow \infty} \frac{k_B T}{V} \ln \Xi(z, V) \\ \langle N \rangle &= z \frac{\partial \ln \Xi}{\partial z} \implies \rho = \lim_{V \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\langle N \rangle}{V} = \lim_{V \rightarrow \infty} \frac{z}{V} \frac{\partial \ln \Xi(z, V)}{\partial z} \end{aligned} \quad (13)$$

These quantities will not have any singularity unless $\Xi(z, V) = 0$ which cannot hold true, unless we consider a *complex* fugacity. Then for finite V , the algebraic equation $\Xi = 0$ has M roots appearing in complex-conjugate pairs. As V increases, the number of roots also increases (linearly with V) and moves around in the complex plane, excluding the real axis. In the limit $V \rightarrow \infty$, some of these roots touch the real axis and this describes a phase transition. With regard to this, we discuss two theorems as stated in the original paper.

Theorem 1:

For all positive values of z , the limit

$$L = \lim_{V \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{V} \ln \Xi(z, V)$$

exists and is independent of the shape of the volume holding the particles, with the assumption that the surface area does not scale faster than $V^{2/3}$.

Moreover, $L(z)$ is a continuous, monotonically increasing function of z .

Theorem 2:

Suppose in the complex z plane, there exists a region $\mathcal{R}$ containing the positive real axis, which has no roots of Ξ , then $\lim_{V \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{V} \frac{\partial^k \ln \Xi}{\partial z^k}$ is uniformly convergent and the limit function is analytic for all $z \in \mathcal{R}$.

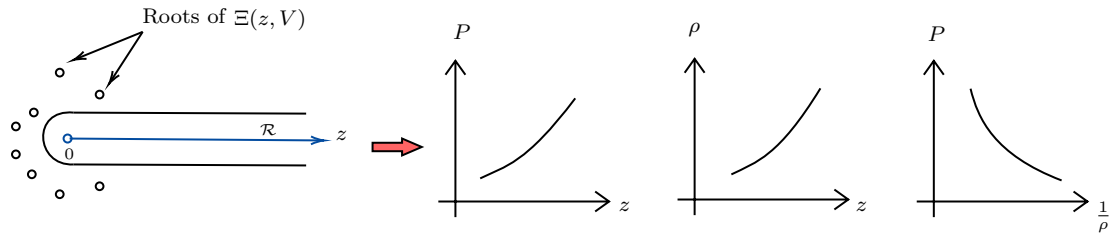
Moreover, the operations $\lim_{V \rightarrow \infty}$ and $z \frac{\partial}{\partial z}$ can be interchanged.

The above theorem implies that,

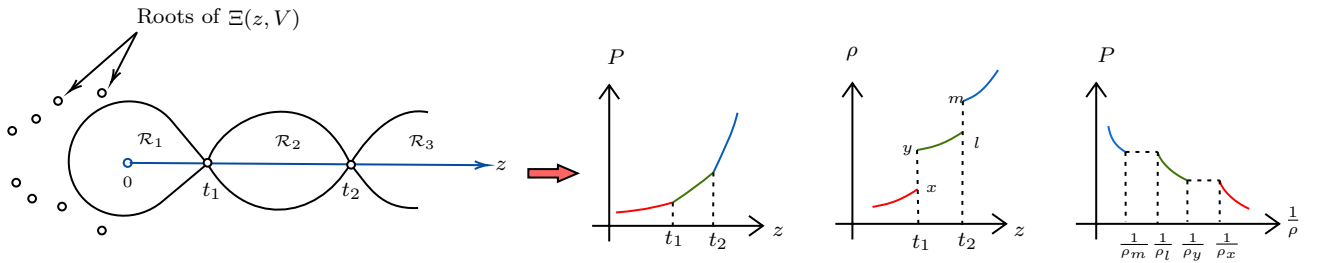
$$\rho = \lim_{V \rightarrow \infty} \frac{z}{V} \frac{\partial \ln \Xi}{\partial z} \iff z \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \left(\lim_{V \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{V} \ln \Xi \right) = z \frac{\partial(\beta P)}{\partial z} \quad (14)$$

If such a region $\mathcal{R}$ does not exist, then the limit does not exist which makes sense physically, since the density ρ as defined in Eq (13), does not assume a single value at the condensation point. Hence, everything depends on the existence of $\mathcal{R}$

- As $V \rightarrow \infty$, if a region $\mathcal{R}$ exists which fully encloses the positive real axis, then P exists from Thm (1) and is an analytic, increasing function of z . From Thm (2), ρ also exists and is an analytic function of z . It can be shown that ρ is also increasing with z . P and ρ are related by Eq (14). The system under consideration is in a *single phase*.



- On the other hand, if the roots of $\Xi(z, V)$ approach some specific values $z = t_1, t_2 \dots$ on the real axis as $V \rightarrow \infty$, from the figure below, there will exist regions $\mathcal{R}_1, \mathcal{R}_2 \dots$ within which Thm (2) will be satisfied piecewise and hence, within these regions, the system exists in a single phase as argued before. At the points $t_1, t_2 \dots$, the pressure P will be continuous from Thm (1), but ρ might have some non-analyticity since this does not satisfy the condition for Thm (2). The system now possess *multiple phases*.



It is to be noted that the discontinuity in the density is only possible in the thermodynamic limit. For finite system, we will get a *continuous crossover* due to *finite-size effects*.

If $\frac{\partial P}{\partial z}$ is discontinuous, then we have a *first-order phase transition* as shown in the figure above. If $\frac{\partial P}{\partial z}$ is continuous but $\frac{\partial^2 P}{\partial z^2}$ is discontinuous, then we obtain a *second-order phase transition*.

From this discussion, we observe that the study of phase transitions can be reduced to just studying the distribution of the zeroes of the grand partition function.

Lecture 05: More on Van der Waal's Equation

In the previous section, we saw a mathematical theory of condensation based on the zeroes of the grand partition function. Let us now move back to the Van der Waal's equation and try to analyse the critical point.

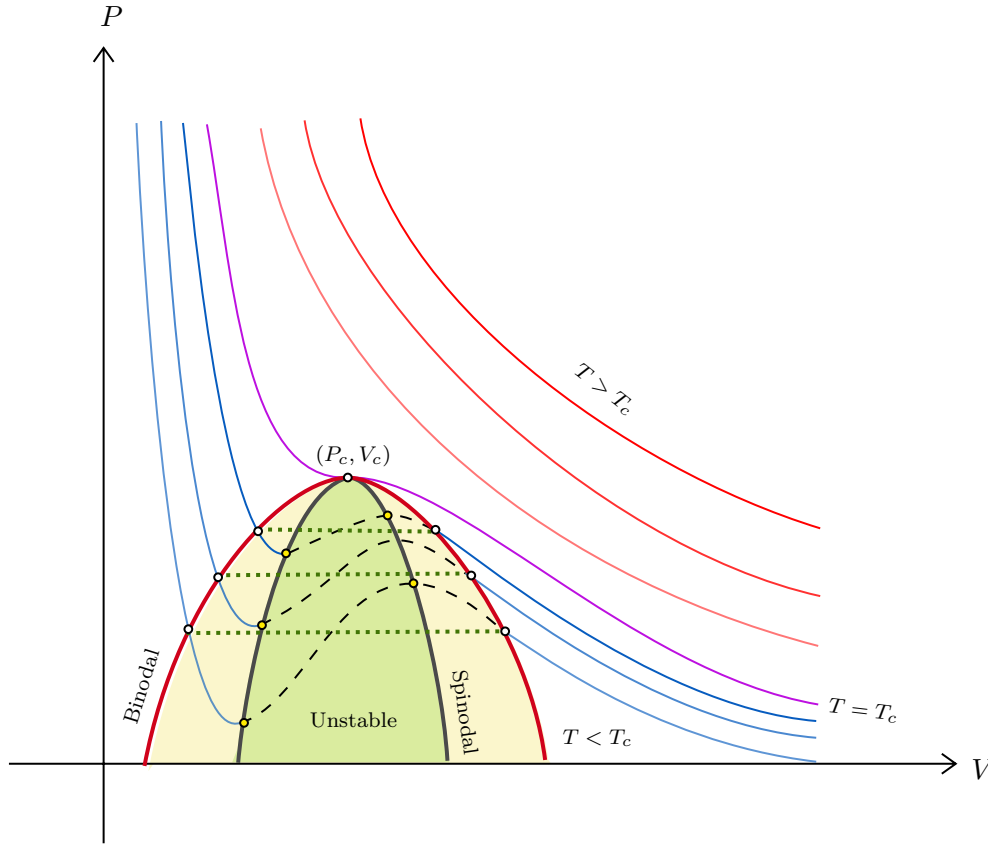


Figure 7: Van der Waal's isotherm. The figure shows Van der Waal's isotherms for $T < T_c$ ($T > T_c$) with blue (red) lines. The curve for $T = T_c$ is shown with purple line. Maxwell's construction is shown with green dotted line. The red line denotes the *binodal* line and the gray line denotes the *spinodal* line. The yellow region denote the metastable state while the green region denote the unstable states.

In Fig.??, we see the Van der Waal's isotherms at different temperature regime. There exists a temperature T_c such that at a particular point (V_c, P_c) , the isotherm has zero slope and zero curvature. Thus the critical point is characterised by

$$\frac{\partial P}{\partial V} = 0 \quad \frac{\partial^2 P}{\partial V^2} = 0$$

Defining $v = \frac{V}{N}$, from Van der Waal's equation we can write,

$$P = \frac{k_B T}{v - b} - \frac{a}{v^2} \implies \frac{\partial P}{\partial v} = -\frac{k_B T}{(v - b)^2} + \frac{2a}{v^3} \implies \frac{\partial^2 P}{\partial v^2} = \frac{2k_B T}{(v - b)^3} - \frac{6a}{v^4} \quad (15)$$

Equating the derivative to zero, we get $2a(v_c - b)^2 = k_B T v_c^3$ and equating the second derivative to zero, we get $3a(v_c - b)^3 = k_B T v_c^4$. Dividing both these equations, we get

$$\frac{3}{2}(v_c - b) = v_c \implies 3(v_c - b) = 2v_c \implies v_c = 3b$$

Substituting this in any one of the above equation we get $k_B T_c = \frac{8a}{27b}$ and substituting v_c and T_c in Van der Waal's equation, we get $P_c = \frac{a}{27b^2}$. Thus our critical parameters are,

$$\boxed{P_c = \frac{a}{27b^2} \quad v_c = 3b \quad k_B T_c = \frac{8a}{27b}}$$

5.1. Approaching Universality

The Van der Waal's equation depends on the microscopic details of the system, a and b . These vary for different gases and hence, the equation cannot describe universal properties. However, let us define the

reduced parameters,

$$\Pi = \frac{P}{P_c} \quad \nu = \frac{v}{v_c} \quad \tau = \frac{T}{T_c}$$

We now put these in the equation of state, which gives us

$$\begin{aligned} \left(\Pi P_c + \frac{a}{\nu^2 v_c^2} \right) (\nu v_c - b) &= k_B \tau T_c \implies \left(\frac{\Pi a}{27b^2} + \frac{a}{9\nu^2 b^2} \right) (3b\nu - b) = \frac{8a\tau}{27b} \\ &\implies \frac{3ab}{27b^2} \left(\Pi + \frac{3}{\nu^2} \right) \left(\nu - \frac{1}{3} \right) = \frac{8a\tau}{27b} \\ &\implies \boxed{\left(\Pi + \frac{3}{\nu^2} \right) \left(\nu - \frac{1}{3} \right) = \frac{8\tau}{3}} \end{aligned} \quad (16)$$

The above dimensionless Van der Waal's equation in terms of the reduced parameters, is independent of a and b and is thus *universal*, in the sense that, different gases are expected to follow the same equation. The generalisation is known as the *principle of corresponding states*, which says that all fluids when compared with respect to reduced parameters, have the same *compressibility factor*. The compressibility factor is defined as $Z = \frac{Pv}{k_B T}$, with the critical value predicted by Van der Waal to be,

$$Z_c = \frac{P_c v_c}{k_B T_c} = \frac{3ab}{27b^2 \times \frac{8a}{27b}} = \frac{3}{8} = 0.375$$

Experimentally, the critical value of the compressibility factor is found to be in the range $0.28 - 0.33$, thus, Van der Waal's equation does not provide an accurate quantitative estimate.

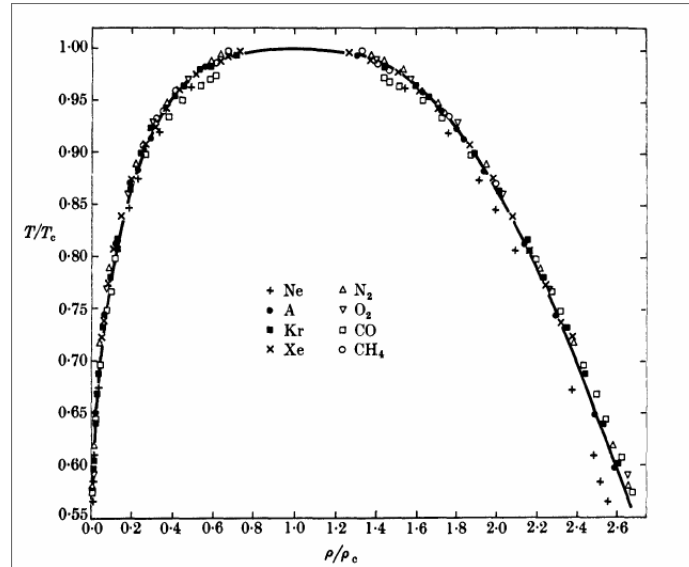


Figure 8: The Guggenheim plot for different gases with reduced parameter, showing that the trend follows a universal function (Source: Guggenheim (1945) [2]).

5.2. Critical Opalescence

Critical opalescence refers to an enhanced scattering of light by a substance in this critical region. Such enhanced scattering renders the substance milky white in reflected light.

As we know, at the critical point, $\mathcal{K}_T = -\frac{1}{V} \left(\frac{\partial V}{\partial P} \right)_T \rightarrow \infty$ since the slope of the isotherm is zero at the critical point. As $\mathcal{K}_T \propto \sigma_N$ where σ_N is the number fluctuations in the system, there is a huge number fluctuation, due to which the scattering of light is intensified.

5.3. Critical Point Behaviour

We will now discuss the behaviour of gases in the vicinity of the critical point to analyse universality. For $T > T_c$, there is always a unique volume corresponding to each pressure and hence, we can apply

Taylor expansion around v_c to write the pressure as,

$$P(T, v) = P(T, v_c) + \left. \frac{\partial P}{\partial v} \right|_T (v - v_c) + \frac{1}{2} \left. \frac{\partial^2 P}{\partial v^2} \right|_T (v - v_c)^2 + \frac{1}{6} \left. \frac{\partial^3 P}{\partial v^3} \right|_T (v - v_c)^3 + \mathcal{O} \left[\left(\frac{v - v_c}{v_c} \right)^4 \right]$$

Each of the coefficients are functions of temperature and hence, can be Taylor expanded about T_c .

$$\begin{aligned} P(T, v_c) &= \underbrace{P(T_c, v_c)}_{P_c} + \alpha(T - T_c) + \mathcal{O} \left[\left(\frac{T - T_c}{T_c} \right)^2 \right] \\ \left. \frac{\partial P}{\partial v} \right|_{T, v_c} &= \cancel{\left. \frac{\partial P}{\partial v} \right|_{T_c, v_c}}^0 - a(T - T_c) + \mathcal{O} \left[\left(\frac{T - T_c}{T_c} \right)^2 \right] \\ \left. \frac{\partial^2 P}{\partial v^2} \right|_{T, v_c} &= \cancel{\left. \frac{\partial^2 P}{\partial v^2} \right|_{T_c, v_c}}^0 + b(T - T_c) + \mathcal{O} \left[\left(\frac{T - T_c}{T_c} \right)^2 \right] \\ \left. \frac{\partial^3 P}{\partial v^3} \right|_{T, v_c} &= -c + \mathcal{O} \left[\left(\frac{T - T_c}{T_c} \right) \right] \end{aligned}$$

At the critical point the slope and the curvature vanishes and hence the first terms in the second and third equation is zero. Using the stability condition in Eq. (6), $a > 0$ for $T > T_c$ and $c > 0$. b can have any arbitrary sign¹. Let us put these expression in the original Taylor expansion.

$$P(T, v) = P_c + \alpha(T - T_c) - a(T - T_c)(v - v_c) + \frac{b}{2}(T - T_c)(v - v_c)^2 - \frac{c}{6}(v - v_c)^3 + \text{higher orders} \dots \quad (17)$$

From this, we can predict the following things about different quantities:

- Let us consider only upto linear order in $(T - T_c)$ and $(v - v_c)$, hence we neglect the fourth, fifth and higher order terms. This gives us an approximate analytic solution for the pressure,

$$\boxed{P(T, v) = P_c + \alpha(T - T_c) - a(T - T_c)(v - v_c)}$$

We obtain $\left. \frac{\partial P}{\partial v} \right|_{T_c} = -a(T - T_c)$ and hence the isothermal compressibility at v_c scales as,

$$\lim_{T \rightarrow T_c^+} \mathcal{K}(T, v_c) = -\frac{1}{v_c} \frac{\partial v}{\partial P} \sim \frac{1}{T - T_c}$$

Experimental results identify the exponent as $\gamma \approx 1.3$ where $\mathcal{K}(T, v_c) \sim (T - T_c)^{-\gamma}$.

- At $T = T_c$, the isotherm behaves as

$$P = P_c - \frac{c}{6}(v - v_c)^3 \implies (P - P_c) \sim (v - v_c)^3$$

Experimental results identify the exponent as $\delta \approx 5.0$ where $(P - P_c) \sim (v - v_c)^\delta$.

The above analysis cannot be applied for $T < T_c$ since then for each pressure, we have two volumes and Taylor expansion cannot be effectively applied. Let us do the analysis in an alternate way using Eq. (16). Consider the two volumes v_{liq} and v_{gas} for which the pressure is same at say some temperature T . Then, from the equation we can write,

$$\Pi = \frac{8\tau/3}{\nu_g - 1/3} - \frac{3}{\nu_g^2} = \frac{8\tau/3}{\nu_l - 1/3} - \frac{3}{\nu_l^2}$$

¹These a, b are not the ones appearing in the Van der Waal's equation.

From this we obtain,

$$8\tau \left[\frac{1}{\nu_g - 1} - \frac{1}{\nu_l - 1} \right] = 3 \left[\frac{1}{\nu_l^2} - \frac{1}{\nu_g^2} \right] = 3 \left[\frac{\nu_g^2 - \nu_l^2}{\nu_l^2 \nu_g^2} \right] \Rightarrow \tau = \frac{(3\nu_l - 1)(3\nu_g - 1)(\nu_l + \nu_g)}{8\nu_g^2 \nu_l^2}$$

Note that the equation is symmetric in ν_g and ν_l and $\nu_g = \nu_l = 1$ at the critical point, which implies that we can write

$$\nu_g = 1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} \quad \nu_l = 1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2}$$

where $\varepsilon \equiv \nu_g - \nu_l$. We substitute this in the expression for τ , leading us to

$$\tau = \frac{2(2 - \frac{3\varepsilon}{2})(2 + \frac{3\varepsilon}{2})}{8[(1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2})(1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2})]^2} = \frac{(4 - \frac{9\varepsilon^2}{4})}{4(1 - \frac{\varepsilon^2}{4})^2} = \left(1 - \frac{9\varepsilon^2}{16}\right) \left(1 - \frac{\varepsilon^2}{4}\right)^{-2} \approx \left(1 - \frac{9\varepsilon^2}{16}\right) \left(1 + \frac{\varepsilon^2}{2}\right) = 1 - \frac{\varepsilon^2}{16} + \mathcal{O}(\varepsilon^4)$$

Then substituting for the real variables, we have

$$(v_{\text{gas}} - v_{\text{liq}}) \sim (T_c - T)^{1/2}$$

Experimental results predict an exponent $\beta \approx 0.3$ where $(v_{\text{gas}} - v_{\text{liq}}) \sim (T_c - T)^\beta$.

Van der Waal's equation thus does not provide a perfect quantitative description of condensation, however, qualitative descriptions are more or less accurate. The exponents $\beta, \gamma, \delta \dots$ are called *critical exponents* and many people dedicate their lives in finding the numerical value of these exponents.

Lecture 06: Correlations and Fluctuations

In here, we discuss a bit about an important quantity, *the correlation function*, which is an important quantity to look at while studying phase transition. Recall from Eq. (1) that the density was given by a sum over delta functions. We define the *density-density correlation function* (or simply the correlation function) as,

$$\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r}, \mathbf{r}') = \langle [n(\mathbf{r}) - \langle n(\mathbf{r}) \rangle][n(\mathbf{r}') - \langle n(\mathbf{r}') \rangle] \rangle = \langle n(\mathbf{r})n(\mathbf{r}') \rangle - \langle n(\mathbf{r}) \rangle \langle n(\mathbf{r}') \rangle$$

where $n(\mathbf{r}) - \langle n(\mathbf{r}) \rangle$ denotes the fluctuation of the density from its average value and $\langle \cdot \rangle$ represent the *thermal (ensemble) average*, using the distribution. For translationally invariant system, we have $\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r}, \mathbf{r}') \equiv \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}')$ and also, $n(\mathbf{r}) = n(\mathbf{r}')$. Then the above equation can also be written as,

$$\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') = \langle n(\mathbf{r})n(\mathbf{r}') \rangle - n^2$$

where $\langle n(\mathbf{r}) \rangle = n$. As $|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}'| \rightarrow \infty$, that is, the distance between two particles become very large, we do expect them to be independent and no longer 'correlated'. Thus, $\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') \rightarrow 0$ as $|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}'| \rightarrow \infty$.

The correlation function kind of quantifies the fluctuations in the density. Earlier, we saw that the isothermal compressibility also characterises the number fluctuations. Then, these two must be related on some level. To see this, we note that

$$\begin{aligned} \langle (N - \langle N \rangle)^2 \rangle &= \left\langle \int d^3r \{n(\mathbf{r} - \langle n(\mathbf{r}) \rangle)\} \int d^3r' \{n(\mathbf{r}' - \langle n(\mathbf{r}') \rangle)\} \right\rangle \\ &= \int d^3r d^3r' \langle \{n(\mathbf{r} - \langle n(\mathbf{r}) \rangle)\} \{n(\mathbf{r}' - \langle n(\mathbf{r}') \rangle)\} \rangle = \int d^3r d^3r' \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') \end{aligned}$$

Introducing the variables $\mathbf{r}'' = \mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}'$ and $\mathbf{R} = \mathbf{r} + \mathbf{r}'$, the integral changes accordingly.

$$\langle (N - \langle N \rangle)^2 \rangle = \int d^3R \int d^3r'' \mathcal{G}(r'') = V \int d^3r'' \mathcal{G}(r'')$$

The number fluctuation can also be written as,

$$\langle (N - \langle N \rangle)^2 \rangle = \frac{\langle N \rangle^2 k_B T}{V} \mathcal{K}_T = \langle N \rangle n k_B T \mathcal{K}_T$$

Consider an ideal gas, with $PV = Nk_B T$ which gives us,

$$\left(\frac{\partial P}{\partial V}\right)_T = -\frac{Nk_B T}{V^2} \implies \kappa_T^\circ = -\frac{1}{V} \left(\frac{\partial V}{\partial P}\right) = \frac{V}{Nk_B T} = \frac{1}{nk_B T}$$

Using this, we can write the dimensionless compressibility as,

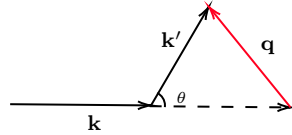
$$\left(\frac{\kappa_T}{\kappa_T^\circ}\right) = \frac{\langle (N - \langle N \rangle)^2 \rangle}{\langle N \rangle} = \frac{V \int d^3r \mathcal{G}(r)}{\langle N \rangle} = \frac{1}{n} \int d^3r \mathcal{G}(r)$$

The above is a very simple example of the *fluctuation-dissipation theorem* which relates the correlation to the linear response of the system (compressibility, in our case).

Since the isothermal compressibility diverges at T_c , the integral also diverges and this implies that the correlation function also becomes long ranged. The correlation length ξ (the characteristic length scale after which $\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r})$ decays) becomes as large as the wavelength of light and the density fluctuations scatter light strongly, resulting in critical opalescence, as mentioned in sec. 5.2.

6.1. Structure Factor

Let us now try to quantify the scattering intensity when our fluid is subjected to some radiation. Assume a *quasielastic scattering*, that is, the incoming radiation has much larger energy than the typical excitation energy of the system. Hence, the system can only absorb or emit very small amounts of energy and very small energy transfer occurs.



From elastic scattering, $|\mathbf{k}| \approx |\mathbf{k}'|$, the momentum transfer vector $\mathbf{q} = \mathbf{k}' - \mathbf{k}$ has a magnitude,

$$|\mathbf{q}| = \sqrt{|\mathbf{k}|^2 + |\mathbf{k}'|^2 - 2|\mathbf{k}||\mathbf{k}'|\cos\theta} \approx \sqrt{2|\mathbf{k}|^2(1 - \cos\theta)} = 2|\mathbf{k}|\sin\left(\frac{\theta}{2}\right)$$

Now, suppose that there are N particles in the target and the *scattering amplitude* for scattering from particle i is $a_i(\mathbf{q})$. Then the total intensity of the scattered radiation is given by,

$$\mathcal{I}(q) = \left\langle \left| \sum_{j=1}^N a_j(\mathbf{q}) \right|^2 \right\rangle$$

The scattering amplitude for particles at $\mathbf{r}_i$ and $\mathbf{r}_j$ are related just by a phase factor,

$$a_j(\mathbf{q}) = a_i(\mathbf{q}) e^{-i\mathbf{q} \cdot (\mathbf{r}_j - \mathbf{r}_i)}$$

Using this, we can write the intensity as,

$$\mathcal{I}(\mathbf{q}) = \left\langle \left| \sum_{j=1}^N a_1(\mathbf{q}) e^{-i\mathbf{q} \cdot (\mathbf{r}_j - \mathbf{r}_1)} \right|^2 \right\rangle = |a_1(\mathbf{q})|^2 \left\langle \left| \sum_{j=1}^N e^{-i\mathbf{q} \cdot (\mathbf{r}_j - \mathbf{r}_1)} \right|^2 \right\rangle = |a_1(\mathbf{q})|^2 \left\langle \left| \sum_{j=1}^N e^{-i\mathbf{q} \cdot \mathbf{r}_j} \right|^2 \right\rangle \quad (18)$$

as $|e^{i\mathbf{q} \cdot \mathbf{r}_1}| = 1$. If no correlations exist between the particles, then $\sum_j e^{-i\mathbf{q} \cdot (\mathbf{r}_j - \mathbf{r}_1)} = N + \sum_{j \neq 1} e^{-i\mathbf{q} \cdot (\mathbf{r}_j - \mathbf{r}_1)}$ and $\sum_{j \neq 1} \langle e^{-i\mathbf{q} \cdot (\mathbf{r}_j - \mathbf{r}_1)} \rangle \approx 0$ due to randomised phases which leads to,

$$\mathcal{I}^\circ(\mathbf{q}) = N|a_1(\mathbf{q})|^2$$

Then we can write the dimensionless intensity as,

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\mathcal{I}(\mathbf{q})}{\mathcal{I}^o(\mathbf{q})} &= \frac{1}{N} \left\langle \left(\sum_{j=1}^N e^{i\mathbf{q} \cdot \mathbf{r}_j} \right) \left(\sum_{i=1}^N e^{-i\mathbf{q} \cdot \mathbf{r}_i} \right) \right\rangle = \frac{1}{N} \left\langle \left(\sum_{i,j} e^{i\mathbf{q} \cdot (\mathbf{r}_j - \mathbf{r}_i)} \right) \right\rangle \\
&= \frac{1}{N} \int d^3r d^3r' \left\langle \left(\sum_{i,j} \delta^{(3)}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}_i) \delta^{(3)}(\mathbf{r}' - \mathbf{r}_j) e^{i\mathbf{q} \cdot (\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}')} \right) \right\rangle \\
&= \frac{1}{N} \int d^3r d^3r' \left\langle e^{i\mathbf{q} \cdot (\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}')} \left(\sum_{i,j} \delta^{(3)}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}_i) \delta^{(3)}(\mathbf{r}' - \mathbf{r}_j) \right) \right\rangle \\
&= \frac{1}{N} \int d^3r d^3r' e^{i\mathbf{q} \cdot (\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}')} \left\langle \left(\sum_i \delta^{(3)}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}_i) \right) \left(\sum_j \delta^{(3)}(\mathbf{r}' - \mathbf{r}_j) \right) \right\rangle \\
&= \frac{1}{N} \int d^3r d^3r' e^{i\mathbf{q} \cdot (\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}')} \langle n(\mathbf{r}) n(\mathbf{r}') \rangle \\
&= \frac{1}{N} \int d^3r d^3r' e^{i\mathbf{q} \cdot (\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}')} (\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') + n^2)
\end{aligned}$$

Again using the same variable substitution, we obtain

$$\frac{\mathcal{I}(\mathbf{q})}{\mathcal{I}^o(\mathbf{q})} = \frac{V}{N} \int d^3r e^{-i\mathbf{q} \cdot \mathbf{r}} \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r}) + \frac{V^2}{N} \int d^3r e^{-i\mathbf{q} \cdot \mathbf{r}} = \frac{V}{N} \int d^3r e^{-i\mathbf{q} \cdot \mathbf{r}} \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r}) + \frac{V^2 n^2}{N} \delta^{(3)}(\mathbf{q})$$

The last term contributes only when $\mathbf{q} = 0$ which is for $\theta = 0$ (forward-scattering) and is omitted in most cases. Hence, we define the structure factor $\mathcal{S}(\mathbf{q})$ as

$$\mathcal{S}(\mathbf{q}) = \frac{n\mathcal{I}(\mathbf{q})}{\mathcal{I}^o(\mathbf{q})} = \int d^3r e^{-i\mathbf{q} \cdot \mathbf{r}} \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r})$$

$\mathcal{S}(\mathbf{q})$ is just the spatial Fourier transform of the correlation function. $\mathcal{S}(\mathbf{q})$ becomes extremely large as we approach the critical point, for small values of $|\mathbf{q}|$.

Lecture 07: Introduction to Ising Model

The Ising model is a prototypical model to study phase transitions in magnetic systems. Since its fomulation by *Lenz* in 1920 and subsequent 1D solution by *Ising* and 2D solution by *Onsager*, Ising model has penetrated deep into all fields. The Ising model is defined fairly simply, by the Hamiltonian,

$$\mathcal{H} = -J \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} \sigma_i \sigma_j - h \sum_j \sigma_j \quad (19)$$

where $\sigma_j \in \{+1, -1\}$ is a random variable which is given an interpretation of a *classical spin*. J and h respectively denote the spin-coupling constant and the external field. The notation $\langle ij \rangle$ means that the spins i and j are nearest-neighbours. The Ising model provides interesting numerical and analytical artefacts till date which makes it an important system to study. The 1D solution is fairly simple, using a *transfer-matrix* method which is provided in Appendix B.

7.1. Mean-field solution

In the mean-field solution for the Ising model, we ‘throw’ away the fluctuations in each spin, which makes the spins interact with an ‘effective’ field resulting from the average orientation of the neighboring spins. Consider the identity,

$$(\sigma_i - \langle \sigma_i \rangle)(\sigma_j - \langle \sigma_j \rangle) = \sigma_i \sigma_j - \sigma_i \langle \sigma_j \rangle - \sigma_j \langle \sigma_i \rangle + \langle \sigma_i \rangle \langle \sigma_j \rangle \quad (20)$$

The LHS is zero since we are neglecting the spin fluctuations in the mean-field and hence the Ising Hamiltonian in Eq. (19) becomes,

$$\mathcal{H} = -J \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} \sigma_i \langle \sigma_j \rangle - J \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} \sigma_j \langle \sigma_i \rangle + J \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} \langle \sigma_i \rangle \langle \sigma_j \rangle - h \sum_i \sigma_i$$

Due to translation invariance, $\langle \sigma_i \rangle = \langle \sigma_j \rangle \equiv \langle \sigma \rangle$ and hence can be taken out of the sum.

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{H} &= -J \langle \sigma \rangle \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} \sigma_i - J \langle \sigma \rangle \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} \sigma_j + J \langle \sigma \rangle^2 \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} 1 - h \sum_i \sigma_i \\ &= -2J \langle \sigma \rangle \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} \sigma_i + J \langle \sigma \rangle^2 \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} 1 - h \sum_i \sigma_i \end{aligned}$$

For each spin σ_i , let us suppose that we have γ neighbours. Since the sums are now independent of j , these can be reduced to a sum over spins,

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} f(\sigma_i) &= \frac{1}{2} \sum_i f(\sigma_i) \sum_{j \in \text{NN}(i)} 1 \equiv \frac{\gamma}{2} \sum_i f(\sigma_i) \implies \mathcal{H} = -J\gamma \langle \sigma \rangle \sum_i \sigma_i + \frac{JN\gamma}{2} \langle \sigma \rangle^2 - h \sum_i \sigma_i \\ &= -h_{\text{eff}} \sum_i \sigma_i + \frac{JN\gamma}{2} \langle \sigma \rangle^2 \end{aligned} \quad (21)$$

where $h_{\text{eff}} = h + J\gamma \langle \sigma \rangle$ is kind of the *mean field* which is subjected to each spin. The Hamiltonian depends on $\langle \sigma \rangle$, however, given the Hamiltonian, we can also calculate $\langle \sigma \rangle$ from the partition function. This leads to a *self-consistent* equation which we need to tackle!

Lecture 08: Mean-field solution for Ising model

We will continue our discussion of the mean-field solution of the Ising model. Previously, we had reduced the Hamiltonian to a simplified expression, with an effective field.

$$\mathcal{H}_{\text{MF}} = -h_{\text{eff}} \sum_i \sigma_i + \frac{JN\gamma}{2} \langle \sigma \rangle^2 \quad (22)$$

This is simple to solve, since this is N independent spins in a field. The partition function is,

$$\mathcal{Z} = \sum_{\{\sigma_i\}} e^{\beta h_{\text{eff}} \sum_i \sigma_i} \cdot e^{-\beta \mathcal{E}_0} \quad (23)$$

where $\mathcal{E}_0 = \frac{J\gamma N}{2} \langle \sigma \rangle^2$. Since the particles are independent, the sum over spins can be simplified as,

$$\mathcal{Z} = \left[\sum_{\sigma \in \{-1, 1\}} e^{\beta h_{\text{eff}} \sigma} \right]^N \cdot e^{-\beta \mathcal{E}_0} = [2 \cosh(\beta h_{\text{eff}})]^N e^{-\beta \mathcal{E}_0}$$

From this, the free energy is obtained as,

$$F(T, h) = -k_B T \ln \mathcal{Z} = k_B T [\beta \mathcal{E}_0 - N \ln(2 \cosh \beta h_{\text{eff}})] = \mathcal{E}_0 - N k_B T \ln(2 \cosh \beta h_{\text{eff}})$$

From the free-energy, we can obtain the magnetisation,

$$\mathcal{M} = -\frac{\partial F}{\partial B} = N k_B T \tanh \beta h_{\text{eff}} \times \beta = N \tanh \beta h_{\text{eff}}$$

The magnetisation per spin is thus obtained as a *transcendental equation*,

$$\boxed{\langle \sigma \rangle = \frac{\mathcal{M}}{N} = \tanh(\beta J \gamma \langle \sigma \rangle + \beta h)} \quad (24)$$

We are interested in finding whether we have any spontaneous magnetisation in the system, that is, magnetisation without an external field. Thus, let us take the case when $h = 0$. Now, define $x := \frac{\langle \sigma \rangle}{\beta J \gamma}$, so that the equation changes to,

$$\frac{x}{\beta J \gamma} = \tanh x$$

Now, note that $\beta J \gamma$ should be dimensionless as x is dimensionless. This implies that $J \gamma$ should have dimension of $k_B T$. Let us define $k_B T_c := J \gamma$ which leads us to,

$$\left(\frac{T}{T_c}\right)x = \tanh(x)$$

Given a temperature T , the left-hand side is just an equation of a line, with slope $\frac{T}{T_c}$. Let us analyse the situation graphically.

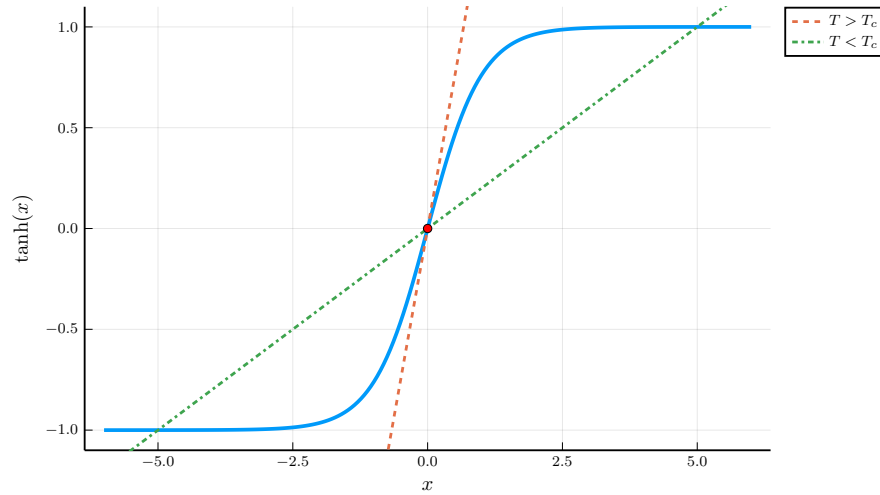


Figure 9: Graphical analysis of the transcendental equation

In Fig.9, we have plotted $\tanh(x)$ and two straight lines, with $T > T_c$ and $T < T_c$. For $T > T_c$, we see that the line does not cut $\tanh(x)$ at any point other than $x = 0$. However, for $T < T_c$, we see that two solutions exist, other than the trivial solution $x = 0$. As $\tanh(-x) = -\tanh(x)$, if one of the solution is $x = +x_0$, then the other solution is $x = -x_0$. A solution of x corresponds to a solution of $\langle \sigma \rangle$. Thus,

- $T > T_c$: $\langle \sigma \rangle = 0$ is the only solution and there is no spontaneous magnetisation.
- $T < T_c$: Apart from $\langle \sigma \rangle = 0$, we have two other solutions $\langle \sigma \rangle = \pm m_0$.

The mean-field solution, which predicts a finite critical temperature, is clearly wrong for the 1D case, where we know that no phase transition occur at any finite temperature. In 1D, the fluctuations are too strong to throw away, since there are only two nearest neighbours to interact with.

For the Ising model, two important things to note are *dimensionality* and lattice structure. However, in the mean-field Hamiltonian, γ (which is the only parameter depending on the topology of the lattice) cannot distinguish between these two factors. For example, for a cubic lattice in 3D, we have six nearest neighbours. Also, a triangular lattice in 2D has six nearest neighbours. Hence, these two lattices have the same γ , however, Ising dynamics in both the lattices are expected to be quite different.

Mean-field analysis becomes exact if we increase the dimensionality of the lattice and also if we increase the range of interaction, that is, we include higher order neighbours also. This ensures that the interaction between the spins is indeed an *effective interaction*.

Lecture 09: More on Ising Model

We have predicted a phase transition for the Ising model using mean-field approximation. However, the approximation seems to be inconsistent on many grounds, working well for higher dimensions and

long-range interactions. It predicted that in 1D too, Ising model has a spontaneous magnetisation at some finite temperature which cannot be. Even though we have solved the Ising system for dimension $d = 1$ in appendix. B (and it has been painfully solved by many stalwarts for $d = 2$ case too), let us see some arguments on why phase transitions cannot occur for 1D but it is possible in 2D Ising system.

9.1. Phase Transition in 1D Ising System

We will show that for $T > 0$ in $d = 1$ zero-field Ising Model, there exists no *long-range order*. Consider the ground state of the Ising model at $T = 0$, which is *ordered*, with all spins aligned in the same direction. Under open boundary conditions, this configuration has minimum energy $E_0 = -J(N - 1)$.

$$\dots \uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow \dots$$

The above configuration has entropy $S = 0$, since all the spins are aligned. Hence, the free energy of the system is $F_{\text{grnd}} = E - TS = -J(N - 1)$.

On increasing the temperature, the spins flip randomly due to interactions and this increases the energy of the system (since the interaction term is $-J(-1) = +J$ only if neighbouring spins are oppositely aligned). We need to check whether this destroys the long-range order. Now, consider a configuration with one *domain wall*¹ introduced at some point in the Ising chain, as shown in red below.

$$\dots \uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow \quad \text{---} \quad \downarrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow \dots$$

Introducing the domain wall increases the energy, due to the spins on either side of the domain wall.

$$E_{\text{dw}} = -J(N_+ - 1) - J(N_- - 1) - J(-1) = -J(N - 1) + 2J$$

Thus introducing one domain wall incurs a cost of $\Delta E = 2J$. Now, since there are N spins, this domain wall can be placed at any of the $(N - 1)$ positions. Then the entropy of the system with one domain wall is $S = k_B \ln(N - 1)$ and the free energy is $F_{\text{dw}} = -J(N - 1) + 2J - k_B T \ln(N - 1)$. The change in free energy is,

$$\Delta F = F_{\text{dw}} - F_{\text{grnd}} = 2J - k_B T \ln(N - 1)$$

In the thermodynamic limit $N \rightarrow \infty$ which implies that $\Delta F \rightarrow -\infty$. The system can always lower the free energy by creating a domain wall for any temperature $T > 0$. In fact, the free energy is further lowered by introducing arbitrary number of domain walls, until no domains remain at all. This implies that the long-ranged order is unstable and there is no spontaneous magnetisation at any finite temperature in the zero-field $d = 1$ Ising model.

9.2. Phase Transition in 2D Ising System (Peierls' Argument)

The situation becomes a bit different for $d = 2$ Ising model. To prove the existence of phase transition at a finite temperature in $d = 2$, consider a case where all the outer layer spins in the lattice are of the same type, say $\uparrow$. Now, consider the spin in the center of the lattice, highlighted yellow in Fig. 10.

¹In simple terms, a domain wall is an imaginary boundary which separates *domains*. Domains are regions with the same kind of spins, that is, all up or all down.

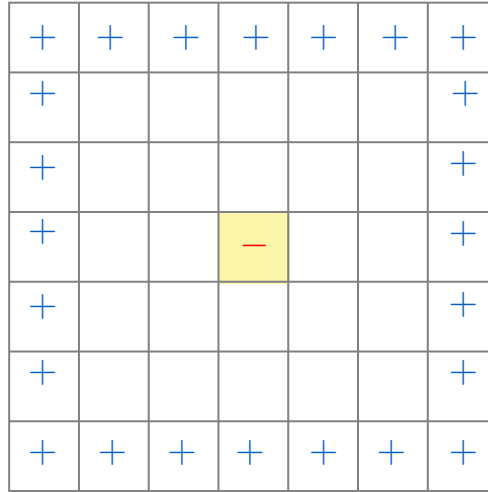


Figure 10: 2D Ising lattice; the outer layer have all same spins while the center spin is oppositely aligned with the outer spins.

If there is spontaneous magnetisation at some finite temperature, then the probability of the center spin to be oppositely aligned to the outer spins become zero (since the lattice becomes *ordered*). Also, note that the central spin is not particularly important and is just a representative of the bulk spin.

$$\Omega := \left\{ \begin{array}{|c|c|c|c|c|} \hline + & + & + & + & + \\ \hline + & & & & + \\ \hline + & & & & + \\ \hline + & & - & & + \\ \hline + & & & & + \\ \hline + & + & + & + & + \\ \hline \end{array} \right\} \supset \Omega_o := \left\{ \begin{array}{|c|c|c|c|c|} \hline + & + & + & + & + \\ \hline + & & & & + \\ \hline + & & & & + \\ \hline + & & - & & + \\ \hline + & & & & + \\ \hline + & + & + & + & + \\ \hline \end{array} \right\}$$

Now, consider Ω to be the set of all configurations where all the outer layers have spin $+$. Naturally, if we define Ω_o to be the set of all configurations where the central spin is $-$ and all the outer layers have spin $+$, we have $\Omega_o \subset \Omega$, as shown in the above figure. To have a phase transition is to show that the probability of any configuration $\{\sigma\} \in \Omega_o \rightarrow 0$ as $N \rightarrow \infty$.

To show that, we define a *shoreline* which is an imaginary closed loop separating $+$ spins from $-$ spins. So, along the boundary of the shoreline, we have all opposite spins on either side. A given shoreline thus separates spins σ_i and σ_j such that $\sigma_i \cdot \sigma_j = -1$. Note that, in the interior of the shoreline, there can be $+$ or $-$ spins.

We define another set of configurations, Ω_s in which every configuration has the central spin to be $-$ and all the outer layers have spin $+$. In addition to it, there is a *fixed* shoreline S surrounding the central spin. Clearly, $\Omega_s \subset \Omega_o$

$$\Omega_o := \left\{ \begin{array}{|c|c|c|c|c|} \hline + & + & + & + & + \\ \hline + & & & & + \\ \hline + & & - & & + \\ \hline + & & & & + \\ \hline + & + & + & + & + \\ \hline \end{array} \right\} \supset \Omega_s := \left\{ \begin{array}{|c|c|c|c|c|} \hline + & + & + & + & + \\ \hline + & & & & + \\ \hline + & & - & & + \\ \hline + & & & & + \\ \hline + & + & + & + & + \\ \hline \end{array} \right\}$$

Figure 11: The set of configurations showing the shoreline with a green line.

The probability of a configuration inside Ω_s is given by,

$$\text{Prob}(\{\sigma\} \in \Omega_s) = \frac{1}{\mathcal{Z}} \sum_{\{\sigma\} \in \Omega_s} e^{-\beta \mathcal{H}(\{\sigma\})} = \frac{1}{\mathcal{Z}} \sum_{\{\sigma\} \in \Omega_s} \exp \left(\beta J \sum_{\langle ij \rangle \in S} \sigma_i \sigma_j \right) \exp \left(\beta J \sum_{\langle ij \rangle \notin S} \sigma_i \sigma_j \right) \quad (25)$$

where we have broken the nearest neighbour sum into two parts: spins which are separated by the shoreline and spins which are not. Note that if the spins are separated by the shoreline, then $\sigma_i \sigma_j = -1$ and the sum is just $-n(S)$, where $n(S)$ denotes the *length* of the shoreline. Thus, the probability becomes,

$$\text{Prob}(\{\sigma\} \in \Omega_s) = \frac{1}{\mathcal{Z}} \sum_{\{\sigma\} \in \Omega_s} e^{-\beta J n(S)} \exp \left(\beta J \sum_{\langle ij \rangle \notin S} \sigma_i \sigma_j \right) \quad (26)$$

The remaining sum, where spins are not separated by the shoreline, is hard to calculate exactly and we need to find an estimate for that.

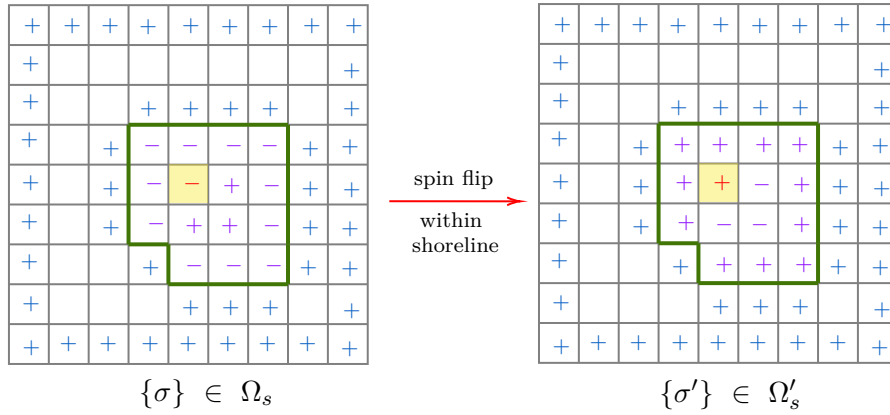


Figure 12: Flipping of all the spins inside the shoreline, taking $\sigma \rightarrow \sigma'$

We consider a specific configuration $\{\sigma\} \in \Omega_s$ and then flip all the spins in the inner side of the shoreline as shown in Fig. 12. We call this configuration $\{\sigma'\}$. If a spin in this configuration is outside the shoreline, then $\sigma_i = \sigma'_i$ since the spins outside the shoreline remains unchanged. If the spins belong inside the shoreline, then both spins have flipped and we have $\sigma'_i \sigma'_j = (-\sigma_i)(-\sigma_j) = \sigma_i \sigma_j$. If the spins are separated by shoreline, only one of the spins (which is in the inner side of the shoreline) changes and $\sigma'_i \sigma'_j = -\sigma_i \sigma_j = -(-1) = +1$. Thus we have,

$$\sum_{\langle ij \rangle} \sigma'_i \sigma'_j = \sum_{\langle ij \rangle \in S} \sigma'_i \sigma'_j + \sum_{\langle ij \rangle \notin S} \sigma'_i \sigma'_j = n(S) + \sum_{\langle ij \rangle \notin S} \sigma_i \sigma_j$$

Note that $n(S) > 0$ always which give us the inequality,

$$\sum_{\langle ij \rangle \notin S} \sigma_i \sigma_j = \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} \sigma'_i \sigma'_j - n(S) < \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} \sigma'_i \sigma'_j$$

Also note that $\sigma_i \rightarrow \sigma'_i$ is a one-to-one map and hence the sum of spins over Ω_s is equal to the sum of spins over Ω'_s . Using this and the estimate of the sum, Eq. (26) becomes,

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Prob}(\{\sigma\} \in \Omega_s) &< \frac{1}{\mathcal{Z}} \sum_{\{\sigma'\} \in \Omega'_s} e^{-\beta J n(S)} \exp \left[\beta J \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} \sigma'_i \sigma'_j \right] \\ &= \frac{e^{-\beta J n(S)}}{\mathcal{Z}} \sum_{\{\sigma'\} \in \Omega'_s} \exp \left[\beta J \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} \sigma'_i \sigma'_j \right] \end{aligned} \quad (27)$$

Now, the RHS is the sum over all configurations in Ω'_s . Since $e^x > 0$ for all x , this term is less than the sum over all the configurations $\{\sigma\} \in \Omega$. Thus,

$$\text{Prob}(\{\sigma\} \in \Omega_s) < e^{-\beta J n(S)} \frac{1}{\mathcal{Z}} \sum_{\{\sigma\} \in \Omega} \exp \left[\beta J \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} \sigma_i \sigma_j \right] = e^{-\beta J n(S)}$$

since the red term is just the definition of the partition function. Thus the probability of any configuration in Ω_s is less than $e^{-\beta J n(S)}$. However, we were interested in the situation where the configuration belonged to Ω_0 which can be obtained by summing over all such possible shorelines S .

$$\text{Prob}(\{\sigma\} \in \Omega_0) = \sum_{\{S\}} \text{Prob}(\Omega_s) < \sum_{\{S\}} e^{-\beta J n(S)}$$

Note that the length n of a shoreline can be $n = 4, 5, 6, \dots$. The minimum value is 4, for the shoreline which contains only the central spin and this length increases. Then the sum over shorelines can be written as,

$$\text{Prob}(\{\sigma\} \in \Omega_0) < \sum_{n=4}^{\infty} s(n) e^{-\beta J n}$$

where $s(n)$ denote the number of shorelines with length n . The final thing to do is to have an estimate for $s(n)$. For this, note that shorelines are closed curves. To form a shoreline, start from any point P . We can move in only three directions (not in four) since shorelines are self-avoiding, so we cannot move in the direction in which we had already formed a line.

The number of ways to form a shoreline of length n is thus $\sim 3^n$. Note that in this case, the choice of P was arbitrary and we can essentially start from any of the n points. Thus, the number of shorelines of length n is $s(n) \sim 3^n n$. Substituting this in the above expression,

$$\text{Prob}(\{\sigma\} \in \Omega_0) < \sum_{n=4}^{\infty} 3^n n e^{-\beta J n} \equiv \sum_{n=4}^{\infty} n r^n < \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n r^n \quad \text{where, } r = 3e^{-\beta J}$$

From the ratio test, we have

$$\lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \left| \frac{a_{k+1}}{a_k} \right| = \lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \left| \frac{(k+1)r^{k+1}}{k r^k} \right| = \lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \left(1 + \frac{1}{k} \right) |r| = |r|$$

and hence the sum converges if $|r| < 1 \implies e^{\beta J} > 3$. The value of the sum in the RHS is $\frac{r}{(r-1)^2}$ and hence,

$$\text{Prob}(\{\sigma\} \in \Omega_0) < \frac{r}{(r-1)^2} = \frac{3e^{-\beta J}}{(3e^{-\beta J} - 1)^2}$$

As $\beta \rightarrow \infty$ (corresponding to $T \rightarrow 0$), $\text{Prob}(\{\sigma\} \in \Omega_0) \rightarrow 0$ and hence for sufficiently low temperatures all spins in the systems tend to align even without an external magnetic field, proving the existence of a phase transition.

9.3. Symmetries of the Ising Model

The zero-field Ising Hamiltonian has an obvious symmetry of $\sigma_i \mapsto -\sigma_i$, which is broken if $h \neq 0$. In non-zero field, from Eq. (19), we can see that if $h \rightarrow -h$ and $\{\sigma\} \rightarrow \{-\sigma\}$, then the Ising Hamiltonian remains invariant.

$$\mathcal{H}(J, h, \{\sigma\}) = \mathcal{H}(J, -h, \{-\sigma\})$$

This is called the *time-reversal* symmetry or $\mathbb{Z}_2$ symmetry. Let us see what happens to the partition function under $h \rightarrow -h$.

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{Z}(-h, J, T) &= \sum_{\{\sigma\}} \exp[-\beta \mathcal{H}(-h, J, \{\sigma\})] \\ &= \sum_{\{\sigma\}} \exp[-\beta \mathcal{H}(-h, J, \{-\sigma\})] \\ &= \sum_{\{\sigma\}} \exp[-\beta \mathcal{H}(h, J, \{\sigma\})] = \mathcal{Z}(h, J, T) \end{aligned}$$

where in the second sum we used the fact that changing $\sigma \rightarrow -\sigma$ will not matter since we are summing over both -1 and $+1$ spins. The free energy is just the logarithm of the partition function, hence it also enjoys the symmetry,

$$F(-h, J, T) = F(h, J, T)$$

From the free energy, we obtain the magnetisation

$$\mathcal{M}(h) = -\frac{\partial F(h, J, T)}{\partial h} = -\frac{\partial F(-h, J, T)}{\partial h} = \frac{\partial F(-h, J, T)}{\partial(-h)} = -\mathcal{M}(-h) \quad (28)$$

From the above expression, if $h = 0$ then we have $\mathcal{M}(0) = 0$ for all temperatures, which apparently says that *phase transition is impossible in zero-field!*

This situation arises since we assumed the derivative of the free energy is well-behaved which is indeed true for finite systems, however, in the thermodynamic limit, F develops a kink for $T < T_c$ and hence $(\frac{\partial F}{\partial h})$ develops a discontinuity as shown in Fig. 13 (a)

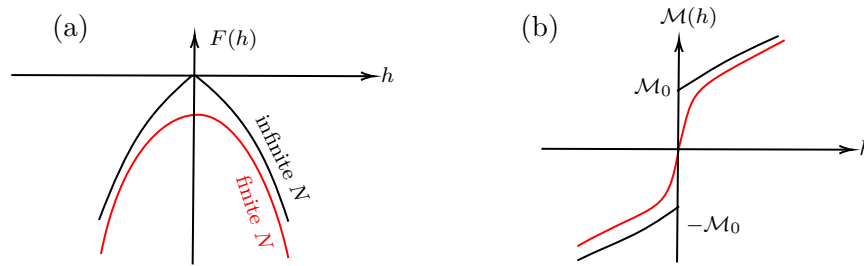


Figure 13: (a) Free energy and (b) Magnetisation behaviour in finite N and thermodynamic limit for $T < T_c$.

In the thermodynamic limit, near $h = 0$ the free energy behaves as,

$$F(h) = F(0) - \mathcal{M}_0|h| + \mathcal{O}(h^{q>1})$$

From this, if $h < 0$ then $\mathcal{M}(0^-) = -\mathcal{M}_0$ and if $h > 0$ then $\mathcal{M}(0^+) = +\mathcal{M}_0$ which is clearly discontinuous as shown in Fig. 13 (b). It is clear that if we take the thermodynamic limit first and then take $h \rightarrow 0$ and if we first take $h \rightarrow 0$ for a finite N and then take $N \rightarrow \infty$, we get two different behaviours. Thus, the limits do not commute.

$$\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \left(\frac{1}{N} \frac{\partial F(h)}{\partial h} \right) \neq \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \left(\frac{1}{N} \frac{\partial F(h)}{\partial h} \right)$$

9.3.1. Spontaneous Symmetry Breaking

When the Hamiltonian of the system has a particular symmetry but the statistical behavior of the system breaks that symmetry, we say that the symmetry is broken spontaneously. As seen before, the zero-field Ising Hamiltonian enjoys a $\mathbb{Z}_2$ symmetry, under the exchange $\{\sigma_i\} \rightarrow \{-\sigma_i\}$. For $T < T_c$ in the thermodynamic limit, we saw that

$$m = \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{N} \sum_i \langle \sigma_i \rangle \neq 0$$

Hence, at all temperature $\mathcal{H}$ has a symmetry under the exchange of spins but $\langle \sigma_i \rangle$ does not. Thus we say that the symmetry is spontaneously broken.

This is different from the uninteresting explicit symmetry breaking in the $h \neq 0$ case, where the Hamiltonian itself does not have the $\mathbb{Z}_2$ symmetry from beginning.

Spontaneous symmetry breaking seems a bit counterintuitive if we naively see a probabilistic viewpoint of the situation. Since the Hamiltonian has $\mathbb{Z}_2$ symmetry, the Boltzmann factor $P(\{\sigma\}) =$

$\frac{1}{Z} \exp(-\beta \mathcal{H}(\{\sigma\}))$ is also invariant under this symmetry. Then the expectation,

$$\langle \sigma_i \rangle = \sum_{\{\sigma\}} \sigma_i P(\{\sigma\}) = 0$$

The sum is zero because for a configuration $\{\sigma_i\}$, the opposite configuration $\{-\sigma_i\}$ will have the same Boltzmann factor, however, the σ_i factor in the sum will become $-\sigma_i$, which will cancel with the configuration. Thus, in the thermodynamic limit, we have to be careful with the calculation!

Consider the Ising model when $h \neq 0$. In this case, consider two configurations A and B which differ by the fact that all spins in configuration B are the flipped spins of configuration A . Due to the field term $-h \sum \sigma_i = -hNm$, the probability of these two contributions will be

$$\frac{P_A}{P_B} = \frac{\exp[\beta h N m]}{\exp[-\beta h N m]} \implies \frac{P_B}{P_A} = \exp[-2\beta h N m]$$

In the thermodynamic limit, for $h > 0$, $\frac{P_B}{P_A} \rightarrow 0$ and hence the system must be in configuration A , with magnetisation $+m$ for any $h > 0$ (in particular, true for $h \rightarrow 0^+$). For $h < 0$, $\frac{P_B}{P_A} \rightarrow \infty$ and hence the system must be in configuration B , with magnetisation $-m$ for any $h < 0$ (in particular, true for $h \rightarrow 0^-$).

Thus, in an infinitesimal field close to zero and in the thermodynamic limit, there is a large weight assigned to states with particular magnetisation $+m$ or $-m$, for $h > 0$ and $h < 0$ respectively. This is equivalent to setting $h = 0$ but taking a *restricted ensemble*, where we exclude the configurations with the ‘unpreferred’ magnetisation and thus, their Boltzmann weight is identically zero. Two such probability distribution can be defined P_+ and P_- based on the magnetisation values. I haven’t gone through the rigorous mathematical arguments for this, however, Goldenfeld advised to refer to [3], where this has apparently been dealt with rigor.

Lecture 10: Some more on Ising Model

In the previous section, we noted some properties based on the symmetry of the Ising model. Let us now continue our discussion on the mean field solution, focussing on critical exponents, that we previously saw in the phase transition in fluids.

10.1. Critical Exponents

Critical exponents are defined as the limiting *power-law* behaviour of some thermodynamic quantities near the critical point.

$$f(t) \sim t^\lambda \implies \lambda = \lim_{t \rightarrow 0} \frac{\ln f(t)}{\ln t}$$

The variable t is often taken to be the reduced temperature $t := \frac{\pm(T-T_c)}{T_c}$ depending on whether we want to approach from below or above T_c . The reduced temperature kinda is a measure of the distance from critical point. It is taken dimensionless so that different models can be compared.

The critical exponents for T_c^+ and T_c^- are found to be always equal, if they exist (Like for magnetisation, $m = 0$ for $T > T_c$ so no exponent can be obtained in that case and hence, magnetisation is approached only from below T_c).

From Eq. (24), the mean field magnetisation was written as $\langle \sigma \rangle = \tanh(\beta h + \beta J \gamma \langle \sigma \rangle)$. Let us denote $m = \langle \sigma \rangle$ and $\tau = \frac{T_c}{T} = \beta J \gamma$. In terms of the reduced temperature $t = \frac{T_c - T}{T_c}$, we have $\tau = \frac{1}{1-t}$. Using $\tanh(x) \simeq x - \frac{x^3}{3}$ for $x \ll 1$, we get

$$m = \tanh(\tau m) = \tanh\left(\frac{m}{1-t}\right) = \frac{m}{(1-t)} - \frac{m^3}{3(1-t)^3} + \dots$$

Solving this, we get $m = 0$ or $m^2 = (3t)(1-t)^2$. Note that for $T > T_c$, $t < 0$ while $(1-t)^2 > 0 \forall t$. Hence, m^2 comes out to be negative, which is not possible. Thus for $T > T_c$ we only have one solution $m = 0$. The non-zero magnetisation is thus interesting for us and let us check what is the scaling of this,

$$m^2 = (3t)(1-t)^2 = 3t + \mathcal{O}(t^2) \implies m \sim \pm(3t)^{1/2}$$

Thus we obtain the first critical exponent from the mean-field analysis,

$$m \sim \left(\frac{T_c - T}{T_c}\right)^\beta \quad \text{where, } \beta = \frac{1}{2}$$

Now, let us check what happens when $h \neq 0$, along the critical isotherm $T = T_c \implies \tau = 1$. For small m and $(h/k_B T_c) \ll m$, the magnetisation equation becomes,

$$\begin{aligned} m &= \tanh(\beta h + m) \simeq (\beta h + m) - \frac{1}{3}(\beta h + m)^3 + \dots \\ &= (\beta h + m) - \frac{m^3}{3} \left(\frac{3\beta h}{m} + 1 \right) + \dots \end{aligned}$$

From this we obtain a scaling between the field and magnetisation,

$$\beta h[1 - m^2] = \frac{m^3}{3} \implies h = \frac{m^3}{3\beta(1 - m^2)} = \frac{m^3}{3\beta} + \dots \implies h \sim m^3$$

We obtained the second critical exponent from the mean-field analysis,

$$m \sim h^{1/\delta} \quad \text{where, } \delta = 3$$

We will now deal with the third exponent, but we have to be more careful here, since this will have scaling both above and below T_c . For this, again consider the transcendental equation $m = \tanh(\beta h + \tau m)$ which, after expansion around small m and $h \ll m k_B T$, can be written as,

$$h = \frac{m(1 - \tau) + \frac{\tau^3 m^3}{3}}{\beta(1 - \tau^2 m^2)}$$

Differentiating and retaining terms only upto $\mathcal{O}(m^2)$,

$$\left(\frac{\partial h}{\partial m}\right)_T = \frac{m^2 \tau^2 + (1 - \tau)}{\beta(m^2 \tau^2 - 1)^2}$$

The denominator cannot provide any more m^2 term and hence upto $\mathcal{O}(m^2)$, the derivative is given by,

$$\left(\frac{\partial h}{\partial m}\right)_T = \frac{1}{\beta} \left[\frac{m^2}{(1-t)^2} - \frac{t}{(1-t)} \right]$$

For $T > T_c$, $m = 0$ and for $T < T_c$, $m^2 = 3t(1-t)^2$ as found before. Substituting this above, we get

$$\begin{aligned} \chi_+ &= \left(\frac{\partial m}{\partial h}\right)_{T_c^+} = \frac{\beta(t-1)}{t} = \frac{1}{k_B T} \left[1 - \frac{T_c}{T_c - T} \right] = \frac{1}{k_B(T - T_c)} \\ \chi_- &= \left(\frac{\partial m}{\partial h}\right)_{T_c^-} = \frac{\beta(1-t)}{t(2-3t)} \simeq \frac{\beta(1-t)}{2t} = \frac{1}{2k_B T} \left[\frac{T_c}{T_c - T} - 1 \right] = \frac{1}{2k_B(T_c - T)} \end{aligned}$$

We obtained the scaling of the susceptibility,

$$\begin{aligned} \chi_+ &\sim (T - T_c)^{-\gamma'} \quad \text{where, } \gamma' = 1 \\ \chi_- &\sim (T_c - T)^{-\gamma} \quad \text{where, } \gamma = 1 \end{aligned}$$

For $T \gg T_c$ then $\chi_+ \sim \frac{1}{T}$, in accordance with Curie's law. We see that $\gamma = \gamma'$ and hence, approach from both side of the critical point is the same. Also, $\frac{\chi_+}{\chi_-} = 2$ which is called the *amplitude ratio*.

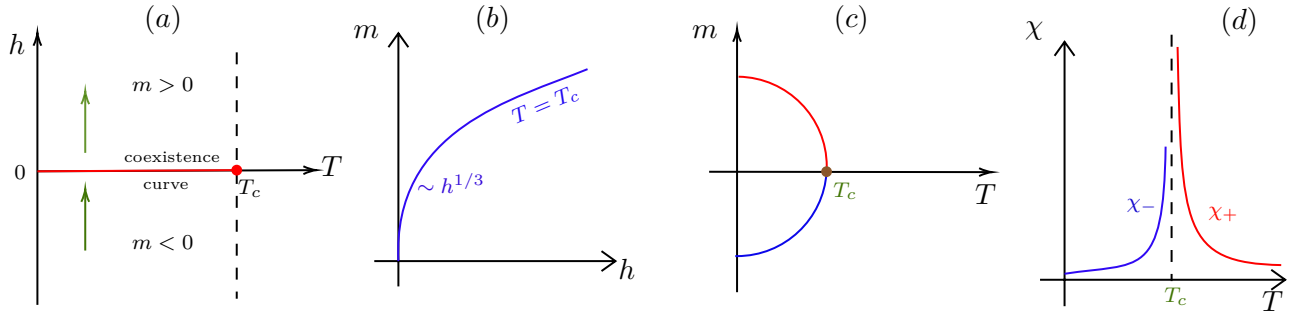


Figure 14: Scaling of various quantities in Ising model

Fig. 14 (a) shows the Ising model phase diagram. For low temperatures $T < T_c$, the system undergoes a discontinuous phase transition in which m changes abruptly as it crosses from $h < 0$ to $h > 0$, denoting a first-order transition. Shown in red is the *coexistence curve*, which ends at T_c . Beyond T_c , m changes continuously across the $h < 0$ to $h > 0$ transition.

As we vary T for a fixed h , the magnetisation varies smoothly as shown in Fig. 14 (c) until T_c , after which it becomes zero. The Ising model shows a first-order transition as a function of h but a second-order transition as a function of T .

10.2. Bragg-Williams Approximation

This is kind of an alternate mean-field description of the Ising model. Consider the Ising lattice containing N spins, with say, N_+ up spins and N_- down spins. Then the average magnetisation is given by,

$$m = \frac{N_+ - N_-}{N_+ + N_-} = \frac{2N_+ - N}{N} \implies \frac{N_+}{N} = \frac{1}{2}(m + 1)$$

The entropy of the system is defined as the number of ways by which a configuration with magnetisation m can be produced. Hence, out of N spins, we choose N_+ spins and the rest are set to N_- , which gives us,

$$\Omega(N_+, N_-) = \frac{N!}{N_+! N_-!} = \frac{N!}{\left(\frac{N(1+m)}{2}\right)! \left(\frac{N(1-m)}{2}\right)!} \quad S = k_B \ln \Omega(N_+, N_-)$$

Using Sterling's approximation, $\ln N! \approx N \ln N - N$ we obtain,

$$\begin{aligned} \ln \Omega &\approx (N \ln N - N) - \frac{N(1+m)}{2} \ln \left(\frac{N(1+m)}{2} \right) - \frac{N(1-m)}{2} \ln \left(\frac{N(1-m)}{2} \right) + N \\ &= N \left[\ln N - \frac{(1+m)}{2} \ln \left(\frac{N(1+m)}{2} \right) - \frac{(1-m)}{2} \ln \left(\frac{N(1-m)}{2} \right) \right] \\ &= N \left[\ln N - \frac{(1+m)}{2} \ln(1+m) - \frac{(1-m)}{2} \ln(1-m) - \ln N - \ln 2 \right] \\ &= N \left[\ln 2 - \frac{1+m}{2} \ln(1+m) - \frac{1-m}{2} \ln(1-m) \right] \end{aligned}$$

The mean-field energy of the Ising model is given by,

$$U = -\frac{J\gamma N m^2}{2} - N h m$$

We can now calculate the free energy and minimise it to find the equation of state.

$$F(T, m, N) = U - TS = -\frac{J\gamma N m^2}{2} - N h m - N k_B T \left[\ln 2 - \frac{1+m}{2} \ln(1+m) - \frac{1-m}{2} \ln(1-m) \right]$$

which implies that,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial F}{\partial m} &= -JN\gamma m - Nh + \frac{Nk_B T}{2} [1 + \ln(1+m) - 1 - \ln(1-m)] = -JN\gamma m - Nh + \frac{Nk_B T}{2} \ln \frac{1+m}{1-m} = 0 \\ \Rightarrow \frac{1+m}{1-m} &= e^{2\beta(J\gamma m + h)} \Rightarrow m = \frac{e^{2\beta(J\gamma m + h)} - 1}{e^{2\beta(J\gamma m + h)} + 1} = \frac{e^{\beta(J\gamma m + h)} - e^{-\beta(J\gamma m + h)}}{e^{\beta(J\gamma m + h)} + e^{-\beta(J\gamma m + h)}} = \tanh(\beta(J\gamma m + h)) \end{aligned}$$

Thus we obtained the same previous self-consistent equation $m = \tanh(\beta J\gamma m + \beta h)$ from this method.

10.3. Towards the Landau free energy

Instead of writing the Ising partition function $\mathcal{Z}(T, h, N)$ as a sum over all spin configurations, we can write it as a sum over all possible magnetisations m . We can write,

$$\mathcal{Z}(T, h, N) = \sum_m \sum_{\{\sigma\}|m} e^{-\beta \mathcal{H}(\{\sigma\}, N, h)} \approx \sum_m \Omega(m, N) e^{-\beta \mathcal{H}_{\text{MF}}(m, N, h)}$$

where $\Omega(m, N)$ is just the *degeneracy factor*, which tells us how many states are there with magnetisation m and $\mathcal{H}_{\text{MF}}$ is the mean-field Hamiltonian from Eq. (22). The above sum can be approximated by an integral from -1 to 1 , taking magnetisation to be continuous:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{Z}(T, h, N) &= \int_{-1}^1 dm \Omega(m, N) e^{-\beta \mathcal{H}_{\text{MF}}(m, N, h)} \\ &= \int_{-1}^1 dm e^{\ln \Omega(m, N)} e^{-\beta \mathcal{H}_{\text{MF}}(m, N, h)} \\ &= \int_{-1}^1 dm e^{\ln \Omega(m, N) - \beta \mathcal{H}_{\text{MF}}(m, N, h)} \\ &= \int_{-1}^1 dm e^{-\beta N \left(\frac{-J\gamma m^2}{2} - mh - \frac{k_B T}{N} \ln \Omega(m, N) \right)} \end{aligned} \tag{29}$$

The blue term feels like some kind of thermodynamic potential but it depends both on m and h . Hence this is some kind of pseudo-free energy called the *Landau free energy* denoted by $\mathcal{L}(m, h)$,

$$\mathcal{L}(m, h) = -\frac{\gamma J m^2}{2} - mh - k_B T \ln 2 + \frac{k_B T}{2} [(1+m) \ln(1+m) + (1-m) \ln(1-m)]$$

From saddle-point approximation, the integral will take the value at $m = m^*$, such that $N\mathcal{L}(m^*, h)$ is minimum. Thus,

$$\left. \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial m} \right|_{m^*} = -\gamma J m^* - h + \frac{k_B T}{2} [1 + \ln(1+m^*) - 1 - \ln(1-m^*)] = 0$$

From this we obtain the same transcendental equation $\tanh(\beta h + \beta J\gamma m) = m$ as before. Let us see some insights from the plot of the Landau free energy.

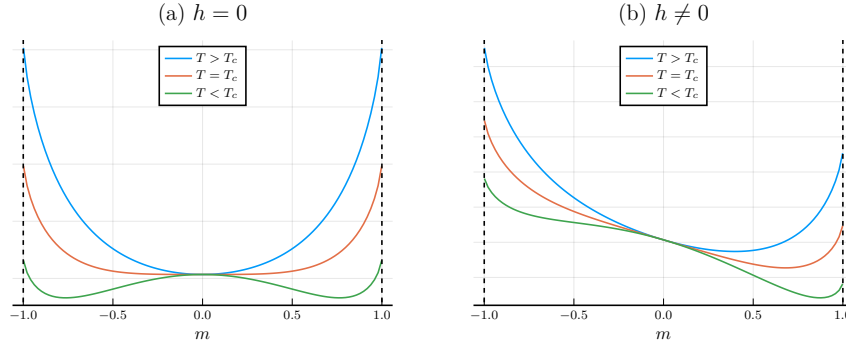


Figure 15: $\mathcal{L}$ vs. m at different temperature regimes. The curves have been appropriately shifted so that $\mathcal{L}(m=0) = 0$

Fig. 15 (a) shows the variation of $\mathcal{L}(m)$ as m is varied between -1 and $+1$. For the zero-field case, $\mathcal{L}$ is symmetric about $m = 0$. For $T > T_c$ we have only one minima at $m = 0$ and for $T < T_c$ we have two minima at $\pm m_0$ while $m = 0$ is a local maxima. The second derivative of the Landau free energy at $m = 0$

$$\left. \frac{\partial^2 \mathcal{L}}{\partial m^2} \right|_{m=0} = -\gamma J + \frac{k_B T}{2} \left[\frac{1}{1+m} + \frac{1}{1-m} \right] \bigg|_{m=0} = -J\gamma + k_B T \implies \left. \frac{\partial^2 \mathcal{L}}{\partial m^2} \right|_{m=0, T=T_c} = 0$$

from our definition of $k_B T_c = J\gamma$. Thus, for all values of h , $m = 0$ is an *inflection point* for $T = T_c$ where the curvature disappears, as is evident in Fig. 15.

For $T < T_c$, $\mathcal{L}$ has two degenerate minima for $h = 0$. However, when we take $h \neq 0$ then these minima becomes non-degenerate, one becomes the stable minima and one becomes the metastable one (depending on the sign of h). On increasing h , the magnetisation metastable minima keeps getting shallower and at some $h = h^*$ (called the *spinodal field*), it disappears completely as shown in Fig. 16. The condition for this is that $\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial m} = 0$ and $\frac{\partial^2 \mathcal{L}}{\partial m^2} = 0$, which gives us

$$m - \tanh(\beta h + \beta J\gamma m) = 0 \quad 1 - \beta J\gamma \operatorname{sech}^2(\beta h + \beta J\gamma m) = 0$$

Using $\operatorname{sech}^2(\beta h + \beta J\gamma m) = 1 - \tanh^2(\beta h + \beta J\gamma m)$ we obtain $m^* = \pm \sqrt{1 - \frac{1}{\beta J\gamma}}$. What happens is that, for $h > 0$ the metastable minima is at $m < 0$ and this is given by $m^* = -\sqrt{1 - \frac{1}{\beta J\gamma}}$ while for $h < 0$, $m^* = +\sqrt{1 - \frac{1}{\beta J\gamma}}$ is the metastable magnetisation. From these *spinodal magnetisation*, we obtain the spinodal fields by substituting this in the expression of $\beta h = \tanh^{-1}(m) - \beta J\gamma m$ according to whether $h < 0$ or $h > 0$.

$$\beta h^* = \frac{1}{2} \ln \left[\frac{1+m^*}{1-m^*} \right] - \beta J\gamma m^*$$

Hence to summarise, we have the following cases:

- $h = 0 \longrightarrow$ degenerate, equally likely minima at $\pm m_0$ for $T < T_c$.
- $h \neq 0, h < h^* \longrightarrow$ one stable and one metastable minima.
- $h \neq 0, h > h^* \longrightarrow$ only one stable minima.

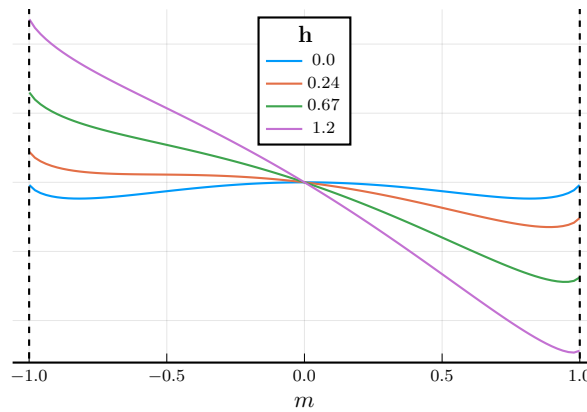


Figure 16: $\mathcal{L}$ vs. m for different values of h at $T < T_c$. On increasing h , the metastable minima at $m < 0$ disappears.

The metastable state exists only between $(-h^*, +h^*)$. At $T = T_c$ we have $\beta J\gamma = 1$ which implies $m^* = 0$ and hence $\pm h^*$ coalesce to the same point. The phase diagram for h vs. T is shown below:

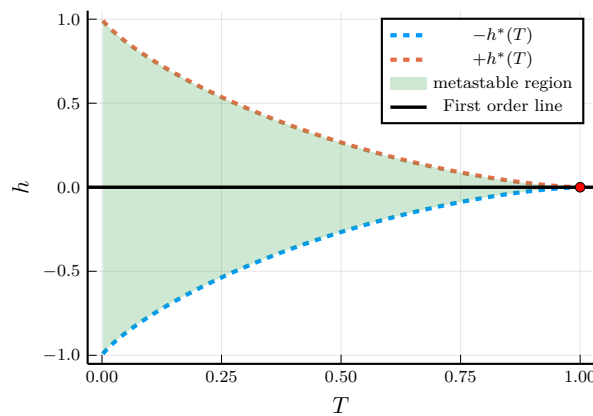


Figure 17: Phase diagram for h and T . The blue shaded region denotes the states (h, T) where the metastable regions exist. The black line denotes the first order phase coexistence curve, ending at T_c . Here T_c is taken to be 1 for the simulation.

10.4. Hysteresis

On varying the magnetic field at some fixed temperature $T < T_c$, we obtain a hysteresis in the Ising model. Suppose we start with a high negative value of $h \gg -|h^*|$. In this case, only one *global minima* is present (see Fig. 18 (a)). As we decrease the field magnitude (take the field towards zero), then at $h = -|h^*|$, the metastable minima will appear, but the system will be sitting in the global minima. At $h = 0$, the global and the metastable minima will become degenerate. On increasing h further in the positive side, the previous global minima now become the metastable minima.

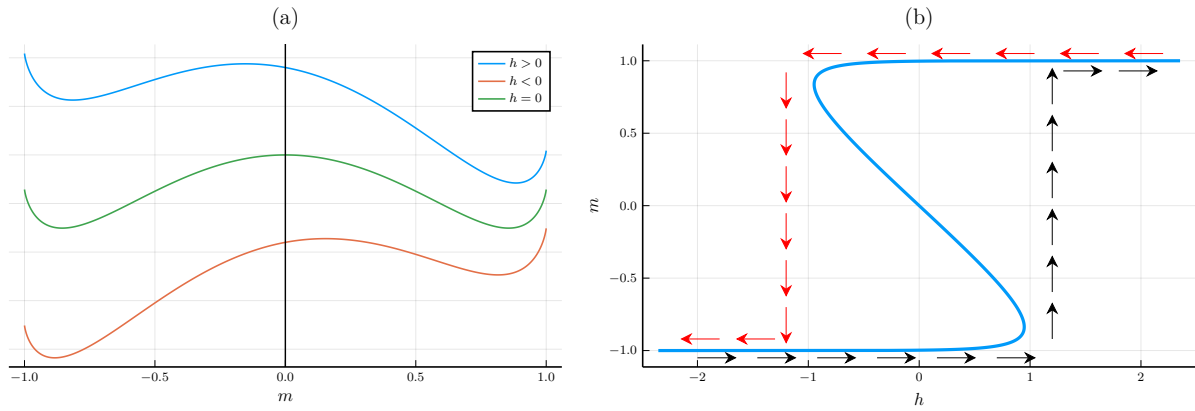


Figure 18: Hysteresis curve from mean-field theory. (a) $\mathcal{L}(m)$ vs. m in different field regimes. The global minima shifts on moving h from negative to positive. (b) Magnetisation vs. h curve, showing the hysteresis loop.

The system should technically be sitting in the global minima, however, since it was previously occupying the other minima (which has now become metastable), due to some kind of *inertia*, it still stays in the metastable state, which happens until h hits $+|h^*|$. After that, the metastable minima disappears and the system is forced to relocate to the global minima.

As shown in Fig. 18 (b), the black arrows traverse the path when we start from $h < 0$ while the red arrows show the same when starting from $h > 0$. We can see that the paths are not the same and the resulting $m(h)$ curve is not reversible in time. This is the characteristic case of *hysteresis*!

Lecture 11: Landau Theory for Phase Transition: I

We move on to a formal description of the process encountered in the previous lecture. Here, we will be doing away with the microscopic details. Although, time and again, we will be taking the Ising model as our basis to build intuition and stuff, the method can be possibly generalised to other systems. We will define the system in terms of an *order parameter* which we will take to be a scalar. However, order parameters can literally be *anything* as long as it can distinguish between two phases.

11.1. Order Parameter

Order parameters can be scalars, or in general tensors or an element from a group, it can be real or complex; there is a lot of diversity. The basic necessity is that, it should distinguish between phases. It is usually zero in the unordered phase and non-zero in the ordered phase. For example, in the *Heisenberg model* with the Hamiltonian,

$$\mathcal{H} = -J \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} \boldsymbol{\sigma}_i \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}_j - \mathbf{h} \cdot \sum_i \boldsymbol{\sigma}_i \quad (30)$$

where the spins on the lattice are *vectors*, the magnetisation $\mathbf{M}$ is a vector, such that $\mathbf{M} = 0$ for $T > T_c$ and $\mathbf{M} = M\hat{\mathbf{n}}$, pointing in some arbitrary direction $\hat{\mathbf{n}}$ for $T < T_c$.

For the superfluid transition in ^3He , the order parameter is something called a *pairing amplitude* which is kinda a complex matrix and has to do with formation of Cooper pairs. In superconductors, the energy gap Δ is often taken to be the order parameter. In fluid systems, as seen before, we took the density difference between the phases to be the order parameter. In each of these, the number of components in the order parameter are different.

11.2. Expanding the energy

The Landau theory has to do with expanding a function $\mathcal{L}$ in powers of the *order parameter*. The function $\mathcal{L}$ must obey the symmetry of the system. With all our might we write the phenomenological expansion,

$$\mathcal{L} = \sum_{i=0}^{\infty} a_i(\{K\}, T) m^i \quad (31)$$

where $\{K\}$ denote the set of couplings in the model (for example, in the Ising model, J was our coupling constant and also h , kinda). The expansion in itself is not that helpful, unless we do something stupid with it. We expect that m should be small in and around T_c and hence we truncate the expansion upto m^4 , leaving us with the quartic free energy,

$$\mathcal{L} = a_0 + a_1 m + a_2 m^2 + a_3 m^3 + a_4 m^4$$

For the time being, let us consider the $\mathbb{Z}_2$ symmetry case as in zero-field Ising model. Thus, $\mathcal{L}(m) = \mathcal{L}(-m)$ which forces the odd terms to be zero viz. $a_1 = a_3 = 0$. Moreover, we want $\mathcal{L}$ to be bounded below, since we hope to extract physical insights from minimising the free energy. If $\mathcal{L}$ has no finite minima, then we can arbitrarily make that small by taking $\eta \rightarrow \infty$ which is unphysical. Thus, $a_4 > 0$ is taken to make $\mathcal{L}$ bounded below.

All the coefficients here are dependent on temperature and the coupling. In the unordered phase, $m = 0$ and hence a_0 denotes the value of $\mathcal{L}$ in the disordered phase. Since this coefficient is independent of the order parameter, we can think of this as a *smooth background field*, containing the irrelevant degrees of freedom, upon which the phase transition stuff is superimposed. We set $a_0 = 0$, that's it! We expand the remaining coefficients with respect to the reduced temperature, $t = \frac{T-T_c}{T_c}$:

$$\begin{aligned} a_2 &= a_2^{(0)} + a_2^{(1)} t + \mathcal{O}(t^2) \\ a_4 &= a_4^{(0)} + a_4^{(1)} t + \mathcal{O}(t^2) \end{aligned} \quad (32)$$

We don't need a_4 upto the linear term also, since a_4 comes with m^4 , which is itself assumed to be tiny. So, we just take a_4 to be some positive constant. We now minimise $\mathcal{L}$, hoping to get some insights.

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial m} = 2a_2 m + 4a_4 m^3 = 0 \implies m = 0 \quad \text{or} \quad m = \sqrt{-\frac{a_2}{2a_4}} \quad (33)$$

We assume m to be continuous across the transition, and hence $a_2(T_c) \rightarrow 0$, which implies that $a_2^{(0)} = 0$. To summarise, with all our assumptions, we get the expression for the Landau free energy upto m^4 to be,

$$\mathcal{L} = a_2(T - T_c)m^2 + a_4 m^4 \quad (34)$$

where we have redefined the constants a_2 and a_4 by absorbing some constants. Let us now add the magnetic field term h , which breaks the $\mathbb{Z}_2$ symmetry. The simplest way to incorporate this is through a linear term. The free energy can then be written as,

$$\mathcal{L} = \frac{a_2}{2}(T - T_c)m^2 + \frac{a_4}{4}m^4 - mh \quad (35)$$

Minimising this gives us,

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial m} = a_2(T - T_c)m + a_4 m^3 - h = 0 \implies \boxed{a_2(T - T_c)m + a_4 m^3 = h}$$

which is the equation of state. It is a cubic equation with potentially three roots.

11.3. Finding Critical Exponents

Suppose $h = 0$. Then, from minimising $\mathcal{L}$ we get,

$$m = 0 \quad m = \left(-\frac{a_2}{a_4}(T - T_c) \right)^{1/2} \sim (T - T_c)^{1/2} \quad (36)$$

We can easily see from here that the critical exponent $\beta = \frac{1}{2}$. Now, suppose $h \neq 0$. Then at $T = T_c$ we have $a_4 m^3 = h \implies m \sim h^{1/3}$ which gives us the critical exponent $\delta = \frac{1}{3}$. From the equation of state, we find that

$$\frac{\partial h}{\partial m} = a_2(T - T_c) + 3a_4 m^2 \implies \frac{\partial m}{\partial h} = \frac{1}{a_2(T - T_c) + 3a_4 m^2}$$

For $T > T_c$, we have $m^* = 0$ and for $T < T_c$ we have $m^* = \sqrt{-\frac{a_2}{a_4}(T - T_c)}$, using which we can obtain the zero-field susceptibility,

$$\chi_{T_c^+} = \frac{1}{a_2(T - T_c)} \implies \gamma' = 1$$

$$\chi_{T_c^-} = \frac{1}{a_2(T - T_c) - 3a_4 \cdot \frac{a_2}{a_4}(T - T_c)} = \frac{1}{2a_2(T_c - T)} \implies \gamma = 1$$

The last exponent comes from the susceptibility which can be obtained from the specific heat $C_v = -T \frac{\partial^2 \mathcal{L}}{\partial T^2}$ for $h = 0$. For $T > T_c$, $\mathcal{L} = 0$ as $m^* = 0$. For $T < T_c$ we have,

$$\mathcal{L} = -\frac{a_2^2}{2a_4}(T - T_c)^2 + \frac{a_2^2}{4a_4}(T - T_c)^2 = -\frac{a_2^2}{2a_4}(T - T_c)^2 \implies C_v = \frac{a_2^2}{a_4}T$$

Thus, between T_c^+ and T_c^- , we have $\Delta C = \frac{a_2^2}{a_4}T_c > 0$ and thus there is a discontinuity in the specific heat. It is clear from here that $\alpha = 0$ which is the remaining critical exponent.

Lecture 12: Landau Theory for Phase Transition: II

We now add a cubic term to the free energy, which will lead to a first order transition.

12.1. First Order Transition

$$\mathcal{L} = \frac{1}{2}a_2(T - T_c)m^2 - \frac{1}{3}a_3m^3 + \frac{1}{4}a_4m^4 \quad a_4, a_2 > 0 \quad (37)$$

We can assume the $a_3 > 0$, if not, define $m' = -m$. The free energy no longer enjoys the $\mathbb{Z}_2$ symmetry. Minimising the free energy gives us,

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial m} = a_2(T - T_c)m - a_3m^2 + a_4m^3 = 0 \implies m = 0 \quad \text{or} \quad a_4m^2 - a_3m + a_2(T - T_c) = 0$$

The quadratic part gives us two solutions, namely,

$$m_{\pm} = \frac{a_3}{2a_4} \pm \sqrt{\left(\frac{a_3}{2a_4} \right)^2 - \frac{a_2}{a_4}(T - T_c)}$$

From this, we see that if $a_3^2 < 4a_2a_4(T - T_c)$ then the above two solutions become complex and we are left with only $m = 0$ as the real solution. If $a_3^2 > 4a_2a_4(T - T_c) \implies T < T_c + \frac{a_3^2}{4a_2a_4}$, then we have three real solutions. Let us denote $T^* = T_c + \frac{a_3^2}{4a_2a_4} > T_c$, which implies that even above T_c , for T satisfying $T_c < T < T^*$, three solutions do appear.

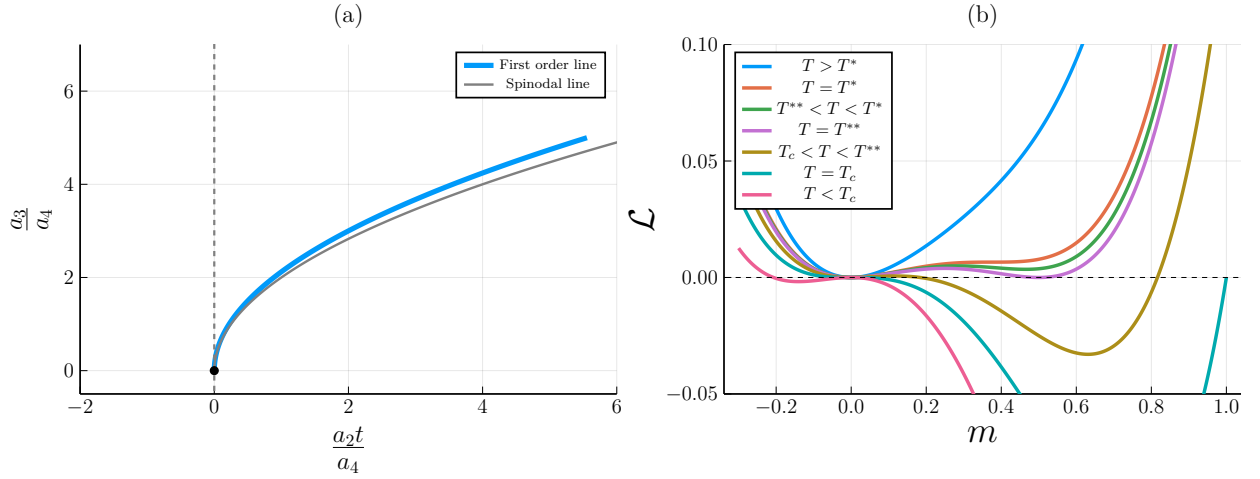


Figure 19: Landau free energy $\mathcal{L}$ with the cubic term. (a) Phase diagram in the a_3 vs. t plane. The blue line denotes the first order line $a_3^2 = (9/2)a_2a_4t$ while the dashed grey line denotes the spinodal line $a_3^2 = 4a_2a_4t$ (b) Behaviour of $\mathcal{L}$ in different temperature regime.

Okay, now let us see the position of these three extremas. Note that $m_+ > m_-$ and $m_+ > 0$ from the form of the expression, so only the position with respect to zero needs to be ascertained for m_- . If we want $m_- > 0$, then

$$\left(\frac{a_3}{2a_4}\right)^2 > \left(\frac{a_3}{2a_4}\right)^2 - \frac{a_2}{a_4}(T - T_c) \implies T > T_c$$

Thus, for $T > T_c$ we have $m_+ > m_- > 0$ and for $T < T_c$ we have $m_- < 0 < m_+$. The position of the extremas are fixed. Now, let's look at the curvature.

$$\frac{\partial^2 \mathcal{L}}{\partial m^2} = a_2(T - T_c) - 2a_3m + 3a_4m^2$$

At $m = 0$, $\frac{\partial^2 \mathcal{L}}{\partial m^2} = a_2(T - T_c)$ which implies that for $T < T_c$ we have a maxima at $m = 0$ and for $T > T_c$, there's a minima at $m = 0$. From these facts, we have:

- For $T < T_c$, $m_{\pm}$ are the minima and $m = 0$ is the maxima.
- For $T > T_c$, m_+ and $m = 0$ are the minima and m_- is the maxima.

Let us now see how the free energy behaves for different values of $T > T_c$, to ascertain which extremas are global. At $m = 0$, we always have an minima and hence, to find the global things, we need to compare the other extremas with $\mathcal{L}(m = 0)$, so we look at the case when $\mathcal{L}(0) = \mathcal{L}(m_+)$ (since m_- is the maxima, we do not care about it). This is equivalent to simultaneously satisfying the two equations for $m \neq 0$,

$$\mathcal{L}(m) = 0 \quad \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial m} = 0$$

Eliminating m^2 from these equations and defining $\epsilon = T - T_c$, leaves us with,

$$4\left(\frac{1}{3}a_3m - \frac{1}{2}a_2\epsilon\right) - a_3m + a_2\epsilon = 0$$

from which we get, $m = \frac{3a_2\epsilon}{a_3}$. Now, this m must be equal to m_+ , since this is the minima.

$$\begin{aligned}
&\Rightarrow \left(\frac{3a_2}{a_3}\epsilon - \frac{a_3}{2a_4} \right)^2 = \left(\frac{a_3}{2a_4} \right)^2 - \frac{a_2}{a_4}\epsilon \\
&\Rightarrow \left(\frac{3a_2}{a_3} \right)^2 \epsilon^2 - \frac{3a_2}{a_4}\epsilon = -\frac{a_2}{a_4}\epsilon \\
&\Rightarrow \frac{9a_2}{a_3^2\epsilon} = \frac{2}{a_4} \\
&\Rightarrow \boxed{a_3^2 = \frac{9}{2}a_2a_4\epsilon}
\end{aligned}$$

Define $T^{**} = T_c + \frac{2a_3^2}{9a_2a_4} < T^*$. We summarise all the cases below:

- For $T > T^*$ we have only one minima $m = 0$.
- For $T^{**} < T < T^*$ we have three extrema, the global minima is at $m = 0$ and at m_+ we have a local minima. m_- is a maxima.
- For $T_c < T < T^{**}$ we have three extrema, the global minima is at m_+ and at $m = 0$ we have a local minima. m_- is still a maxima.
- For $T < T_c$, we have three extremas and $m = 0$ is a local maxima, while the global minima is at m_+ . m_- is a local minima.

But where does the first order transition take place? Note that, for $T > T^{**}$ the minima is at $m = 0$ and then, at $T = T^{**}$, we have two minima at $m = 0$ and a finite $m = m_+ > 0$. Just below T^{**} we have the global minima as m_+ which is not zero. Thus, there is a abrupt jump between the minima, which is the telltale sign of a first order transition.

12.2. Tricritical Point

We now consider a free energy with $\mathbb{Z}_2$ symmetry, but with a higher order term, m^6 .

$$\mathcal{L} = \frac{1}{2}a_2(T - T_c)m^2 + \frac{1}{4}a_4m^4 + \frac{1}{6}a_6m^6 \quad a_6, a_2 > 0 \quad (38)$$

From the same old routine, we minimise the Landau free energy

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial m} = m(a_2(T - T_c) + a_4m^2 + a_6m^4) = 0 \quad (39)$$

Denoting $t = T - T_c$, the trivial solution is $m = 0$ while the four other solutions are given by,

$$m^2 = -\frac{a_4}{2a_6} \pm \sqrt{\left(\frac{a_4}{2a_6}\right)^2 - \frac{a_2}{a_6}t} \Rightarrow \boxed{m = \pm \sqrt{-\frac{a_4}{2a_6} \pm \sqrt{\left(\frac{a_4}{2a_6}\right)^2 - \frac{a_2}{a_6}t}}}$$

Suppose that, $T > T_c$ and $a_4 > 0$, which implies that $a_2t + a_4m^2 + a_6m^4 > 0$ and cannot produce any root, for all m and hence, $\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial m}$ has a unique root at $m = 0$. For $T < T_c$, consider $a_2t + a_4x + a_6x^2 = 0$ where we defined $x = m^2$.

The discriminant of this equation is $a_4^2 - 4a_6a_2t$. As $T < T_c$, we have $t < 0$ and hence the discriminant is positive. This implies the existence of two roots to the equation. However, note that the product of the roots is $\frac{a_2t}{a_6} < 0$ which implies that one of the root is negative and the other is positive. We discard the negative root, as $x = m^2 > 0$ by definition. Then, apart from $m = 0$, only two root survive from this, corresponding to $x_+ \rightarrow m = \pm\sqrt{x_+}$, which are:

$$m = \pm \sqrt{-\frac{a_4}{2a_6} + \sqrt{\left(\frac{a_4}{2a_6}\right)^2 - \frac{a_2}{a_6}t}}$$

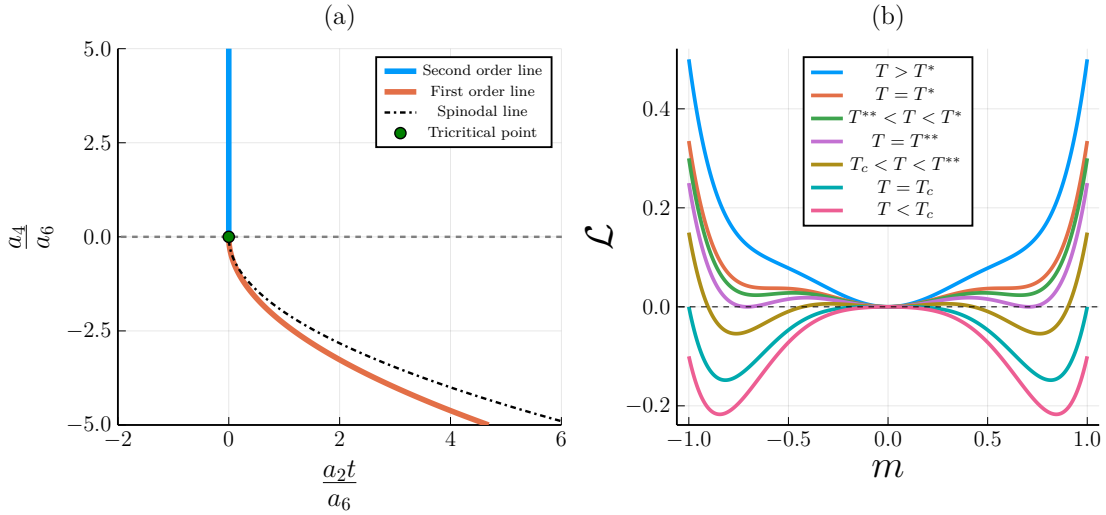


Figure 20: Landau free energy $\mathcal{L}$ with the sixth order term. (a) Phase diagram in the a_4 vs. t plane. The blue line denotes the second order line ($a_2 = 0$) while the dashed grey line denotes the spinodal line $a_4^2 = 4a_2a_6t$ (b) Behavior of $\mathcal{L}$ in different temperature regime.

as the ‘-’ root inside the square root gives imaginary solution. To see this, note that $\frac{a_2}{a_6}t < 0$ and hence,

$$\sqrt{\left(\frac{a_4}{2a_6}\right)^2 - \frac{a_2}{a_6}t} = \sqrt{\left(\frac{a_4}{2a_6}\right)^2 + \left|\frac{a_2}{a_6}t\right|} > \left|\frac{a_4}{2a_6}\right|$$

Let us now look at the case when $T > T_c$ but $a_4 < 0$, which has all five real roots, provided $a_4^2 > 4a_2a_6t \implies a_4 < -2\sqrt{a_2a_6t}$. If $a_4 > -2\sqrt{a_2a_6t}$, then the quantity under the root becomes imaginary and all the four roots become complex, so only real root is $m = 0$.

As $\mathcal{L} \rightarrow \infty$ as $m \rightarrow \pm\infty$, we must have three minima, separated by two maximas. From $\mathbb{Z}_2$ symmetry or otherwise, we can say that for $T > T_c$, $m = 0$ is always going to be a minima (and for $T < T_c$, it is a maxima). We now need to check whether the other two minima are lower in energy than $m = 0$ or not; so we check as before, $\mathcal{L}(m) = \mathcal{L}(0) = 0$ along with $\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial m} = 0$ which gives us two simultaneous equations,

$$\begin{aligned} 6a_2t + 3a_4m^2 + 2a_6m^4 &= 0 \\ a_2t + a_4m^2 + a_6m^4 &= 0 \end{aligned} \tag{40}$$

Multiplying the second equation by 2 and subtracting, we obtain:

$$4a_2t + a_4m^2 = 0 \implies m^2 = -\frac{4a_2}{a_4}t$$

Substituting this again the one of the equations gives us,

$$a_4 = -\frac{4}{\sqrt{3}}\sqrt{a_2a_6t} < 0$$

Now, we summarise the cases for $T > T_c$:

- If $a_4 > -2\sqrt{a_2a_6t}$ then only minima is $m = 0$.
- If $-\frac{4}{\sqrt{3}}\sqrt{a_2a_6t} < a_4 < -2\sqrt{a_2a_6t}$, then five real roots appear, but the global minima is still $m = 0$.
- If $a_4 < -\frac{4}{\sqrt{3}}\sqrt{a_2a_6t}$, then five real roots appear and zero minima is the local minima, while the other two (degenerate) minimas are global.

For $T < T_c$, three extremas are three; $m = 0$ is a maxima while two other global minimas are present. As before, there are two temperature scales involved, first is the spinodal temperature $T^* = T_c + \frac{a_4^2}{4a_2a_6}$ where the minima first start to appear and $T^{**} = T_c + \frac{3a_4^2}{16a_2a_6}$ where the first order transition take place (minima is the same as the minima at $m = 0$), as shown in Fig. 20. The point $(t = 0, a_4 = 0)$ in the phase diagram, where the first and the second order line meet is called the *tricritical point*.

Lecture 13: Landau Theory for Phase Transition: III

In this lecture, we focus on how the order parameter changes and the emergence of interesting phenomenon like hysteresis, for the m^3 and m^6 Landau theory.

13.1. Order Parameter Flow for m^3

Consider the previous case of $\mathcal{L}$ with m^3 term. We can change this to a one-parameter problem, following a transformation. We want to keep the one parameter r associated with a_2 , since this is where the temperature dependence is there. The other parameters need to be scaled somehow. If we say, $a_3 = ca_4$, then we obtain

$$\mathcal{L} = a_4 \left(\frac{a_2}{2a_4} (T - T_c) m^2 - \frac{1}{3} c m^3 + \frac{1}{4} m^4 \right)$$

If we now define the scaling $m = cu$ then we obtain,

$$\mathcal{L} = a_4 \left(\frac{a_2}{2a_4} (T - T_c) c^2 u^2 - \frac{1}{3} c^4 u^3 + \frac{1}{4} c^4 u^4 \right)$$

The last two terms contain c^4 . If the first term also somehow had c^4 we can take it common. So let us try the definition

$$\frac{a_2(T - T_c)}{a_4} = rc^2 \implies a_2(T - T_c) = \frac{a_2^2}{a_4} r$$

where r is our new parameter and the Landau free energy becomes,

$$\mathcal{L} = a_4 c^4 \left(\frac{1}{2} r u^2 - \frac{1}{3} u^3 + \frac{1}{4} u^4 \right)$$

Rescaling $\mathcal{L}$ by $a_4 c^4$, we obtain the following transformed function,

$$\varphi(u) = \frac{1}{2} r u^2 - \frac{1}{3} u^3 + \frac{1}{4} u^4 \quad (41)$$

which depends only on the parameter r (note that r contains the temperature dependence). The fixed point for $\varphi(u)$ are found from solving $\varphi'(u) = 0$,

$$ru - u^2 + u^3 = 0 \implies u = 0 \quad u_{\pm} = \frac{1}{2} \pm \sqrt{\frac{1}{4} - r}$$

From the second derivative, we have $\varphi''(u) = r - 2u + 3u^2$. For $r > \frac{1}{4}$ we only have one fixed point, $u = 0$ and $\varphi''(u) = r > 0$, hence $u = 0$ is a *stable fixed point*. Now, for $0 < r < \frac{1}{4}$ we have three extremas for $\varphi(u)$.

For this case, $0 < u_- < u_+$ and hence, 0 and u_+ are the minimas while u_- is the maxima (from the form of the potential). We need to check which of the minima is lower, for which we check $\varphi(u) = \varphi(0) = 0$.

Multiplying this by 12 and ignoring the $u = 0$ roots, we have $6r - 4u + 3u^2 = 0$. From minimisation condition, we further have $r - u + u^2 = 0$. Solving this simultaneously yields $u = 3r$ and substituting this in any one of the equation gives us $r = \frac{2}{9}$ and $u = \frac{2}{3}$. Hence, for $r > \frac{2}{9}$, $u = 0$ is the global minima while $u = u_+$ is the local minima and this becomes opposite for $0 < r < \frac{2}{9}$.

For $r < 0$, $u_- < 0 < u_+$ and hence $u = 0$ becomes the *unstable* maxima and the minimas are that $u = u_{\pm}$.

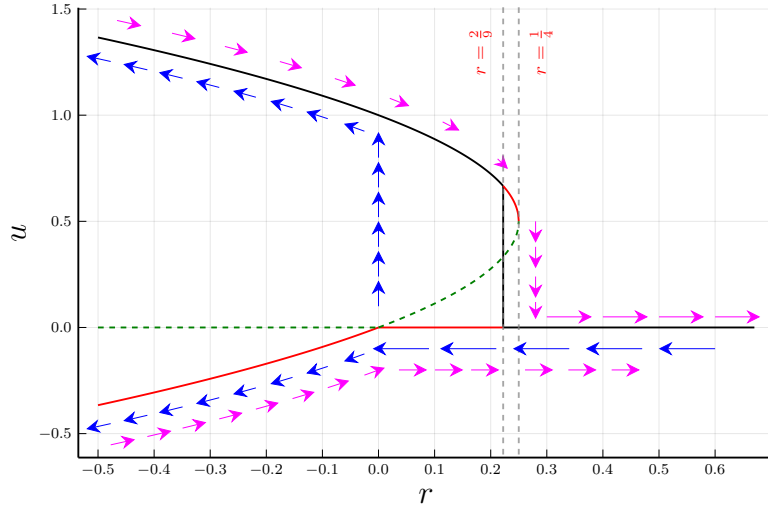


Figure 21: Hysteresis plot for $\varphi(u)$ with the cubic term. The black line denotes the stable fixed points while the red line represents the metastable fixed points. The dashed green line denote the unstable points.

So, say if we start from a negative value of u and r , then the system quickly moves to the red line (which is locally stable). As we increase r , we move along the red line to reach past $r = 0$ (shown by the magenta arrows in the lower region of Fig. 21), still following the same line, since the line is locally stable. In this case, there is no hysteresis.

Instead, if we start from some positive value of u initially, the system moves to follow the upper black line; it continues to move like this till $r = \frac{1}{4}$, at which point the line ceases to exist and it quickly drops down to $u = 0^+$.

When coming back (starting with a high positive value of r), the system remains in $u = 0$ line, until $u = 0$ becomes unstable at $r = 0$. At this point, the system jumps to the globally stable upper black line and continues to move there (shown by the blue lines in the upper part of Fig. 21)).

Clearly, these paths, while going and returning, are not the same, and this demonstrates the hysteresis in the theory.

13.2. Order Parameter Flow for m^6

Let us move on to the sextic potential that we saw earlier,

$$\mathcal{L} = \frac{1}{2}a_2(T - T_c)m^2 + \frac{1}{4}a_4m^4 + \frac{1}{6}a_6m^6$$

We can perform the same kind of transformation here also. Taking a_6 common we have,

$$\mathcal{L} = a_6 \left(\frac{a_2}{2a_6}(T - T_c)m^2 + \frac{a_4}{4a_6}m^4 + \frac{1}{6}m^6 \right)$$

Taking the scaling $a_4 = \pm c^2 a_6$ ¹ and $m = cu$ we obtain,

$$\mathcal{L} = a_6 \left(\frac{a_2}{2a_6}(T - T_c)c^2u^2 \pm \frac{c^6}{4}u^4 + \frac{1}{6}c^6u^6 \right)$$

Defining the new scaling,

$$\frac{a_2(T - T_c)}{a_6} = rc^4 \implies a_2(T - T_c) = \frac{a_4^2}{a_6}r$$

¹If a_4 is positive, then we take the + sign, else take the - sign.

Taking c^6 common and rescaling $\mathcal{L}$ by $c^6 a_6$, we get the transformed function,

$$\varphi(u) = \frac{1}{2}ru^2 \pm \frac{1}{4}u^4 + \frac{1}{6}u^6 \quad (42)$$

We do not focus on the case with the $+$ sign. We will deal mainly with the negative coefficient of u^2 . Minimising $\varphi(u)$ we obtain,

$$ru - u^3 + u^5 = 0 \implies r - u^2 + u^4 = 0$$

which gives us the roots,

$$u = \pm \sqrt{\frac{1}{2} \pm \sqrt{\frac{1}{4} - r}} \quad u = 0$$

If $r > \frac{1}{4}$, then the only root is $u = 0$ (other roots become imaginary). If $0 < r < \frac{1}{4}$ then we have all the roots. If $r < 0$ then $\sqrt{\frac{1}{4} - r} > \frac{1}{2}$, then there are only three roots, $u = 0, \pm \sqrt{\frac{1}{2} + \sqrt{\frac{1}{4} - r}}$.

Note that $\varphi''(0) = r$ which implies that for $r > 0$, $u = 0$ is a minima and it is a maxima otherwise. For $r > 0$, to check which is the global minima, we check $\varphi(r) = \varphi(0) = 0$ and $\varphi'(u) = 0$, which leads to the simultaneous equations,

$$\begin{aligned} 6r - 3u^2 + 2u^4 &= 0 \\ r - u^2 + u^4 &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

solving which, we obtain $u^2 = 4r$ and $r = 0$ or $r = \frac{3}{16}$. Then, for $r > \frac{3}{16}$, $u = 0$ is the global minima. For $r < \frac{3}{16}$, u_{++} and u_{-+} are the global stable minimas. Between $\frac{3}{16} < r < \frac{1}{4}$, u_{++} and u_{-+} are the metastable minimas. From this, we obtain the following u vs. r plot.

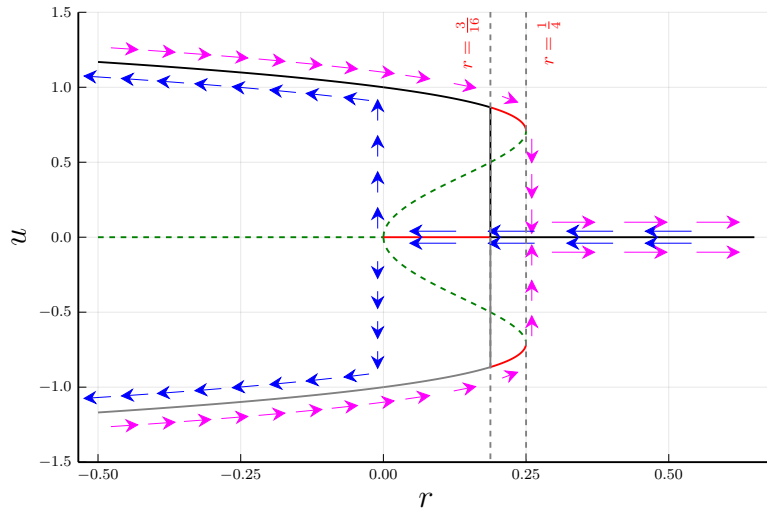


Figure 22: Hysteresis plot for $\varphi(u)$ with m^6 . The solid black and grey line denote the stable fixed points while the red line represents the metastable fixed points. The dashed green line denote the unstable points.

There is an obvious $u \rightarrow -u$ symmetry in Fig. 22. When r is positive, the flow is towards the fixed point $u = 0$, which persists even when $r < \frac{1}{4}$. When it reaches $r = 0$, $u = 0$ becomes unstable and the flow shifts to either of the global fixed points u_{++} or u_{-+} .

If we instead start from a higher positive value of u when $r < 0$, the system shifts to the upper black branch and follows that line till $r = \frac{1}{4}$ where the stable point is annihilated and the system abruptly shifts to $u = 0+$, where it remains on increasing r further. We thus see that between $0 < r < \frac{1}{4}$, the dynamics is irreversible and there is *hysteresis*.

Lecture 14: Spontaneous Symmetry Breaking

Let us re-visit the spontaneous symmetry breaking seen earlier, through the perspective of Landau theory. SSB, as stated before, refers to the fact that in some regime, the ground state does not respect the symmetry of the Hamiltonian. For a finite system, we observe no SSB since everything is analytic. In the thermodynamic limit, we had seen,

$$m = -\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\partial}{\partial h} \left[\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \left(\frac{1}{N} \frac{\partial F}{\partial h} \right) \right] \neq -\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\partial}{\partial h} \left[\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \left(\frac{1}{N} \frac{\partial F}{\partial h} \right) \right]$$

With the definition of the partition function using $\mathcal{L}$, we can write the free energy from Eq. (29) as,

$$F = -k_B T \ln \left[\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dm e^{-\beta N \mathcal{L}} \right] \quad (43)$$

where we have extended the integral limits to $\pm\infty$. Taking derivative with respect to the field, we obtain,

$$\frac{\partial F}{\partial h} = -k_B T \cdot -\beta N \frac{\int dm e^{-\beta N \mathcal{L}} (-m)}{\int dm e^{-\beta N \mathcal{L}}} = -N \frac{\int dm m e^{-\beta N \mathcal{L}}}{\int dm e^{-\beta N \mathcal{L}}} \quad (44)$$

where we assumed that $\mathcal{L}$ has the coupling term $-mh$ with the field. Let us focus on the numerator only, since the denominator is just the partition function and is always positive.

$$\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\partial F}{\partial h} \propto \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \int dm m e^{-\beta N \mathcal{L}} = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \left[\int_{-\infty}^0 dm m e^{-\beta N \mathcal{L}} + \int_0^{\infty} dm m e^{-\beta N \mathcal{L}} \right] \quad (45)$$

Now, in the zero field limit, $\mathcal{L}(m) = \mathcal{L}(-m)$ (presence of $\mathbb{Z}_2$ symmetry). Let us change the integral variable $m \rightarrow -m$, using which we get

$$\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\partial F}{\partial h} \propto \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \left[-\int_0^{\infty} dm m e^{-\beta N \mathcal{L}} + \int_0^{\infty} dm m e^{-\beta N \mathcal{L}} \right] = 0 \quad (46)$$

Thus, on taking the zero-field limit first, we get an overall zero magnetisation, even if we take the thermodynamic limit after this. Let us now try to take the thermodynamic limit first and then take the zero-field limit.

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} -\frac{k_B T}{N} \ln \left[\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dm e^{-\beta N (\tilde{\mathcal{L}} - hm)} \right] &= \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} -\frac{k_B T}{N} \ln \left[\int_{-\infty}^0 dm e^{-\beta N (\tilde{\mathcal{L}} - hm)} + \int_0^{\infty} dm e^{-\beta N (\tilde{\mathcal{L}} - hm)} \right] \\ &= \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} -\frac{k_B T}{N} \ln \left[\int_0^{\infty} dm \left(e^{-\beta N (\tilde{\mathcal{L}} - hm)} + e^{-\beta N (\tilde{\mathcal{L}} + hm)} \right) \right] \end{aligned} \quad (47)$$

where $\tilde{\mathcal{L}}$ denotes the Landau free energy without the field coupling. In the last step, we had used the substitution $m \rightarrow -m$ as before. Let us suppose $h > 0$, then the integral can be written as,

$$\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} -\frac{k_B T}{N} \ln \left[\int_0^{\infty} dm e^{-\beta N (\tilde{\mathcal{L}} - hm)} \left[1 + e^{-2\beta N hm} \right] \right] \quad (48)$$

For a finite positive h , if $N \rightarrow \infty$, then the blue term is really really small and hence can be neglected. The remaining integral (evaluated by the saddle point approximation) takes the value where it peaks at m^* . Taking the thermodynamic limit and $h \rightarrow 0^+$, we have:

$$-\lim_{h \rightarrow 0^+} \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\partial}{\partial h} \left[-\frac{k_B T}{N} \ln e^{-\beta N (\tilde{\mathcal{L}}(m^*) - hm^*)} \right] = -\lim_{h \rightarrow 0^+} \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\partial}{\partial h} [\tilde{\mathcal{L}}(m^*) - hm^*] = m^* \quad (49)$$

which gives a finite magnetisation. Suppose we had taken $h < 0$ initially,

$$\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} -\frac{k_B T}{N} \ln \left[\int_0^\infty dm e^{-\beta N(\tilde{\mathcal{L}} + hm)} \left[1 + e^{+2\beta N hm} \right] \right] \quad (50)$$

Since $h < 0$ then the red term goes to zero and exactly similarly, we obtain a finite magnetisation $-m^*$ when taking the zero field limit after the thermodynamic limit. This gives us the correct prescription of analysing the spontaneous magnetisation, depicting SSB.

Lecture 15: Landau-Ginzburg Theory

In the Landau theory, we had assumed an average value m of the magnetisation for the entire system and used this as the order parameter. However, this method is too rough as it misses any spatial dependence of the order parameter. m was spatially homogenous which perhaps is not what we want. We now generalise $m \rightarrow m(\mathbf{x})$ where $m(\mathbf{x})$ is now a field.

We focus on magnetic systems only, however, this can be applied to more general systems. To see this clearly, divide the system into N' different cells $\{I_1, I_2 \dots I_{N'}\}$, each with a characteristic length $\sim l$ as shown below. Here l is a mesoscopic length scale, $a \ll l \ll L$ where a is the lattice spacing and L is the typical linear dimension of the lattice.

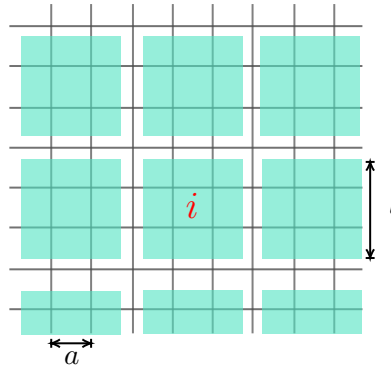


Figure 23: Coarse graining the lattice

Let the centre each cell I be $\mathbf{x}$ and define the local order parameter,

$$m_I(\mathbf{x}) = \frac{1}{N_I} \sum_{i \in I} \sigma_i \quad (51)$$

where N_I is the number of spins in cell I . This process is called *coarse graining*, since we are defining an order parameter, averaged over N_I spins in each cell. Let us now define $\mathcal{L}$ in this case. At the first glance, it seems that

$$\mathcal{L}(\{m_i\}) = \sum_i^{N'} \left[\frac{1}{2} a_2 (T - T_c) m_i^2 + \frac{1}{4} a_4 m_i^4 - h_i m_i \right]$$

We have suppressed the $\mathbf{x}$ parameter, since $\mathbf{x}$ is dependent on i itself. Note that the above free energy does not take into account the cost of maintaining the local magnetisation in adjacent cells. Every m_i is independent and this can lead to large difference in the order parameter in adjacent cells. We assume that the spatial variation of the local order parameter is ‘slow’ and for this, we introduce a symmetric coupling term,

$$\mathcal{L}(\{m_i\}) = \sum_i^{N'} \left[\frac{1}{2} a_2 (T - T_c) m_i^2 + \frac{1}{4} a_4 m_i^4 - h_i m_i \right] + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{ij} C_{ij} (m_i - m_j)^2 \quad (52)$$

where $\mathcal{C}_{ij}$ is the short-range coupling and based on a characteristic cutoff length R , is defined as,

$$\mathcal{C}_{ij} = \begin{cases} c_0 & |i - j|l < R \\ 0 & |i - j|l > R \end{cases}$$

There are some subtleties here though. Note that $\mathbf{x}$ can take only discrete values, based on the position of the cell. Hence we assume that $\frac{N'}{N}$ is small enough that $\mathbf{x}$ can be taken to be continuous. Moreover, within each cell, $m_i(\mathbf{x})$ is quantised in terms of $\frac{1}{N_I}$. We choose N_I large enough, so that $m_i(\mathbf{x})$ can take any value between -1 and $+1$. This allows us to replace $m_i(\mathbf{x})$ by just a continuous function $m(\mathbf{x})$. Let us now manipulate the coupling term now. Assume a 1D system for ease.

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{2} \sum_{ij} \mathcal{C}_{ij} (m_i - m_j)^2 &= \sum_i \sum_{j=1}^{R/l} c_0 (m_{i+j} - m_i)^2 \\ &= \sum_i \sum_{j=1}^{R/l} c_0 \left[\frac{(m_{i+j} - m_i)^2}{(jl)^2} \right] (jl)^2 \end{aligned} \quad (53)$$

The thing in the bracket looks like the discrete version of a derivative. In the continuum limit, this leads to $(\partial_x m(x))^2$, which becomes the gradient term $(\nabla m(\mathbf{x})) \cdot (\nabla m(\mathbf{x}))$ in general d dimensions. The sum over i can be converted to a d -dimensional integral,

$$\sum_i \equiv \frac{1}{l^d} \int d^d x$$

where l^d is the elemental volume in each cell with centre $\mathbf{x}$. The sum over j is just a constant and depends on the interaction range R . Thus, absorbing every constants into a single parameter γ , the coupling term becomes,

$$\frac{1}{2} \sum_{ij} \mathcal{C}_{ij} (m_i - m_j)^2 \simeq \frac{\gamma}{2} \int d^d x (\nabla m(\mathbf{x}))^2$$

The final expression for the Landau free energy is,

$$\mathcal{L}[m(\mathbf{x})] = \int d^d x \left[\frac{1}{2} a_2 (T - T_c) (m(\mathbf{x}))^2 + \frac{1}{4} a_4 (m(\mathbf{x}))^4 - h(\mathbf{x}) m(\mathbf{x}) + \frac{\gamma}{2} (\nabla m(\mathbf{x}))^2 \right] \quad (54)$$

Note that, $\mathcal{L}$ has now become a *functional*, that is, it takes a function $m(\mathbf{x})$ and spits out a scalar. The partition function calculation becomes a bit involved, since it contains the term $\exp(-\beta \mathcal{L}[m(\mathbf{x})])$ and we have to perform an integral. However, this is not an ordinary integral, since the integration variable is now a function $m(\mathbf{x})$. What happens is that there are infinite realisations of the function $m(\mathbf{x})$ and we need to ‘integrate’ over all these realisations. The process through which it is done is called *functional integral* or a more cool sounding *path integral*. The formal notation of the functional integral is,

$$\mathcal{Z} = \int \mathcal{D}m(\mathbf{x}) e^{-\beta \int d^d x \left[\frac{1}{2} a_2 (T - T_c) (m(\mathbf{x}))^2 + \frac{1}{4} a_4 (m(\mathbf{x}))^4 - h(\mathbf{x}) m(\mathbf{x}) + \frac{\gamma}{2} (\nabla m(\mathbf{x}))^2 \right]} \quad (55)$$

Out of the infinite realisations of $m((x))$, the one which gives the equation of state is the one which minimises the free energy functional. For minimisation purpose, we have to invoke the concept of function derivative since $m(\mathbf{x})$ is a function. Thus, we have the equation of state as,

$$m^*(\mathbf{x}) : \frac{\delta \mathcal{L}}{\delta m} = 0$$

Before formally going down this rabbit hole, let us find the minima by simply calculating the variation $\delta \mathcal{L}$ when the function $m(vbx)$ is varied from the minimising function as $m((x)) = m^*(\mathbf{x}) + \delta m(\mathbf{x})$, such that at the boundaries, $\delta m = 0$.

$$\delta \mathcal{L} = \int d^d x \left[a_2 (T - T_c) m \delta m + a_4 m^3 \delta m - h \delta m + \frac{\gamma}{2} \times 2 (\delta(\nabla m) \cdot (\nabla m)) \right]$$

Let us calculate the variation of the gradient term.

$$\begin{aligned} \int d^d x (\nabla m) \delta(\nabla m) &= \int d^d x (\nabla m) \nabla(\delta m) \\ &\stackrel{\text{IBP}}{=} - \int d^d x (\nabla^2 m) \delta m + [\nabla m \delta m]_{\text{bound.}} \\ &= - \int d^d x (\nabla^2 m) \delta m \end{aligned}$$

The boundary term is zero, since δm is zero at the boundaries. From the variation of the functional, we obtained

$$\delta \mathcal{L} = \int d^d x [a_2(T - T_c)m(\mathbf{x}) + a_4(m(\mathbf{x}))^3 - h(\mathbf{x}) - \gamma \nabla^2 m(\mathbf{x})] \delta m = 0$$

Since δm is arbitrary, we have the equation of state satisfied by,

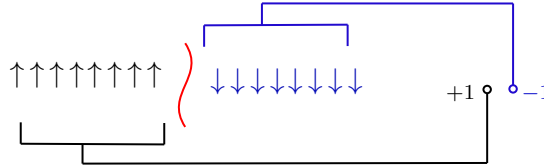
$$a_2(T - T_c)m^*(\mathbf{x}) + a_4(m^*(\mathbf{x}))^3 - h(\mathbf{x}) - \gamma \nabla^2 m^*(\mathbf{x}) = 0$$

Lecture 16: Kink Solutions

In the previous lecture, we introduced a spatial variation of the order parameter, $m(\mathbf{x})$. Consider the 1D Ising chain as an example. Suppose in the extreme left end of the chain, we have a $\uparrow$ spin while in the extreme right, we have a $\downarrow$ spin.

If we keep this constraint, then it is evident that somewhere in the middle, there should be a spin flip (that is, we cannot *continuously deform* the left side to bring it to the right side). This inability to continuously deform aptly indicates that this is a *topological artifact*.

This spin flip is nothing but a *domain wall* if we think about it. The domain wall is also exotically called a *kink* or *soliton* depending on the context and the type of system used. Note that if there are two kinks, then there are two spin flips and hence these cancel each other (that is, the boundaries have the same spins). Thus, this configuration can be continuously deformed to the ground state.



The spins left and right of the kink can be mapped from the real space (of the lattice) to the order-parameter space, where there are two points $+1$ and -1 , as shown above. Thus a state $(+, +)$ or $(-, -)$ will have all up spins and down spins respectively and hence are the ground states. The state $(+, -)$ (state $(-, +)$) will have up spins on the left (right) and down spins on the right (left) of the kink. These are the four topologically distinct sectors for the 1D Ising model. The state $(-, +)$ is called the kink state where we have up spins on the right of the chain while $(+, -)$ is called the anti-kink state.

We want to see the variation of the order parameter across the domain wall. For this, consider the following Landau functional,

$$\mathcal{L}[m(\mathbf{x})] = \int d^d x \left[\frac{1}{2} a_2(T - T_c)(m(\mathbf{x}))^2 + \frac{1}{4} a_4(m(\mathbf{x}))^4 - h(\mathbf{x})m(\mathbf{x}) + \frac{\gamma}{2} (\nabla m(\mathbf{x}))^2 \right]$$

Now, suppose spatial variations persist only in one direction, while all the other $(d - 1)$ dimensions are spatially uniform. Hence $m(\mathbf{x}) \equiv m(x)$ and let A be the integral over the rest of the spatially uniform $(d - 1)$ dimensions (hence $A \sim l^{d-1}$).

$$\frac{\mathcal{L}}{A} = \int dx \left[\frac{1}{2} a_2(T - T_c)(m(x))^2 + \frac{1}{4} a_4(m(x))^4 - h(x)m(x) + \frac{\gamma}{2} \left(\frac{\partial m(x)}{\partial x} \right)^2 \right] \quad (56)$$

Considering $h(x) = 0$, we get the equation of motion:

$$\gamma \frac{d^2 m}{dx^2} = a_2(T - T_c)m + a_4 m^3 \quad (57)$$

Multiplying both sides by $\frac{dm}{dx}$ we get,

$$\begin{aligned} \gamma \left(\frac{dm}{dx} \right) \frac{d^2 m}{dx^2} &= [a_2(T - T_c)m + a_4 m^3] \left(\frac{dm}{dx} \right) \Rightarrow \frac{\gamma}{2} \frac{d}{dx} \left(\frac{dm}{dx} \right)^2 = \frac{\partial}{\partial x} \left[\frac{1}{2} a_2(T - T_c)m^2 + \frac{1}{4} a_4 m^4 \right] \\ &\Rightarrow \frac{d}{dx} \left[\frac{\gamma}{2} \left(\frac{dm}{dx} \right)^2 - \frac{1}{2} a_2(T - T_c)m^2 - \frac{1}{4} a_4 m^4 \right] = 0 \\ &\Rightarrow -\frac{\gamma}{2} \left(\frac{dm}{dx} \right)^2 + \frac{1}{2} a_2(T - T_c)m^2 + \frac{1}{4} a_4 m^4 = C \end{aligned}$$

where C is a constant determined by the boundary conditions. So let's set $m(x \rightarrow +\infty) = m_\infty = \sqrt{-\frac{a_2}{a_4}(T - T_c)} > 0$ and $\left. \frac{dm}{dx} \right|_\infty = 0$. Using this, we obtain the value of C

$$C = \frac{1}{2} a_2(T - T_c) \times \left(-\frac{a_2(T - T_c)}{a_4} \right) + \frac{1}{4} a_4 \times \frac{(a_2(T - T_c))^2}{a_4^2} = -\frac{[a_2(T - T_c)]^2}{4a_4}$$

Substituting this value above, we get the equation as,

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &= -\frac{\gamma}{2} \left(\frac{dm}{dx} \right)^2 + \frac{1}{2} a_2(T - T_c)m^2 + \frac{1}{4} a_4 m^4 + \frac{[a_2(T - T_c)]^2}{4a_4} \\ &= -\frac{\gamma}{2} \left(\frac{dm}{dx} \right)^2 + \frac{a_4}{4} \left[\frac{2a_2}{a_4}(T - T_c)m^2 + m^4 + m_\infty^4 \right] \\ &= -\frac{\gamma}{2} \left(\frac{dm}{dx} \right)^2 + \frac{a_4}{4} [-2m^2 m_\infty^2 + m^4 + m_\infty^4] \\ &= -\frac{\gamma}{2} \left(\frac{dm}{dx} \right)^2 + \frac{a_4}{4} (m^2 - m_\infty^2)^2 \end{aligned} \quad (58)$$

from which get two solutions,

$$\sqrt{\frac{2\gamma}{a_4}} \frac{dm}{dx} = \pm (m^2 - m_\infty^2)$$

We take the $-ve$ solution and then we integrate to get,

$$\sqrt{\frac{2\gamma}{a_4}} \int_{m(x_0)}^m \frac{dm}{m_\infty^2 - m^2} = \int_{x_0}^x dx = (x - x_0)$$

where x_0 is the centre of the domain wall and we assume $m(x_0) = 0$. On solving the integral, we obtain the solution,

$$\begin{aligned} \sqrt{\frac{2\gamma}{a_4}} \frac{1}{m_\infty} \tanh^{-1} \left(\frac{m}{m_\infty} \right) &= (x - x_0) \Rightarrow m(x) = m_\infty \tanh \left[\frac{m_\infty(x - x_0)}{\sqrt{2}(\gamma/a_4)^{1/2}} \right] \\ &= m_\infty \tanh \left[\frac{(x - x_0)}{\sqrt{2}(\gamma/a_4)^{1/2} (a_2(T_c - T)/a_4)^{-1/2}} \right] \end{aligned}$$

Now, the red quantity has the dimension of length and we denote it by ξ . Physically, ξ denotes the length scale over which significant change occurs across the domain wall. This is appropriately called the *correlation length* since this is the scale across which correlations between the spins persist. The correlation length is temperature dependent as seen above. It scales as, $\xi \sim (T_c - T)^{-1/2}$, hence shows a power-law divergence at $T = T_c$.

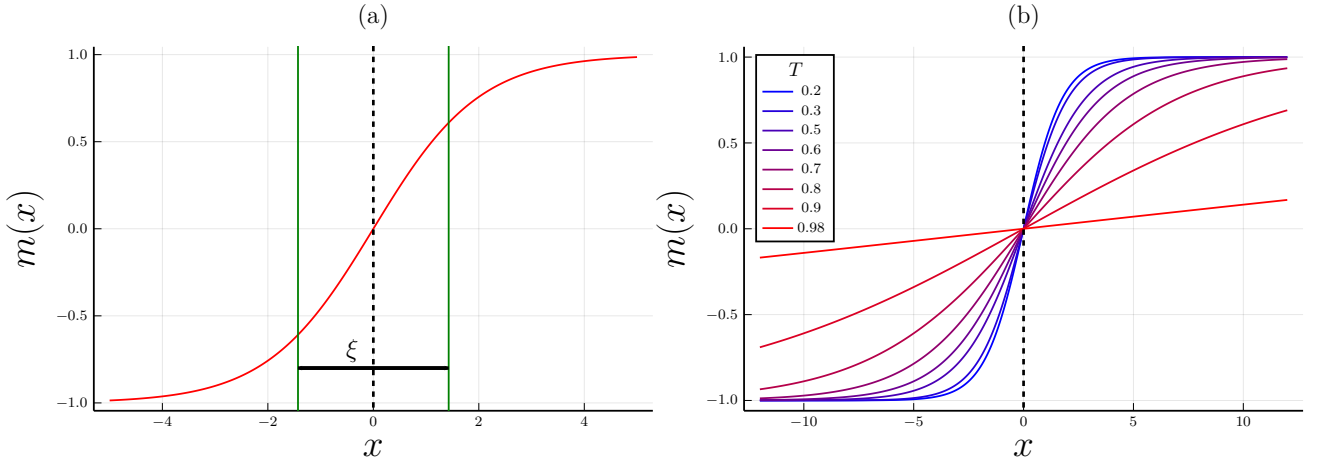


Figure 24: Spatial variation of order parameter. (a) $m(x)$ at $T < T_c$. The black vertical dashed line denotes the centre of the domain wall, while the green lines denote the extent of ξ . Within this region, most change occurs across the domain wall. (b) $m(x)$ for various temperature. We see that the correlation length gradually increases on increasing T .

The domain wall incurs some energy cost in the system. This is reflected in terms of the surface tension σ defined as,

$$\sigma \equiv \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left[\frac{1}{2} a_2 m^2(x) + \frac{1}{4} a_4 m^4(x) + \frac{\gamma}{2} \left(\frac{dm}{dx} \right)^2 \right] - \left[\frac{1}{2} a_2 m_\infty^2 + \frac{1}{4} a_4 m_\infty^4 \right] \quad (59)$$

The above is just the increase in energy from the uniform ground state. This gives us,

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left[\frac{1}{2} a_2 (m^2(x) - m_\infty^2) + \frac{1}{4} a_4 (m^4(x) - m_\infty^4) + \frac{\gamma}{2} \left(\frac{dm}{dx} \right)^2 \right] dx \\ &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left[\frac{1}{2} a_2 (m^2 - m_\infty^2) + \frac{1}{4} a_4 (m^4 - m_\infty^4) + \frac{a_4}{4} (m^2 - m_\infty^2)^2 \right] dx \\ &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} (m^2 - m_\infty^2) \left[\frac{1}{2} a_2 + \frac{1}{4} a_4 (m^2 + m_\infty^2) + \frac{a_4}{4} (m^2 - m_\infty^2) \right] dx \\ &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{a_4}{2} (m^2 - m_\infty^2)^2 dx = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{a_4}{2} \times \frac{2\gamma}{a_4} \left(\frac{dm}{dx} \right)^2 dx = \gamma \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left[\frac{d}{dx} \left(m_\infty \tanh \left(\frac{x - x_0}{\sqrt{2}\xi} \right) \right) \right]^2 dx \end{aligned} \quad (60)$$

Carrying out the integral yields us,

$$\sigma = \frac{\gamma m_\infty^2}{2\xi^2} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \text{sech}^4 \left(\frac{x - x_0}{\sqrt{2}\xi} \right) dx = \frac{\gamma m_\infty^2}{2\xi^2} \times \sqrt{2}\xi \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \text{sech}^4(t) dt = \frac{4\gamma m_\infty^2}{3\sqrt{2}\xi}$$

Using the definition of ξ from before, we get

$$\sigma = \frac{4}{3\sqrt{2}} \frac{\sqrt{\gamma a_2^3 |T_c - T|^3}}{a_4} \implies \sigma \sim |T_c - T|^{3/2} \quad (61)$$

The surface tension goes to 0 at T_c and so domain walls are easy to form at the critical point.

16.1. Physical Interpretation

At the extreme left end, $m(x) \rightarrow -m_\infty$ and $m(x) \rightarrow +m_\infty$ at the extreme right end. Note that

$$\pm m_\infty$$

are the minima of the free energy density. Hence, the domain wall allows us to go from one minima to another. There is another physical interpretation of Eq. (57). This equation looks exactly like Newton's law $\frac{\partial^2 y}{\partial t^2} = -\frac{\partial V}{\partial y}$, with $m \leftrightarrow y$ and $x \leftrightarrow t$. Then this situation is like an inertial particle moving back and forth between two hills, situated at $\pm m_\infty$.

16.2. Topological Charge

Let us define the following quantity,

$$q_T := \frac{1}{2m_0} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dx \left(\frac{dm}{dx} \right) = \left[\frac{m(+\infty) - m(-\infty)}{2m_0} \right] \quad (62)$$

q_T is just dependent on the boundary conditions and hence, invariant under some local change of the order parameter. For the ground states, $(+, +)$ or $(-, -)$, the topological charge is zero. For the kink state $(-, +)$ we have $q_T = +1$ and for the anti-kink state $(+, -)$ we have $q_T = -1$. Two kinks (one kink and other anti-kink or vice versa) is topologically equivalent to one of the ground states.

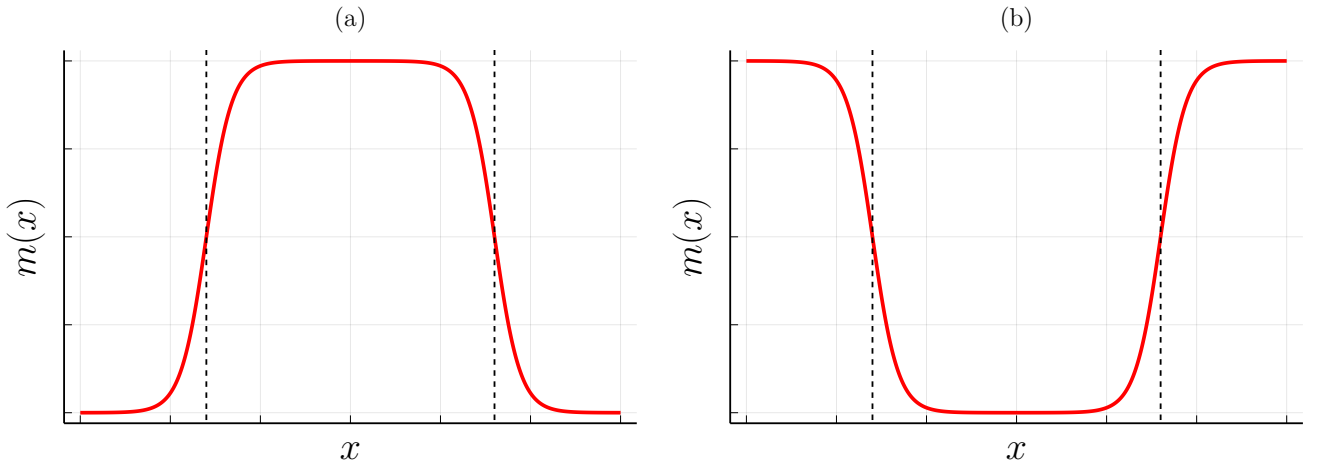


Figure 25: (a) Kink-antikink pair (b) Antikink-kink pair

Such kink and anti-kink pairs are deformable and annihilate each other as seen previously.

Lecture 17: Fluctuation-Response Relations

Given a partition function we can obtain the free energy as $F = -k_B T \ln \mathcal{Z}$ and from there we can find the expectation value of the order parameter,

$$\langle m(\mathbf{r}) \rangle = -\frac{\delta F}{\delta h(\mathbf{r})} = \frac{\int \mathcal{D}m e^{-\beta \mathcal{L}} m(\mathbf{r})}{\int \mathcal{D}m e^{-\beta \mathcal{L}}} \quad (63)$$

The second expression is just the definition of the expectation value. In a similar way, the generalised susceptibility (with spatial dependence) can be found out as,

$$\chi(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') = \frac{\delta \langle m(\mathbf{r}) \rangle}{\delta h(\mathbf{r}')} = -\frac{\delta^2 F}{\delta h(\mathbf{r}) \delta h(\mathbf{r}')} \quad (64)$$

Using the definition of functional derivatives we can then write the variations,

$$\delta F = - \int d^d r' \langle m(\mathbf{r}') \rangle \delta h(\mathbf{r}') \quad \delta \langle m(\mathbf{r}) \rangle = \int d^d r' \chi(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') \delta h(\mathbf{r}')$$

We assume that $\mathcal{L}$ has a term $-h(\mathbf{r})m(\mathbf{r})$. Differentiating the expectation value with respect to the field, we have

$$\begin{aligned}\chi(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') \frac{\delta \langle m(\mathbf{r}) \rangle}{\delta h(\mathbf{r}')} &= \frac{\int \mathcal{D}m e^{-\beta \mathcal{L}[m]} \beta m(\mathbf{r}) m(\mathbf{r}')}{\int \mathcal{D}m e^{-\beta \mathcal{L}}} - \frac{[\int \mathcal{D}m e^{-\beta \mathcal{L}} m(\mathbf{r})] [\int \mathcal{D}m m(\mathbf{r}') \beta e^{-\beta \mathcal{L}}]}{[\int \mathcal{D}m e^{-\beta \mathcal{L}}]^2} \\ &= \frac{1}{k_B T} [\langle m(\mathbf{r}) m(\mathbf{r}') \rangle - \langle m(\mathbf{r}) \rangle \langle m(\mathbf{r}') \rangle] = \beta \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}')\end{aligned}\quad (65)$$

where $\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}')$ is the correlation function defined in Lec. 6. Hence we get a simple relation,

$$\chi(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') = \beta \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}')$$

Note that we have assumed translational invariance from the beginning, that's why we were writing the functions as a different of the two vectors $\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}'$. We can easily use the Fourier transform for translationally invariant systems.

$$\chi(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') = \int \frac{d^d k}{(2\pi)^d} \tilde{\chi}(k) e^{i\mathbf{k} \cdot (\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}')}$$

Using this in the above relation above, we get $\tilde{\chi}(k) = \beta \tilde{\mathcal{G}}(k)$, which is an aspect of *linear response theory*. The susceptibility is a response, which is linearly proportional to the correlation function. Now, if the frequency of the external perturbation (like the Fourier decomposition of the magnetic field) tends to zero, χ must reduce to the static isothermal susceptibility,

$$\chi_T = \lim_{k \rightarrow 0} \tilde{\chi}(k) = \beta \tilde{\mathcal{G}}(0) = \beta \int d^d r \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r}) \quad (66)$$

17.1. Calculating the Correlation function (Ornstein-Zernike relation)

Here, we outline a method to calculate the correlation function. For that, let us take the derivative of the equation of state with respect to the field.

$$\frac{\delta}{\delta h(\mathbf{r}')} [a_2(T - T_c)m(\mathbf{r}) + a_4 m^3(\mathbf{r}) - h(\mathbf{r}) - \gamma \nabla^2 m] = 0$$

From the definition of susceptibility, we have

$$[-\gamma \nabla^2 + a_2(T - T_c) + 3a_4 m^2] \chi(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') = \delta^{(d)}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}')$$

Using the linear response result, we have

$$[-\gamma \nabla^2 + a_2(T - T_c) + 3a_4 m^2] \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') = k_B T \delta^{(d)}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}')$$

It is evident that the correlation function is the *Green's function* for this differential equation. Let us focus on the spatially homogenous case, $m(\mathbf{r}) \equiv m = \sqrt{\frac{a_2(T_c - T)}{a_4}}$ for $T < T_c$ and $m = 0$ for $T > T_c$. Then,

$$(-\nabla^2 + \xi_{>}^{-2}) \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') = \frac{k_B T}{\gamma} \delta^{(d)}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') \quad \xi_{>} = \left[\frac{a_2(T - T_c)}{\gamma} \right]^{-1/2}$$

and for $T < T_c$ we have

$$\left(-\gamma \nabla^2 + a_2(T - T_c) + 3a_4 \times \frac{a_2(T_c - T)}{a_4} \right) = (-\gamma \nabla^2 - 2a_2(T - T_c)) \implies (-\nabla^2 + \xi_{<}^{-2}) \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') = \frac{k_B T}{\gamma} \delta^{(d)}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}')$$

where $\xi_{<} = \left[\frac{2a_2(T_c - T)}{\gamma} \right]^{-1/2}$. These are the *correlation length* defined above and before T_c . We see the scaling of ξ with $|T_c - T|$ and conclude that, $\xi \sim (T_c - T)^{-\nu}$ for $T < T_c$ and $\xi \sim (T - T_c)^{\nu'}$ for $T > T_c$ with $\nu = \nu' = \frac{1}{2}$ from the mean-field theory. In summary, the two-point correlation function satisfies the differential equation,

$$(-\nabla^2 + \xi^{-2}) \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}') = \frac{k_B T}{\gamma} \delta^{(d)}(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}')$$

Fourier transform of the equation yields,

$$\tilde{\mathcal{G}}(k) = \frac{k_B T}{\gamma} \frac{1}{k^2 + \xi^{-2}} \quad (67)$$

This is kind of the Fourier transform of the Yukawa potential. Note that, at $T = T_c$, $\xi \rightarrow \infty$ and hence $\tilde{\mathcal{G}}(k) \sim k^{-2}$. We can revert back to the real space correlation function using the polar coordinates which we do now. For that, let us choose $\mathbf{r}' = 0$ and write the Laplacian in polar coordinates in d dimensions which gives us,

$$\left[-\frac{1}{r^{d-1}} \frac{\partial}{\partial r} \left(r^{d-1} \frac{\partial}{\partial r} \right) + \xi^{-2} \right] \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r}) = \frac{k_B T}{\gamma} \delta^{(d)}(\mathbf{r}) \quad (68)$$

Let us define $\rho := r/\xi$ and $G(\rho) = \mathcal{G}(r/\xi)$. Moreover, the d -dimensional delta function gives $\delta^{(d)}(\rho\xi) = \frac{1}{\xi^d} \delta^{(d)}(\rho)$. Using these variables, the differential equation becomes,

$$\left[-\frac{1}{\rho^{d-1}} \frac{\partial}{\partial \rho} \left(\rho^{d-1} \frac{\partial}{\partial \rho} \right) + 1 \right] G(\rho) = g \delta^{(d)}(\rho)$$

where we have defined $g := \frac{k_B T}{\gamma} \xi^{2-d}$. g is a strength of the fluctuations since this contains the correlation length. Now, if $\rho \neq 0$, then

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \rho} \left(\rho^{d-1} \frac{\partial G}{\partial \rho} \right) = \rho^{d-1} G(\rho) \implies G'' + \frac{(d-1)}{\rho} G' - G = 0$$

Define $G(\rho) = \rho^{-\nu} F(\rho)$ and carrying out the derivatives,

$$\begin{aligned} G' &= -\nu \rho^{-(1+\nu)} F + \rho^{-\nu} F' = \rho^{-\nu} \left(F' - \frac{\nu F}{\rho} \right) \\ G'' &= -\nu \left[\rho^{-(1+\nu)} F' - (1+\nu) \rho^{-(\nu+2)} F \right] - \nu \rho^{-(1+\nu)} F' + \rho^{-\nu} F'' \\ &= \rho^{-\nu} F'' - 2\nu F' \rho^{-(\nu+1)} + \nu(1+\nu) \rho^{-(2+\nu)} F \\ &= \rho^{-\nu} \left[F'' - \frac{2\nu}{\rho} F' + \frac{\nu(\nu+1)}{\rho^2} F \right] \end{aligned} \quad (69)$$

Let us substitute these in the above differential equation,

$$\begin{aligned} G'' + \frac{(d-1)}{\rho} G' - G &= \rho^{-\nu} \left[\left(F'' - \frac{2\nu}{\rho} F' + \frac{\nu(\nu+1)}{\rho^2} F \right) + \frac{(d-1)}{\rho} F' - \frac{\nu(d-1)}{\rho^2} F - F \right] \\ &= \rho^{-\nu} \left[F'' + \frac{d-1-2\nu}{\rho} F' + \frac{\nu(\nu+1) - \nu(d-1) - \rho^2}{\rho^2} F \right] = 0 \end{aligned} \quad (70)$$

Let us choose $d-1-2\nu = 1 \implies \nu = \frac{d}{2}-1$. Then $\nu(\nu+1) - \nu(d-1) = \nu(\nu+1-d+1) = \nu(\nu+2-d) = -\nu^2$. Finally, we get the simplified differential equation,

$$\rho^2 F'' + \rho F' - (\nu^2 + \rho^2) F = 0$$

This is the *modified Bessel equation* and its solutions are given by the modified Bessel functions,

$$G(\rho) = \rho^{-\nu} (c_1 I_\nu(\rho) + c_2 K_\nu(\rho))$$

Note that $I_\nu \sim e^\rho$ and hence it exponentially grows up, which we do not want. Thus, we keep only $K_\nu(\rho)$ in the solution and hence, $G(\rho) \sim \rho^{-\nu} K_\nu$. The constant can be fixed another complicated process (which I skip) and finally we get,

$$\frac{G(\rho)}{g} = \begin{cases} e^{-\rho} & d = 1 \\ \frac{1}{(2\pi)^{d/2}} \frac{1}{\rho^{(d-2)/2}} K_{\frac{d-2}{2}}(\rho) & d \geq 2 \end{cases} \quad (71)$$

For $\rho \gg 1 \implies r \gg \xi$, $K_\nu(\rho) \sim \left(\frac{\pi}{2\rho}\right)^{1/2} e^{-\rho}$ and hence for $d \geq 2$,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{G}(r) &= \frac{g}{(2\pi)^{d/2}} \frac{1}{\rho^{(d-2)/2}} K_{\frac{d-2}{2}}(\rho) \longrightarrow \frac{g}{(2\pi)^{d/2}} \frac{\xi^{(d-2)/2}}{r^{(d-2)/2}} \left(\frac{\pi\xi}{2r}\right)^{1/2} e^{-r/\xi} \\ &= \xi^{2-d} \frac{k_B T}{\gamma} \frac{1}{2^{d/2} \pi^{d/2}} \frac{\xi^{d/2-1}}{r^{d/2-1}} \frac{\pi^{1/2} \xi^{1/2}}{2^{1/2} r^{1/2}} e^{-r/\xi} \\ &= \frac{k_B T}{\gamma} \cdot \frac{\pi^{(1-d)/2}}{2^{(1+d)/2}} \cdot \frac{e^{-r/\xi}}{r^{(d-1)/2}} \cdot \frac{1}{\xi^{(d-3)/2}} \end{aligned} \quad (72)$$

For $r \ll \xi$ (near T_c where correlation length diverges), $K_\nu \sim \frac{1}{2} \Gamma(\nu) \left(\frac{\rho}{2}\right)^{-\nu}$ and we get the expression:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{G}(r) &= \frac{g}{(2\pi)^{d/2}} \frac{1}{\rho^{(d-2)/2}} K_{\frac{d-2}{2}}(\rho) \longrightarrow \frac{g}{(2\pi)^{d/2}} \frac{\xi^{(d-2)/2}}{r^{(d-2)/2}} \cdot \frac{1}{2} \Gamma\left(\frac{d-2}{2}\right) \left(\frac{2\xi}{r}\right)^{(d-2)/2} \\ &= \frac{k_B T}{\gamma} \cdot \xi^{2-d} \cdot \frac{1}{2^{d/2} \pi^{d/2}} \frac{\xi^{d-2}}{r^{(d-2)/2}} \Gamma\left(\frac{d-2}{2}\right) 2^{d/2-2} \\ &= \frac{k_B T}{\gamma} \cdot \frac{1}{4\pi^{d/2}} \cdot \frac{1}{r^{d-2}} \cdot \Gamma\left(\frac{d-2}{2}\right) \implies \mathcal{G}(r) \sim r^{-(d-2)} \end{aligned} \quad (73)$$

Thus, near $T = T_c$, $\mathcal{G}(r)$ becomes a power-law and it is self-similar. There is no inherent length scale. It has been experimentally seen that the exponent is not exactly $(d-2)$, hence we add a correction η . Thus,

$$\mathcal{G}(r) \sim \frac{1}{r^{d-2+\eta}} \quad (74)$$

From mean-field, η is obtained to be zero. The critical exponents heavily depend on the dimensionality of space. As d increases, the exponents becomes closer to that of the mean-field theory. In general, the exponents are not simple rational fractions, however, in $d = 2$ due to *conformal symmetry* (about which I do not have any idea), the exponents become rational numbers.

Lecture 18: Some More Fluctuations

By now, we have realised that the mean-field theory is very unstable and in many cases, it breaks down. Let us analyse when it is effective and when it is not. In MFT, we threw away the fluctuations and hence, if the fluctuations become more than the order parameter scale, then it breaks down.

In general, we see that the exponents do match for $d \geq 4$. What is so special about $d = 4$?

18.1. Ginzburg-Levanyuk Criterion

Suppose we consider only regions of extent upto order ξ in each dimensions (so correlations persist). We then define the correlation volume $V_\xi \sim \xi^d \alpha_d$ where $\alpha_d = \frac{\pi^{d/2}}{\Gamma(\frac{d}{2}+1)}$ is the volume of a unit d -sphere. Now, within this volume, if the fluctuations are way smaller than the value of the order parameter, then we can say that MFT is kinda valid. Since the correlation is given by $\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r})$ then, mathematically, we can define the condition for validity of Landau theory,

$$\frac{\int_{V_\xi} d^d r \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r})}{V_\xi} \ll \langle m \rangle^2 \quad (75)$$

This criteria is called the *Ginzburg-Levanyuk* criteria. We further analyse this,

$$\int_{V_\xi} d^d r \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{r}) \ll \langle m \rangle^2 \xi^d \alpha_d$$

Now, from Eq. (66) the LHS just becomes the isothermal susceptibility¹,

$$\chi_T k_B T \ll \langle m \rangle^2 \xi^d \alpha_d \implies (-t)^{-\gamma} \ll (-t)^{2\beta} t^{-d\nu}$$

where we used the reduced temperature $t = \frac{T-T_c}{T_c}$ and the various scaling laws, $m \sim (-t)^\beta$, $\xi \sim (-t)^{-\gamma}$ and $\xi \sim (-t)^{-\nu}$. From this, we finally obtain:

$$(-t)^{\gamma+2\beta-d\nu} \gg 1 \quad (76)$$

As $t \rightarrow 0$ (near T_c), this condition is only satisfied if $\gamma + 2\beta - \nu d < 0$, since then the LHS becomes less than 1 and blows up when the denominator becomes arbitrarily small. The criteria gives us,

$$\frac{\gamma + 2\beta}{\nu} < d \quad (77)$$

Defining $d_c = \frac{\gamma+2\beta}{\nu}$ as the *upper critical dimension*, we see that for the Ising universality class (that is, those systems where the mean-field exponents are equal to that of the Ising model), $d_c = 4$ as $\gamma = 1, \beta = \nu = 1/2$ which tells us why $d = 4$ is important.

From our previous discussion, we saw that for $T < T_c$,

$$\xi = \left[\frac{\gamma}{2a_2(T_c - T)} \right]^{-1/2} \implies \xi = \left[\frac{\gamma}{2a_2 T_c (-t)} \right]^{-1/2} \implies \xi^d = \xi_1^d (-t)^{-d/2}$$

where ξ_1 is the rest of the constants, having no temperature dependence. For $T < T_c$ the susceptibility is equal to,

$$\chi = \frac{1}{2a(T_c - T)} = \frac{1}{2a T_c (-t)}$$

Then, for $T < T_c^-$ the Ginzburg criteria gives us,

$$k_B T_c \cdot \frac{1}{2a T_c (-t)} \ll \alpha_d \xi_1^d (-t)^{-d/2} \cdot \frac{a_2 (-t) T_c}{a_4} \implies \frac{k_B a_4}{2a_2^2 T_c \xi_1^d \alpha_d} \ll (-t)^{2-\frac{d}{2}}$$

Note that, from sec 11.3, the discontinuity in the specific heat was found out to be $\Delta C = \frac{a_2^2}{a_4} T_c$ which exactly appears here also. Define the GL reduced temperature as,

$$(-t_{\text{GL}}) := \left[\frac{k_B}{2\Delta C \xi_1^d \alpha_d} \right]^{2/(4-d)} \quad (78)$$

which tells us that MFT is valid only if $(-t)^{(4-d)/2} \gg (-t_{\text{GL}})^{(4-d)/2}$. This relation is also dependent on the dimension.

- For $d > 4$: As $t \rightarrow 0$, since $(4-d) < 0$ the LHS blows up and hence the relation is always satisfied, since the RHS is just a finite constant.
- For $d < 4$: As $t \rightarrow 0$, the Ginzburg criteria is not satisfied. There exists a temperature T_{GL} obtained from t_{GL} such that between $T_c - T_{\text{GL}}$ and $T_c + T_{\text{GL}}$, the Landau theory is not applicable. This region is called the *fluctuation dominating window*. The fluctuation dominating window is not universal and depends on the system. It is very, very narrow for conventional superconductors, so narrow that it cannot be probed by experimental means and hence experimentally it always matches with the MFT results.
- For $d = 4$: Landau Theory is strictly not valid, however the Ginzburg criteria is marginally satisfied. There are some logarithmic corrections due to fluctuations.

¹In Eq. (66), the integral is over the whole space, but it is well approximated by the integral over the correlation volume, since $\mathcal{G}$ is a rapidly decaying function.

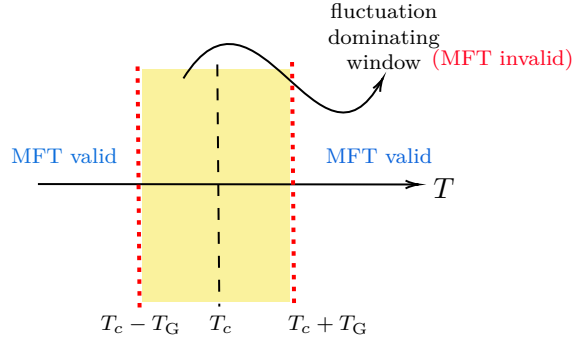


Figure 26: Fluctuation dominating window

This explains the significance of $d_c = 4$ as the upper critical dimension. Although we considered the Ising universality class, this procedure is also valid for other classes, however, $d_c \neq 4$ for those systems. Similar to the upper critical dimension, we do have a lower critical dimension d_l . Below d_l , fluctuations are so strong that they kill all the ordering and hence the mean-field theory is not even qualitatively correct (For Ising class, $d_l = 1$). Between d_l and d_c , we can qualitatively explain things using MFT but it will not provide quantitative accuracy.

Note: MFT is valid at $T = 0$, since at this temperature, no fluctuations exist. Also, when $d \rightarrow \infty$ and for infinite-range interactions, MFT is valid.

Lecture 19: Gaussian Approximation

We will try to incorporate some simple correction to MFT, to take care of the fluctuations. We try to approximate the functional integral in some way. For that, assume some deviation from the uniform magnetisation,

$$m(\mathbf{r}) = m_0 + \phi(\mathbf{r})$$

For $T > T_c$, we have $m_0 = 0$ and hence the Landau free energy becomes,

$$\mathcal{L}[\phi(\mathbf{x})] = \int d^d x \left[\frac{1}{2} a_2 (T - T_c) (\phi(\mathbf{x}))^2 + \frac{1}{4} a_4 (\phi(\mathbf{x}))^4 - h(\mathbf{x}) \phi(\mathbf{x}) + \frac{\gamma}{2} (\nabla \phi(\mathbf{x}))^2 \right]$$

We neglect terms greater than the quadratic order and also take the zero field case, which gives us,

$$\mathcal{L}[\phi(\mathbf{x})] = \int d^d x \left[\frac{1}{2} a_2 (T - T_c) (\phi(\mathbf{x}))^2 + \frac{\gamma}{2} (\nabla \phi(\mathbf{x}))^2 \right] \equiv \int d^d x f(\phi(\mathbf{x})) \quad (79)$$

Let us consider a finite volume $V = L^d$, which will lead to the discretisation of the functional integral. If we decompose the field in terms of its Fourier modes, then the momenta will take discrete values in the d -dimensional space,

$$\mathbf{k} = \frac{2\pi \mathbf{n}}{L} \quad \mathbf{n} \in \mathbb{Z}^d$$

We define the Fourier transform as,

$$\phi(\mathbf{x}) = \frac{1}{V} \sum_{\mathbf{k}} e^{i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{x}} \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}} \xrightarrow{V \rightarrow \infty} \int \frac{d^d k}{(2\pi)^d} e^{i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{x}} \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}$$

We will work with the discrete case (finite volume) for now. Let us substitute this definition carefully in the Landau functional.

$$\begin{aligned} f(\mathbf{x}) &= \frac{1}{V^2} \sum_{\mathbf{k}, \mathbf{k}'} \frac{\gamma}{2} [\nabla_x \cdot (\tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}} e^{i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{x}})] [\nabla_x \cdot (\tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}'} e^{i\mathbf{k}' \cdot \mathbf{x}})] + \frac{a_2}{2} (T - T_c) \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}} \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}'} e^{i(\mathbf{k} + \mathbf{k}') \cdot \mathbf{x}} \\ &= \frac{1}{2V^2} \sum_{\mathbf{k}, \mathbf{k}'} [-\gamma \mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{k}' + a_2 (T - T_c)] \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}} \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}'} e^{i(\mathbf{k} + \mathbf{k}') \cdot \mathbf{x}} \end{aligned}$$

There is only $\mathbf{x}$ dependence on the last exponential term. Integrating this over all the spatial dimensions of our system ¹, we will get a Kronecker delta,

$$\int d^d x f(\mathbf{x}) = \frac{1}{2V^2} \sum_{\mathbf{k}, \mathbf{k}'} [-\gamma \mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{k}' + a_2(T - T_c)] \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}} \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}'} (V \delta_{\mathbf{k}+\mathbf{k}', 0}) = \frac{1}{2V} \sum_{\mathbf{k}} [\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c)] \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}} \tilde{\phi}_{-\mathbf{k}}$$

Since the field $\phi(\mathbf{x}) \in \mathbb{R}$, we have $\tilde{\phi}_{-\mathbf{k}} = \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}^*$ which means that,

$$\int d^d x f(\mathbf{x}) = \frac{1}{2V} \sum_{\mathbf{k}, \mathbf{k}'} [-\gamma \mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{k}' + a_2(T - T_c)] \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}} \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}'} \delta_{\mathbf{k}+\mathbf{k}', 0} = \frac{1}{2V} \sum_{\mathbf{k}} [\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c)] |\tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}|^2$$

Observe that $\phi(\mathbf{x}) = \tilde{\phi}_0 + \sum_{\mathbf{k} \neq 0} e^{i\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{x}} \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}$ which implies that, $\mathbf{k} = 0$ is the uniform mean field solution while $\mathbf{k} \neq 0$ denotes the fluctuations. Previously we had performed a coarse-graining to define the Landau-Ginzburg theory, which imposed a mesoscopic length scale l . Thus, $|\mathbf{r}| \gg l \implies |k| \ll \frac{1}{l}$. Hence, there is a cutoff for the momenta, let us call it Λ . Thus the sum is restricted to only those momenta $\mathbf{k}$ which satisfies $|\mathbf{k}| < \Lambda$.

$$\mathcal{L}[\{\tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}\}] = \frac{1}{2V} \sum_{\substack{\mathbf{k} \\ |\mathbf{k}| < \Lambda}} [\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c)] |\tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}|^2$$

Now, divide the $\mathbf{k}$ -space into two halves, Ω and Ω' such that if $\mathbf{k} \in \Omega$ then $-\mathbf{k} \in \Omega'^2$. We need to focus only on one half, since if $\mathbf{k} \in \Omega$ then $-\mathbf{k} \in \Omega'$ and these are not independent. Then the Landau functional becomes,

$$\mathcal{L}[\{\tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}\}] = \frac{1}{V} \sum_{\substack{\mathbf{k} \in \Omega \\ |\mathbf{k}| < \Lambda}} [\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c)] |\tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}|^2 \quad (80)$$

Now, let us find the partition function, where we need to perform the functional integral. Since the functional now depends on the Fourier modes, the functional integral measure will also change, which we write as,

$$\mathcal{Z} = \int \mathcal{D}\phi(\mathbf{x}) e^{-\beta \mathcal{L}[\phi(\mathbf{x})]} \equiv \int \prod \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}} \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}^* e^{-\beta \mathcal{L}[\{\tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}\}]}$$

Let us elaborate this a little bit explicitly, getting rid of some subtleties.

- Firstly, note that $\tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}$ and $\tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}^*$ are in the same footing as the real and imaginary parts of $\tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}$, so henceforth we will use the real and imaginary parts in the integral measure which we denote as, $\text{Re } \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}} \equiv \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}^R$ and $\text{Im } \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}} \equiv \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}^I$.
- Secondly, the limits of the product needs to be ascertained. Firstly, due to the same constraint that the field is real, the positive and negative modes are not independent. Moreover, we also need to take care of the cutoff. As a result, the product has the same limits as of the sum.
- While changing the measure to the Fourier modes, some constants surely crept in, which we would simply write as $\mathcal{N}$, since these would not be much of use.

Then the partition function becomes,

$$\mathcal{Z} = \mathcal{N} \prod_{\substack{\mathbf{k} \in \Omega \\ |\mathbf{k}| < \Lambda}} \int \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}^R \tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}^I \exp \left[\frac{-\beta}{V} [\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c)] [(\tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}^R)^2 + (\tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}^I)^2] \right] \quad (81)$$

where we have converted the exponential of the sum as a product of exponentials. Each integral has independent $\tilde{\phi}_{\mathbf{k}}^{R/I}$ going from $-\infty$ to $+\infty$ and the integrand is a Gaussian. Thus, for each $\mathbf{k}$, the integral

¹Note that the space is still continuous, even though the volume is finite

²One way to construct these regions can be to choose any arbitrary vector $\mathbf{a}$ and define $\Omega := \{\mathbf{k} | \mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{a} > 0\}$ and $\Omega' := \{\mathbf{k} | \mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{a} < 0\}$

gives two Gaussian results, one for the imaginary and other for the real part. So the partition function becomes,

$$\mathcal{Z} = \mathcal{N} \prod_{\substack{\mathbf{k} \in \Omega \\ |\mathbf{k}| < \Lambda}} \frac{\pi k_B T V}{\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c)} \quad (82)$$

The free energy is then found by taking the logarithm,

$$F = -k_B T \left[\ln \mathcal{Z}_0 + \sum_{\substack{\mathbf{k} \in \Omega \\ |\mathbf{k}| < \Lambda}} \ln \left(\frac{\pi k_B T V}{\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c)} \right) \right] = F_0 - \frac{k_B T}{2} \sum_{|\mathbf{k}| < \Lambda} \ln \left(\frac{\pi k_B T V}{\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c)} \right)$$

In the last part, we included the sum over all k-space, which introduced the factor of $1/2$ there. Next, we will calculate the heat capacity using this free energy and see whether any changes from MFT is seen by the introduction of fluctuations.

Lecture 20: Heat Capacity from Fluctuations

From MFT we know that the critical exponent $\alpha = 0$ and there is just a finite discontinuity across the transition point. However, in experiments, we have seen that the heat capacity actually diverges at the critical point. Let us see whether we can explain this behaviour using the fluctuations. The heat capacity at constant volume is given by,

$$C_v = -T \frac{\partial(S/V)}{\partial T} = -T \frac{\partial^2(F/V)}{\partial T^2}$$

We had calculated the free energy with incorporated fluctuations, in the previous lecture. The fluctuations are incorporated in the second term of the free energy, where the sum over $\mathbf{k}$ is there. Let us focus on that part only.

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{C_v}{T} &= \frac{\partial^2}{\partial T^2} \left[\frac{1}{2} \frac{k_B T}{V} \sum_{|\mathbf{k}| < \Lambda} \ln(\pi k_B V T) - \ln(\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c)) \right] \\ &= \frac{k_B}{2V} \frac{\partial}{\partial T} \left[\sum_{|\mathbf{k}| < \Lambda} \ln(\pi k_B V T) - \ln(\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c)) + \left\{ 1 - \frac{a_2 T}{\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c)} \right\} \right] \\ &= \frac{k_B}{2V} \sum_{|\mathbf{k}| < \Lambda} \left[\frac{1}{T} - \frac{2a_2}{\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c)} - \frac{a_2^2 T}{(\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c))^2} \right] \\ &= \frac{k_B}{2} \int_{|\mathbf{k}| < \Lambda} \frac{d^d k}{(2\pi)^d} \left[\frac{1}{T} - \frac{2a_2}{\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c)} - \frac{a_2^2 T}{(\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c))^2} \right] \end{aligned}$$

where we have converted the summation to an integral, taking $V \rightarrow \infty$. Now, we shall change the integral to polar coordinates. The angular part will be integrated out as the integrand has no angular dependence, giving us the solid angle S_d . We are then left with,

$$\frac{k_B}{2} \frac{1}{(2\pi)^d} \int_0^\Lambda k^{d-1} dk \left[\frac{1}{T} - \frac{2a_2}{\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c)} - \frac{a_2^2 T}{(\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c))^2} \right]$$

Let us focus on these integrals one by one:

- The first integral is,

$$\int_0^\Lambda k^{d-1} dk \frac{1}{T} = \frac{1}{T} \frac{\Lambda^d}{d} \longrightarrow \text{just a finite constant}$$

- The second integral is,

$$\frac{1}{\gamma} \int_0^{\Lambda} k^{d-1} dk \frac{2a_2}{k^2 + \frac{a_2}{\gamma}(T - T_c)} = \frac{1}{\gamma} \int_0^{\Lambda} k^{d-1} dk \frac{2a_2}{k^2 + \xi^{-2}}$$

Let us define $\mathbf{q} = \xi \mathbf{k} \implies dq = \xi dk$. Substituting this in the integral,

$$\frac{2a_2}{\gamma} \cdot \xi^{2-d} \int_0^{\Lambda\xi} dq \frac{q^{d-1}}{1+q^2}$$

Since we are interested at points near T_c , where $\xi \rightarrow \infty$. Let us break the integral into two parts. The second part is for large q ($q \gg 1$) while the first part is for $q \ll 1$ or $q \sim 1$.

$$\int_0^c dq q^{d-1} + \int_c^{\Lambda\xi} dq q^{d-3} = \left[\frac{q^d}{d} \right]_0^c + \left[\frac{q^{d-2}}{d-2} \right]_c^{\Lambda\xi} \sim (w + \xi^{d-2})$$

where w is some constant, obtained from the first part. The integral overall becomes,

$$\frac{2a_2}{\gamma} \cdot (w + \xi^{d-2}) \xi^{2-d} \sim \xi^{2-d} \sim t^{-(1-\frac{d}{2})}$$

ξ blows up at $T = T_c$ and hence the contribution would be finite if $2 - d < 0 \implies d > 2$.

- Let us now focus on the third integral

$$\frac{k_B}{2} \frac{1}{(2\pi)^d} \int_0^{\Lambda} k^{d-1} dk \frac{a_2^2 T}{(\gamma k^2 + a_2(T - T_c))^2}$$

We do a similar kind of substitution $\mathbf{q} = \xi \mathbf{k}$ which gives us,

$$\frac{a_2^2 k_B T}{2\gamma^2} \frac{1}{(2\pi)^d} \cdot \xi^{4-d} \int_0^{\Lambda\xi} dq \frac{q^{d-1}}{(1+q^2)^2}$$

Again, separating the integral into two parts gives us,

$$\int_0^{\Lambda\xi} dq \frac{q^{d-1}}{(1+q^2)^2} = \int_0^c dq q^{d-1} + \int_c^{\Lambda\xi} dq q^{d-5} \sim (w' + \xi^{d-4})$$

Then the contribution from the third integral becomes,

$$\frac{a_2^2 k_B T}{2\gamma^2} \frac{1}{(2\pi)^d} \cdot \xi^{4-d} (w' + \xi^{d-4}) \sim \xi^{4-d} \sim t^{-(2-\frac{d}{2})}$$

The contribution would be finite if $4 - d < 0 \implies d > 4$

For $d < 2$, both the integrals diverge while for $d > 4$, both converge. For $2 < d < 4$, the first converges while the second diverges. The scaling of the specific heat with the reduced temperature then becomes,

$$C_v \sim t^{-(1-\frac{d}{2})} + t^{-(2-\frac{d}{2})} \longrightarrow t^{-(2-\frac{d}{2})} \implies \boxed{C_v \sim t^{-(2-\frac{d}{2})}}$$

Hence, we see that the fluctuation have shifted the exponent α from the mean field value of zero to $\alpha = (2 - \frac{d}{2})$ and we do get a diverging behaviour at $T = T_c$, in agreement with reality. However, this is just a qualitative thing, since this exponent does not numerically agree with the experiments. Next, we will see a bit about correlation functions with fluctuations.

Appendices

From the first law we have the energy conservation equation,

$$dU = TdS - PdV + \mu dN$$

and thus the internal energy is a function of S, V and N . We know that the internal energy is a homogenous function of degree 1, on physical grounds, since if we scale the system variables by λ , U is also appropriately scaled (extensivity)

$$U(\lambda S, \lambda V, \lambda N) = \lambda U(S, V, N)$$

Now, from Euler's theorem of homogenous functions, we know that any homogenous function f of degree k can be written as,

$$kf(x_1, x_2 \dots x_n) = \sum_{i=1}^n x_i \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_i}$$

Using this theorem for U , we have

$$U = S \frac{\partial U}{\partial S} + V \frac{\partial U}{\partial V} + N \frac{\partial U}{\partial N}$$

Substituting the values from the first law, we obtain $U = TS - PV + \mu N$

A. Legendre Transformation

From classical mechanics, we know that the Legendre transformation is used to convert Lagrangian $L(x, \dot{x})$ to the Hamiltonian $H(x, p)$ and vice versa. Note how we switch $\dot{x}$ in L for p in H . We will call the variable that we want to switch to as the 'conjugate' of the variable we are switching. The Legendre transformation of the Lagrangian gives us the Hamiltonian,

$$H(x, p) = p\dot{x} - L$$

A function $f(x)$ with the Legendre transform $f^*(p)$ satisfies $f(x) + f^*(p) = xp$. We will use this for thermodynamic quantities also, however we will use an alternate definition using minus sign, $f(x) - f^*(p) = xp$. From the first law, we know that,

$$U = TdS - PdV + \mu dN$$

As clearly seen, the conjugate variable pairs are (S, T) , $(V, -P)$, (N, μ) . We will consider the starting point as the internal energy $U(S, V, N)$ which is a function of S, V, N from the statement of the first law. However, in any experiment, keeping these as control parameters are way too hard. Think about this, controlling entropy of a system is an arduous task but controlling its conjugate variable, T , is easy-peasy.

We get four different 'potentials' by just Legendre transformation (which is basically multiplying the conjugate variables together and subtracting from the function) of the internal energy, switching between the different conjugate variables.

- **Helmholtz Free Energy:** switching $S \leftrightarrow T$

$$F(T, V, N) = U - TS \implies dF = -SdT - PdV + \mu dN$$

- **Enthalpy:** switching $V \leftrightarrow -P$

$$H(S, P, N) = U + PV \implies dH = TdS + VdP + \mu dN$$

- **Gibb's Free Energy:** switching both $S \leftrightarrow T$ and $V \leftrightarrow -P$

$$G(T, P, N) = U - TS + PV \implies dG = -SdT + VdP + \mu dN$$

- **Grand Potential:** switching both $S \leftrightarrow T$ and $N \leftrightarrow \mu$

$$\Phi(T, V, \mu) = U - TS - \mu N = -PV \implies d\Phi = -SdT - PdV - Nd\mu$$

B. 1D Solution of Ising Model

In 1D, the Ising model is given by,

$$\mathcal{H} = -J \sum_i^N \sigma_i \sigma_{i+1} - h \sum_i^N \sigma_i$$

where we have assumed periodic boundary conditions. The second term can be written as a symmetric sum, utilising the translation invariance. Hence the Hamiltonian becomes,

$$\mathcal{H} = -J \sum_i^N \sigma_i \sigma_{i+1} - \frac{h}{2} \sum_i^N (\sigma_i + \sigma_{i+1}) \equiv \sum_i^N \mathcal{E}(\sigma_i, \sigma_{i+1})$$

where $\mathcal{E}(\sigma_i, \sigma_{i+1}) = -J\sigma_i\sigma_{i+1} - \frac{h}{2}(\sigma_i + \sigma_{i+1})$. Note that $\mathcal{E}(+, +) = -(J + h)$, $\mathcal{E}(-, -) = -(J - h)$, $\mathcal{E}(+, -) = \mathcal{E}(-, +) = J$. The contribution of each configuration is,

$$P(\{\sigma_i\}) \propto e^{-\beta\mathcal{H}(\{\sigma_i\})} = \exp\left(-\beta \sum_j \mathcal{E}(\sigma_j, \sigma_{j+1})\right) \equiv \prod_{i=1}^N \exp(-\beta\mathcal{E}(\sigma_i, \sigma_{i+1}))$$

Let us define $t_{\sigma_i\sigma_{i+1}} = \exp(-\beta\mathcal{E}(\sigma_i, \sigma_{i+1}))$ which is an entry of a matrix t called the *transfer matrix*:

$$t_{\sigma_i\sigma_j} \equiv \langle \sigma_i | t | \sigma_j \rangle$$

The transfer matrix is just a notational trick and is assumed to be an operator of the Hilbert space spanned by $|+1\rangle$ and $|-1\rangle$.

$$\begin{aligned} \langle + | t | + \rangle &= e^{\beta(J+h)} & \langle + | t | - \rangle &= e^{-\beta J} \\ \langle - | t | - \rangle &= e^{\beta(J-h)} & \langle - | t | + \rangle &= e^{-\beta J} \end{aligned}$$

The partition function can then be written as,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{Z} &= \sum_{\{\sigma_i\}} e^{-\beta\mathcal{H}(\{\sigma_i\})} = \sum_{\sigma_1} \sum_{\sigma_2} \cdots \sum_{\sigma_N} t_{\sigma_1\sigma_2} t_{\sigma_2\sigma_3} \cdots t_{\sigma_N\sigma_1} \\ &= \sum_{\sigma_1} \sum_{\sigma_2} \cdots \sum_{\sigma_N} \langle \sigma_1 | t | \sigma_2 \rangle \langle \sigma_2 | t | \sigma_3 \rangle \langle \sigma_3 | t | \sigma_4 \rangle \cdots \langle \sigma_N | t | \sigma_1 \rangle \end{aligned} \quad (83)$$

From the resolution of identity, $\sum_{\sigma} |\sigma\rangle \langle \sigma| = \mathbb{1}$ and hence all the inner spin sums vanish. We are left with,

$$\mathcal{Z} = \sum_{\sigma_1} \langle \sigma_1 | t^N | \sigma_1 \rangle = \text{Tr}(t^N) = \lambda_+^N + \lambda_-^N = \lambda_+^N \left(1 + \left(\frac{\lambda_-}{\lambda_+} \right)^N \right)$$

where $\lambda_- < \lambda_+$ are the eigenvalues of the transfer matrix. In the limit $N \rightarrow \infty$, $\mathcal{Z} \rightarrow \lambda_+$. The eigenvalues of the transfer matrix are given as,

$$t \equiv \begin{pmatrix} e^{\beta(J+h)} & e^{-\beta J} \\ e^{-\beta J} & e^{\beta(J-h)} \end{pmatrix} \Rightarrow \boxed{\lambda_{\pm} = e^{\beta J} \left[\cosh(\beta h) \pm \sqrt{\sinh^2(\beta h) + e^{-4\beta J}} \right]}$$

In the thermodynamic limit, the free energy $F = -k_B T \ln \mathcal{Z} = -N k_B T \ln \lambda_+$ and then the magnetisation is given as,

$$\begin{aligned} M &= -\frac{\partial F}{\partial h} = N k_B T \frac{\partial}{\partial h} \left[\beta J + \ln \left(\cosh(\beta h) + \sqrt{\sinh^2(\beta h) + e^{-4\beta J}} \right) \right] \\ &= N k_B T \frac{\beta \sinh(\beta h) + \frac{2\beta \sinh(\beta h) \cosh(\beta h)}{2\sqrt{\sinh^2(\beta h) + e^{-4\beta J}}}}{\left(\cosh(\beta h) + \sqrt{\sinh^2(\beta h) + e^{-4\beta J}} \right)} \\ &= N (k_B T) \beta \frac{\sinh(\beta h) \left[\sqrt{\sinh^2(\beta h) + e^{-4\beta J}} + \cosh(\beta h) \right]}{\left(\sqrt{\sinh^2(\beta h) + e^{-4\beta J}} \right) \left(\cosh(\beta h) + \sqrt{\sinh^2(\beta h) + e^{-4\beta J}} \right)} \\ &= \frac{N \sinh(\beta h)}{\sqrt{\sinh^2(\beta h) + e^{-4\beta J}}} \end{aligned}$$

The magnetisation per spin is then,

$$m = \frac{\sinh(\beta h)}{\sqrt{\sinh^2(\beta h) + e^{-4\beta J}}}$$

For $T > 0$ and $h \neq 0$, m is a well-behaved function with no singularity. For $h \rightarrow 0$, we get $m \rightarrow 0$ for all $T > 0$. Thus, temperature is not sufficient to produce a finite magnetisation without an external field. For $T \rightarrow 0$, we have $m \rightarrow 1$ and hence we can say that the phase transition to ferromagnetic behaviour in the 1D Ising model is at $T_c = 0$. This is the reason why Ising said that there is no phase transition in 1D case (and incorrectly generalised it to higher dimensions too)!

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